Self-Supervised Learning

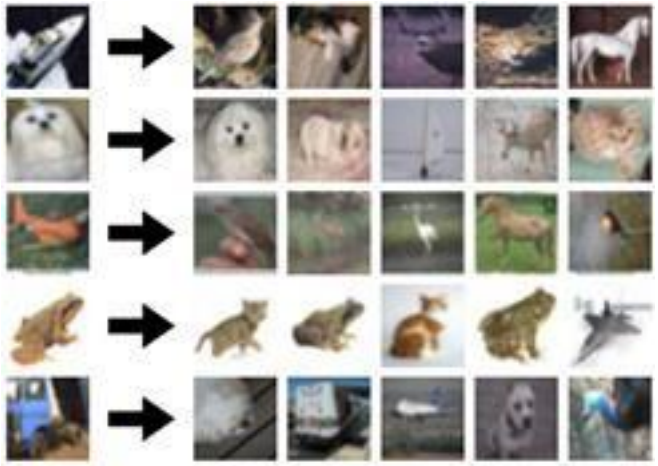
Advanced Machine Learning
26 October 2026
Prof. Fabio Galasso



SAPIENZA
UNIVERSITÀ DI ROMA

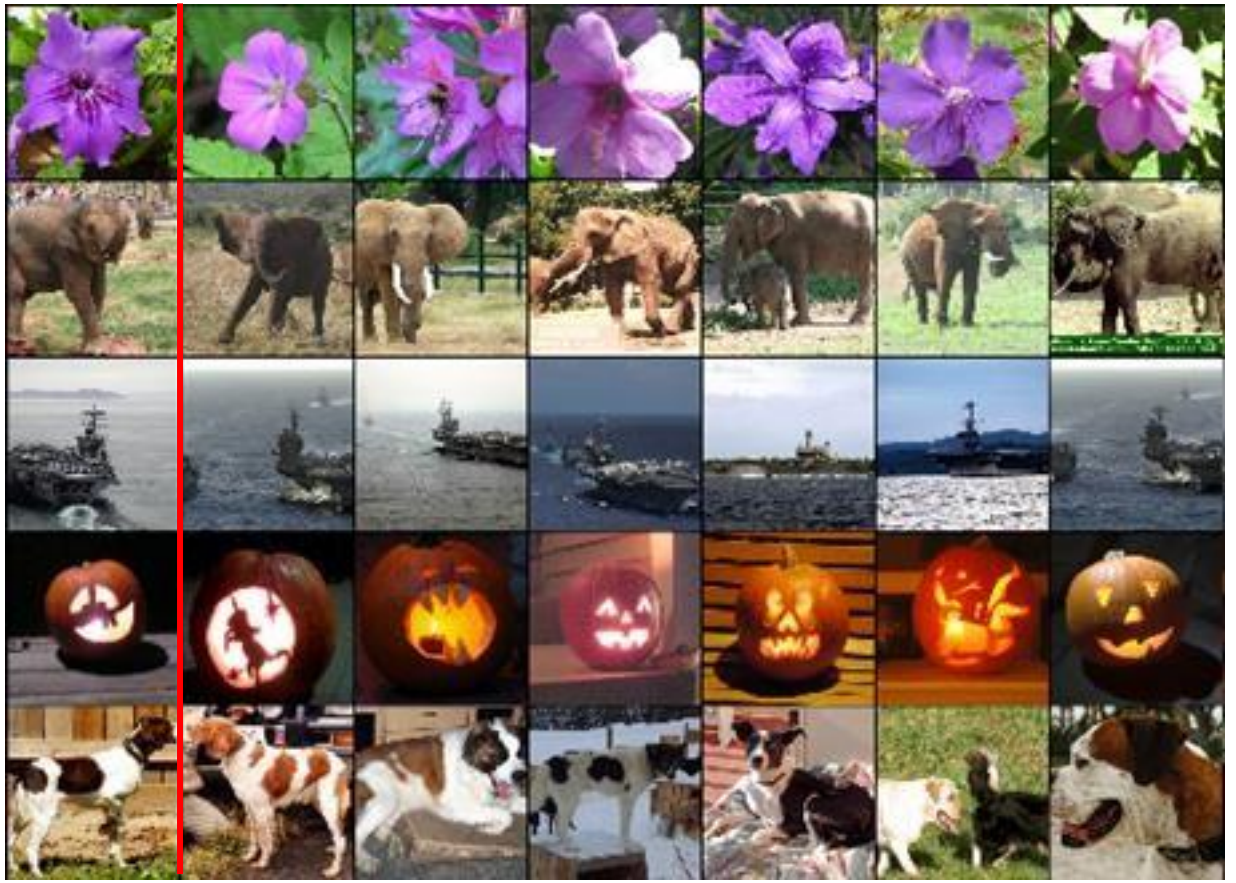
Recall: Visualization and Transfer Learning

Recall: Nearest neighbors in pixel space

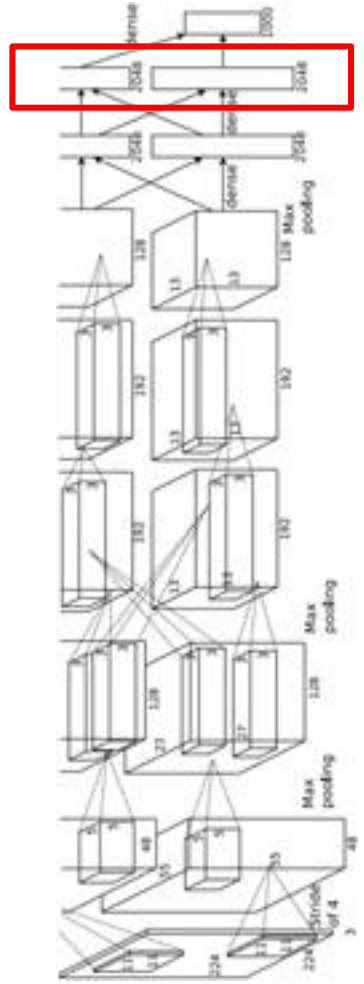


Test image

L2 Nearest neighbors in feature space



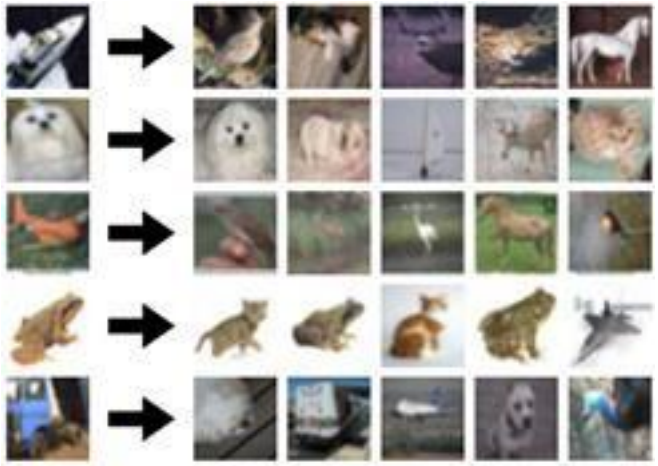
4096-dim vector



Krizhevsky et al, "ImageNet Classification with Deep Convolutional Neural Networks", NIPS 2012.
Figures reproduced with permission.

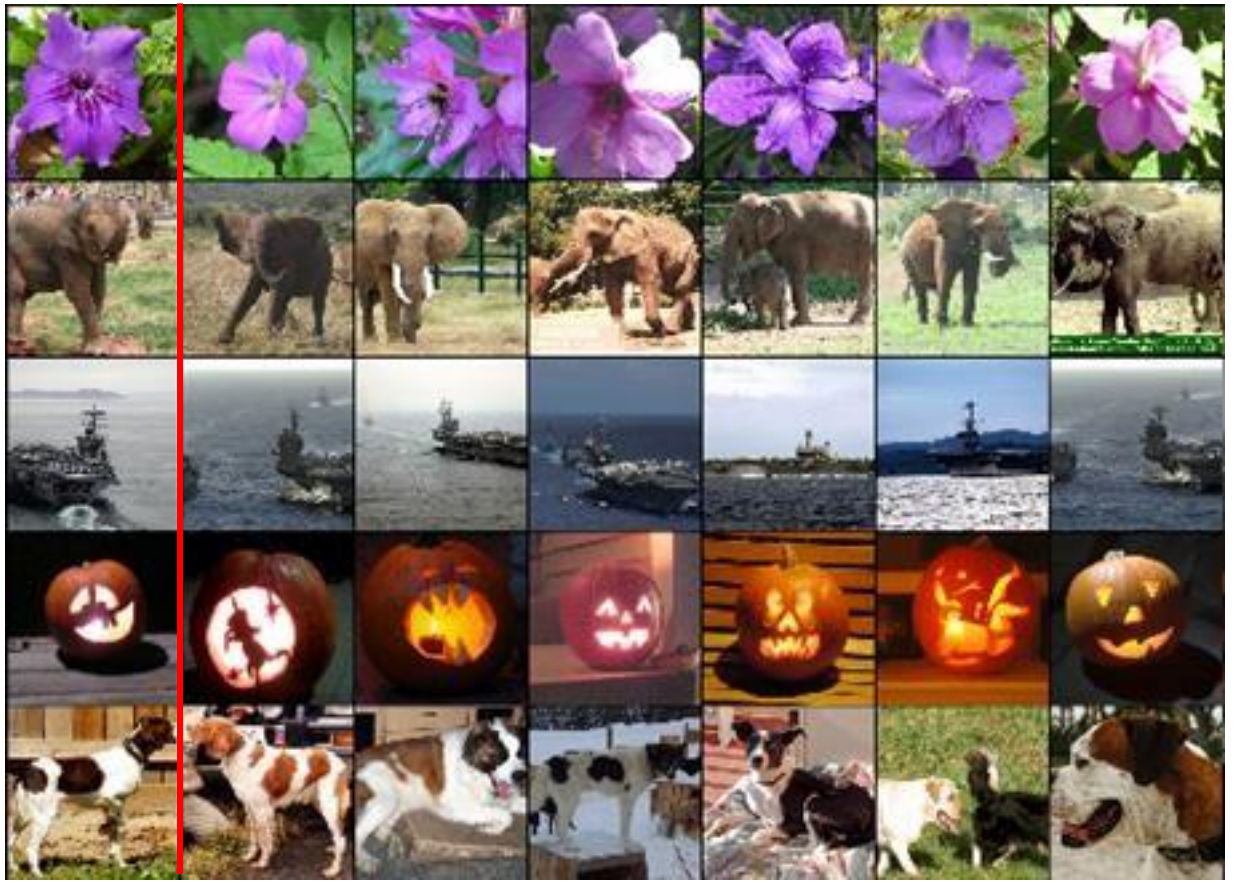
Learned Representations

Recall: Nearest neighbors in pixel space

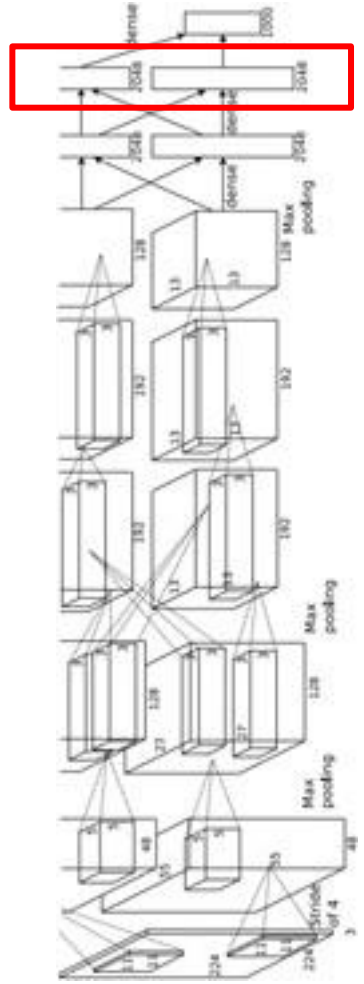


Test image

L2 Nearest neighbors in feature space



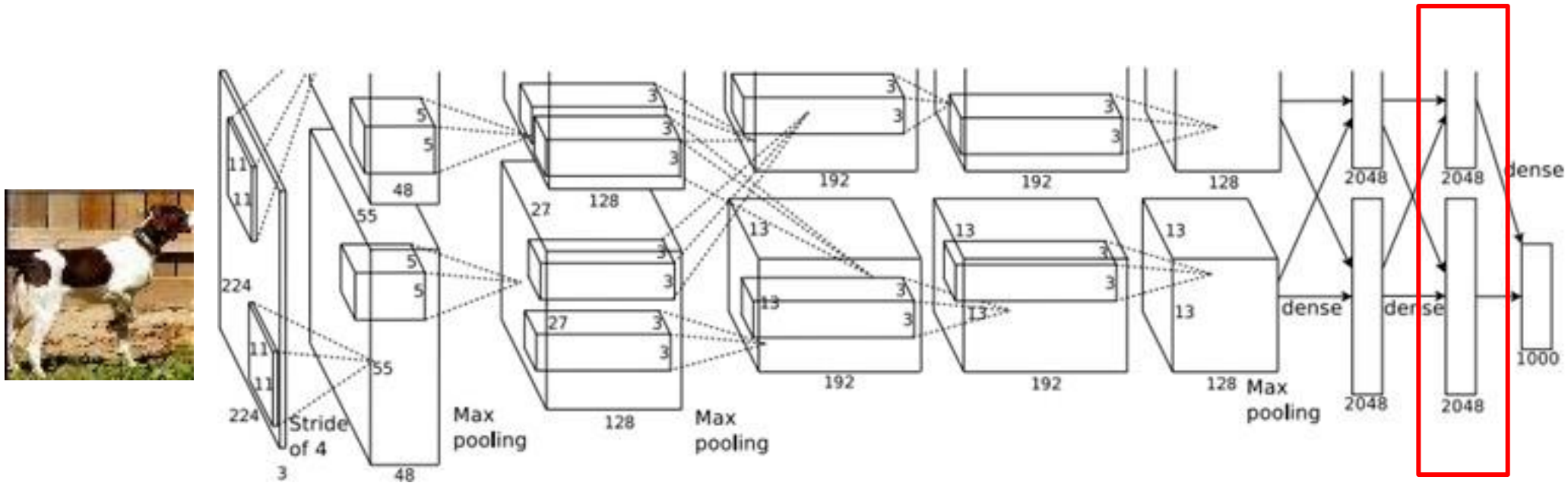
4096-dim vector



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Learned Representations

4096-dim vector



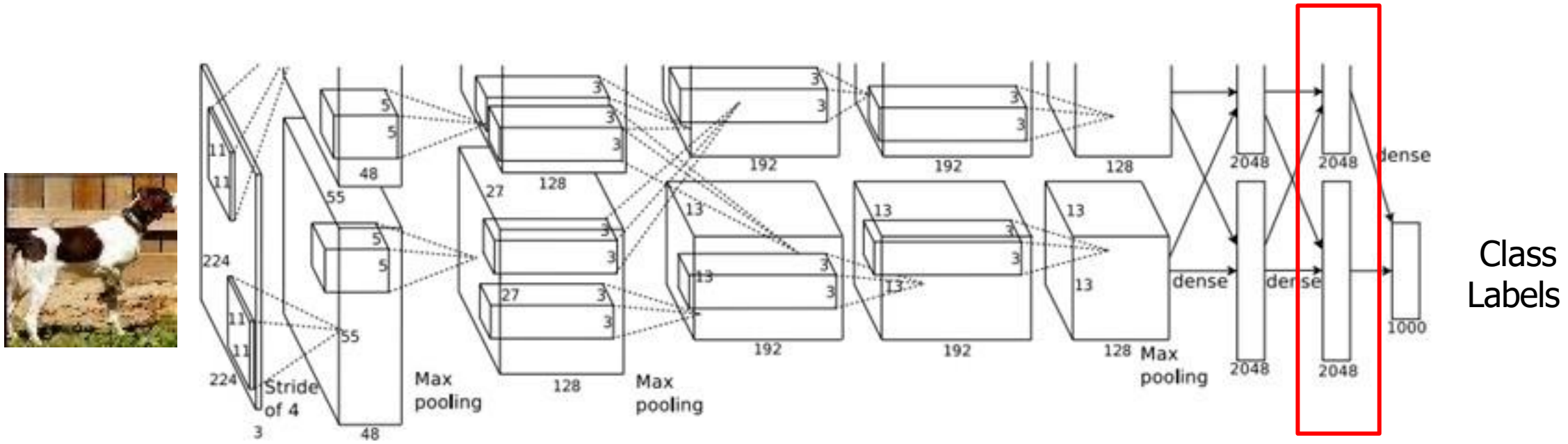
Class Labels

What is the problem with large-scale training?

Krizhevsky et al, "ImageNet Classification with Deep Convolutional Neural Networks", NIPS 2012.
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Learned Representations

4096-dim vector



Class Labels

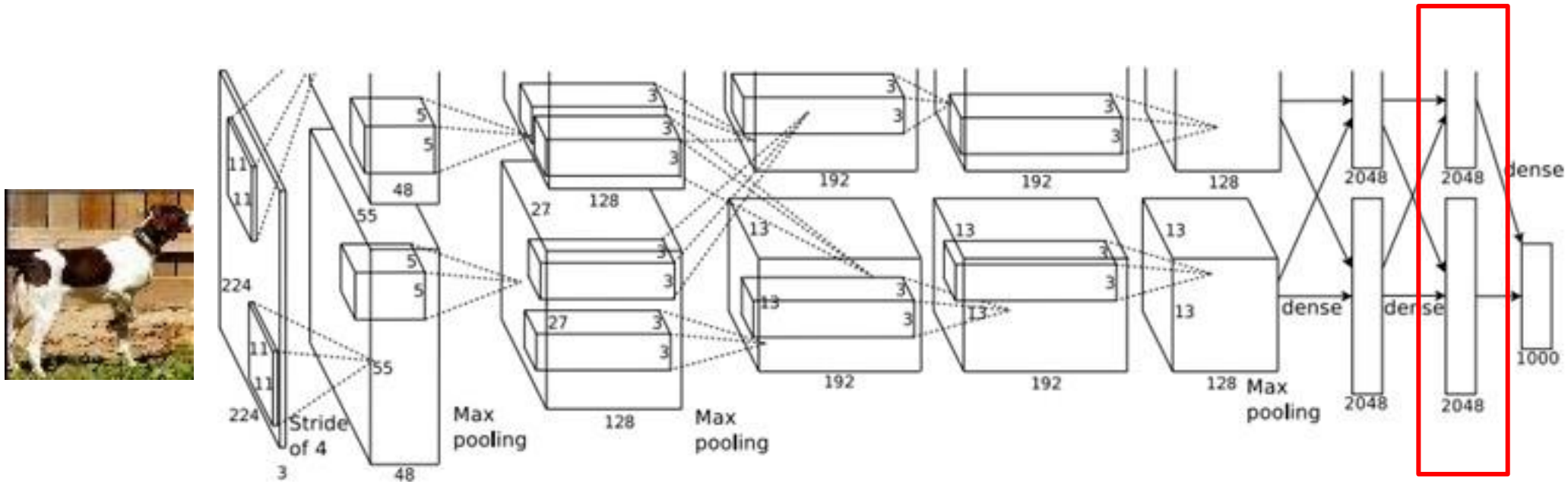
What is the problem with large-scale training?

- **We need a lot of labeled data**

Krizhevsky et al, "ImageNet Classification with Deep Convolutional Neural Networks", NIPS 2012.
Figures reproduced with permission.

Learned Representations

4096-dim vector



Class Labels

What is the problem with large-scale training?

- **We need a lot of labeled data**

Is there a way we can train neural networks without the need for huge manually labeled datasets?

Krizhevsky et al, "ImageNet Classification with Deep Convolutional Neural Networks", NIPS 2012.
Figures reproduced with permission.

Learned Representations: avoiding Supervision collapse

Networks are good at picking patterns in the images, to reach their target

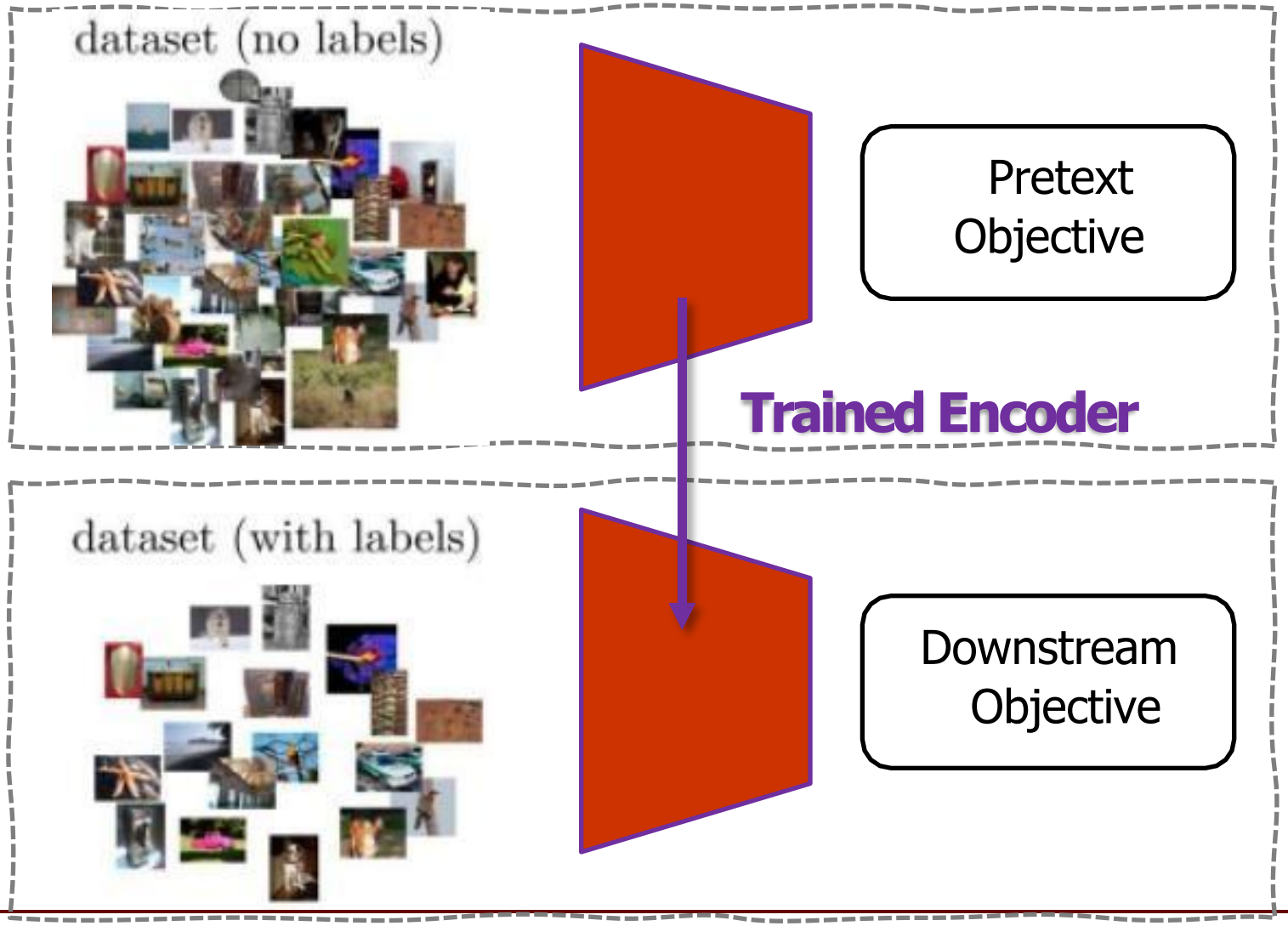
The learned feature manifold depends on the target task
The learned model features may disregard anything that does not relate to the target task

Risk of picking spurious correlations that do not generalize



CrossTransformers: spatially-aware few-shot transfer (Doersch et al. NIPS 2020)

Self-Supervised Learning



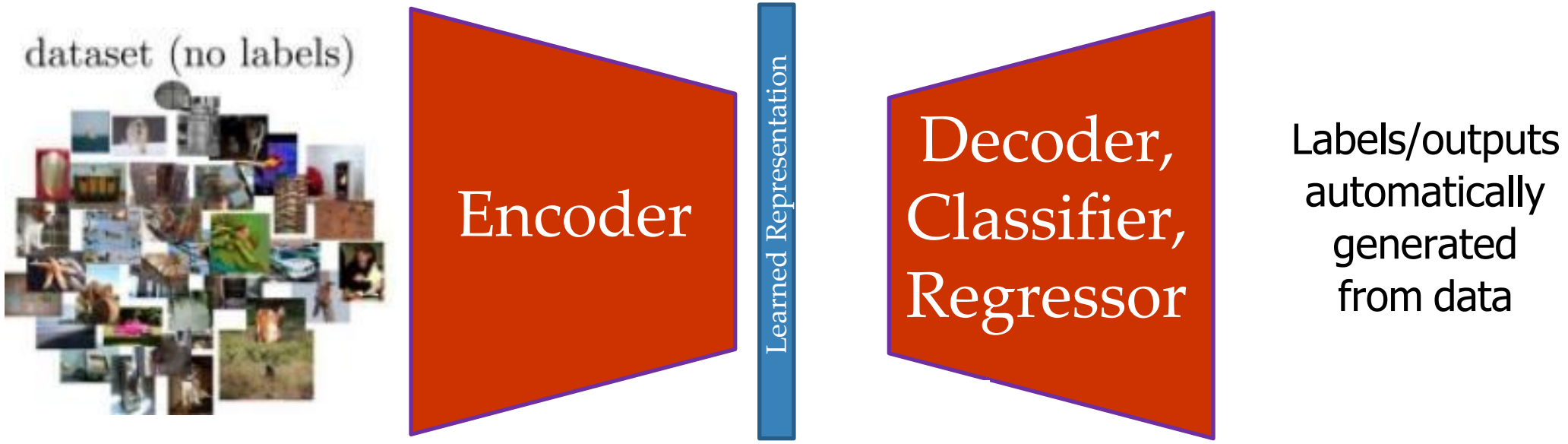
Pretext Task

- Define a task based on the data itself
- No manual annotation
- Could be considered an **unsupervised** task;
  - but we learn with supervised learning objectives, e.g., classification or regression.

Downstream Task

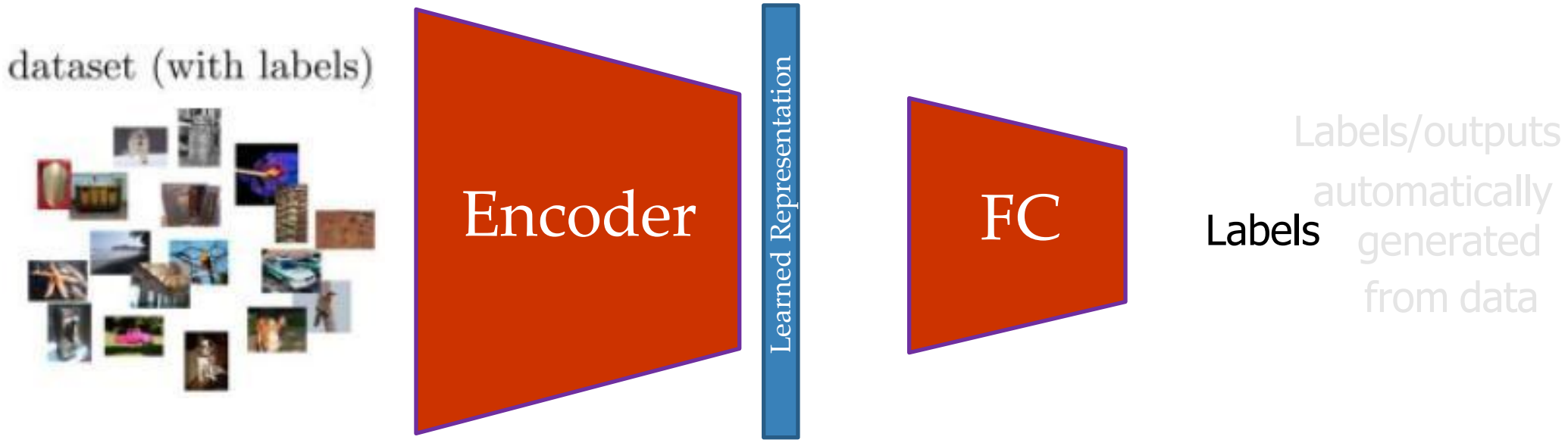
- The application you care about
- You do not have large datasets
- The dataset is labeled

Self-Supervised Learning – Pretext Task



Labels/outputs automatically generated from data

Self-Supervised Learning – Downstream Task



Self-supervised pretext tasks

Example: learn to predict image transformations / complete corrupted images

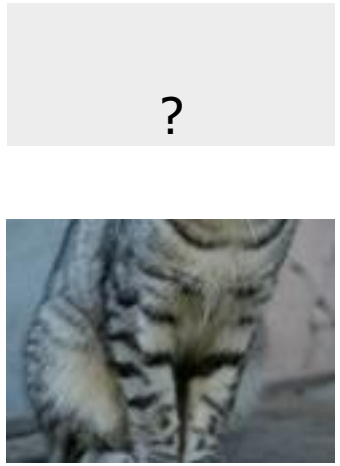
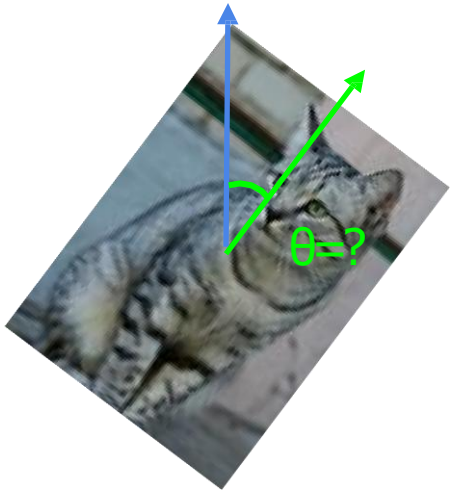


image completion



rotation prediction



"jigsaw puzzle"



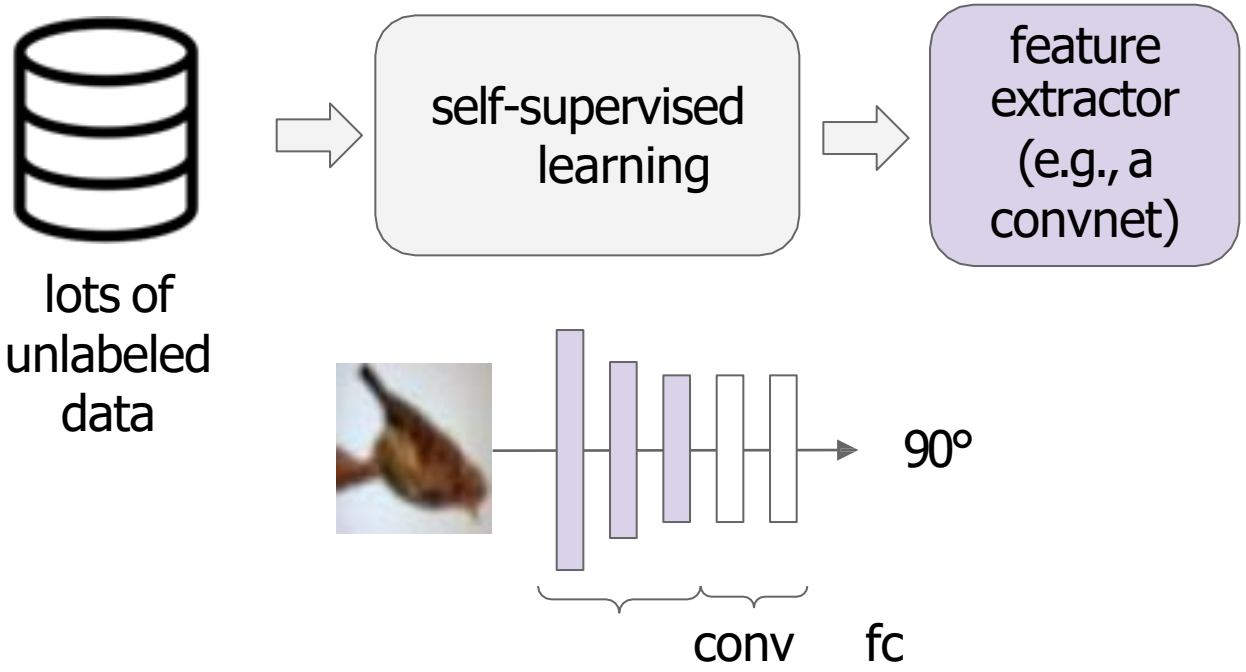
colorization

1. Solving the pretext tasks allow the model to learn good features.
2. We can automatically generate labels for the pretext tasks.

How to evaluate a self-supervised learning method?

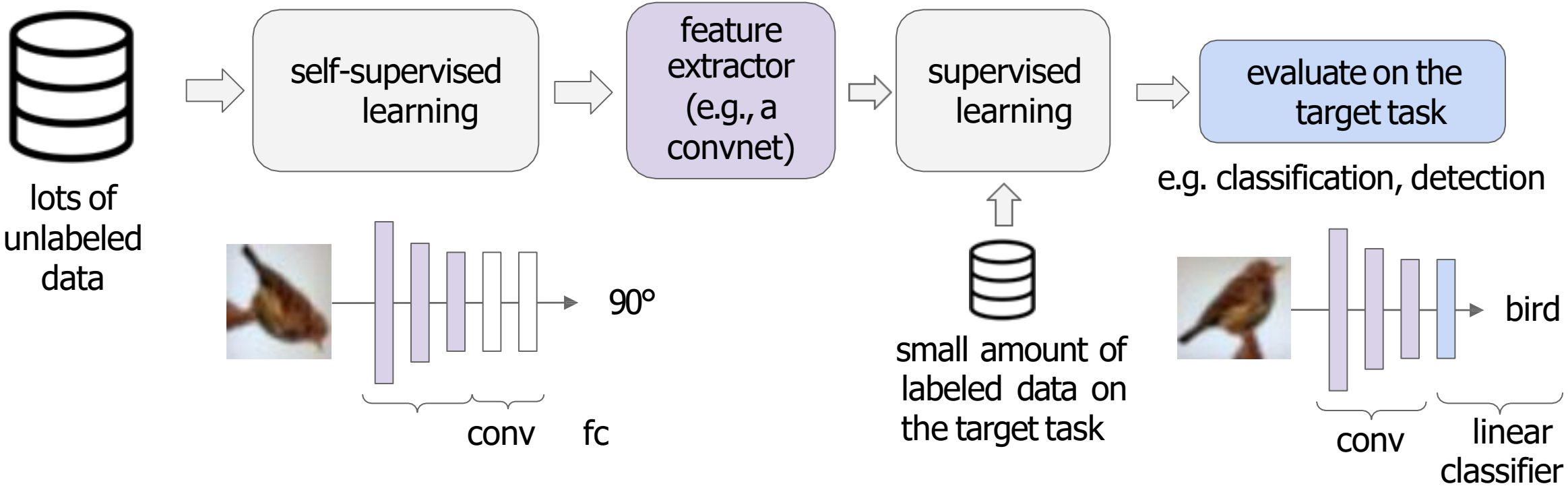
- **Pretext Task Performance**
  - Measure how well the model performs on the task it was trained on without labels.
- **Representation Quality**
  - Evaluate the quality of the learned representations
    - *Linear Evaluation Protocol:* Train a linear classifier on the leaerned representations;
    - *Clustering:* Measure clustering performance;
    - *t-SNE:* Visualize the representations to assess their separability.)
- **Robustness and Generalization**
  - Test how well the model generalizes to different datasets and is robust to variations.
- **Computational Efficiency**
  - Assess the efficiency of the method in terms of training time and resource requirements.
- **Transfer Learning and Downstream Task Performance**
  - Assess the utility of the learned representations by transferring them to a downstream supervised task.

How to evaluate a self-supervised learning method?



1. Learn good feature extractors from self-supervised pretext tasks, e.g., predicting image rotations

How to evaluate a self-supervised learning method?



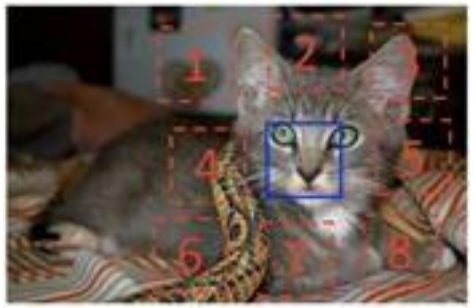
1. Learn good feature extractors from self-supervised pretext tasks, e.g., predicting image rotations

2. Attach a shallow network on the feature extractor; train the shallow network on the target task with small amount of labeled data

Broader picture

Today's lecture

computer vision



Doersch et al., 2015

language modeling

GPT-4 Technical Report

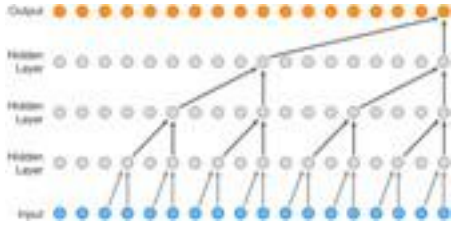
OpenAI*

Abstract

We report the development of GPT-4, a large-scale, multimodal model which can accept image and text inputs and produce text outputs. While less capable than humans in many real-world scenarios, GPT-4 exhibits human-level performance on various professional and academic benchmarks, including passing a simulated bar exam with a score around the top 10% of test takers. GPT-4 is a Transformer-based model pre-trained to predict the next token in a document. The post-training alignment process results in improved performance on measures of factuality and adherence to desired behavior. A core component of this project was developing infrastructure and optimization methods that behave predictably across a wide range of scales. This allowed us to accurately predict some aspects of GPT-4's performance based on models trained with no more than 1/1,000th the compute of GPT-4.

GPT-4 (OpenAI 2023)

speech synthesis



Wavenet (van den Oord et al., 2016)

robot / reinforcement learning



Dense Object Net (Florence and Manuelli et al., 2018)

...

Outline

Pretext tasks from image transformations

- Rotation, inpainting, rearrangement, coloring
- Reconstruction-based learning (MAE)

Contrastive representation learning

- Intuition and formulation
- Instance contrastive learning: SimCLR and MOCO
- Contrastive learning without negatives: BYOL, SimSiam
- Self-Distillation Without Labels, DINO

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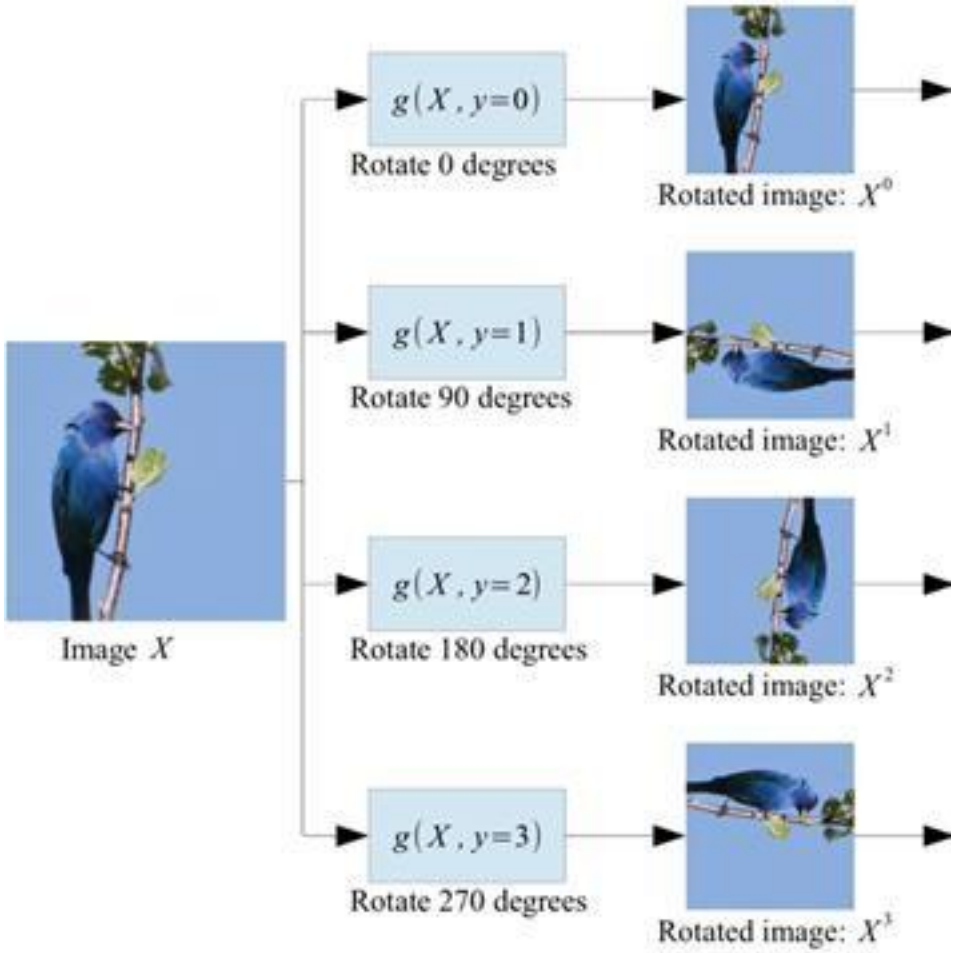
Pretext task: predict rotations



Hypothesis: a model could recognize the correct rotation of an object only if it has the "visual commonsense" of what the object should look like unperturbed.

(Image source: Gidaris et al. 2018)

Pretext task: predict rotations

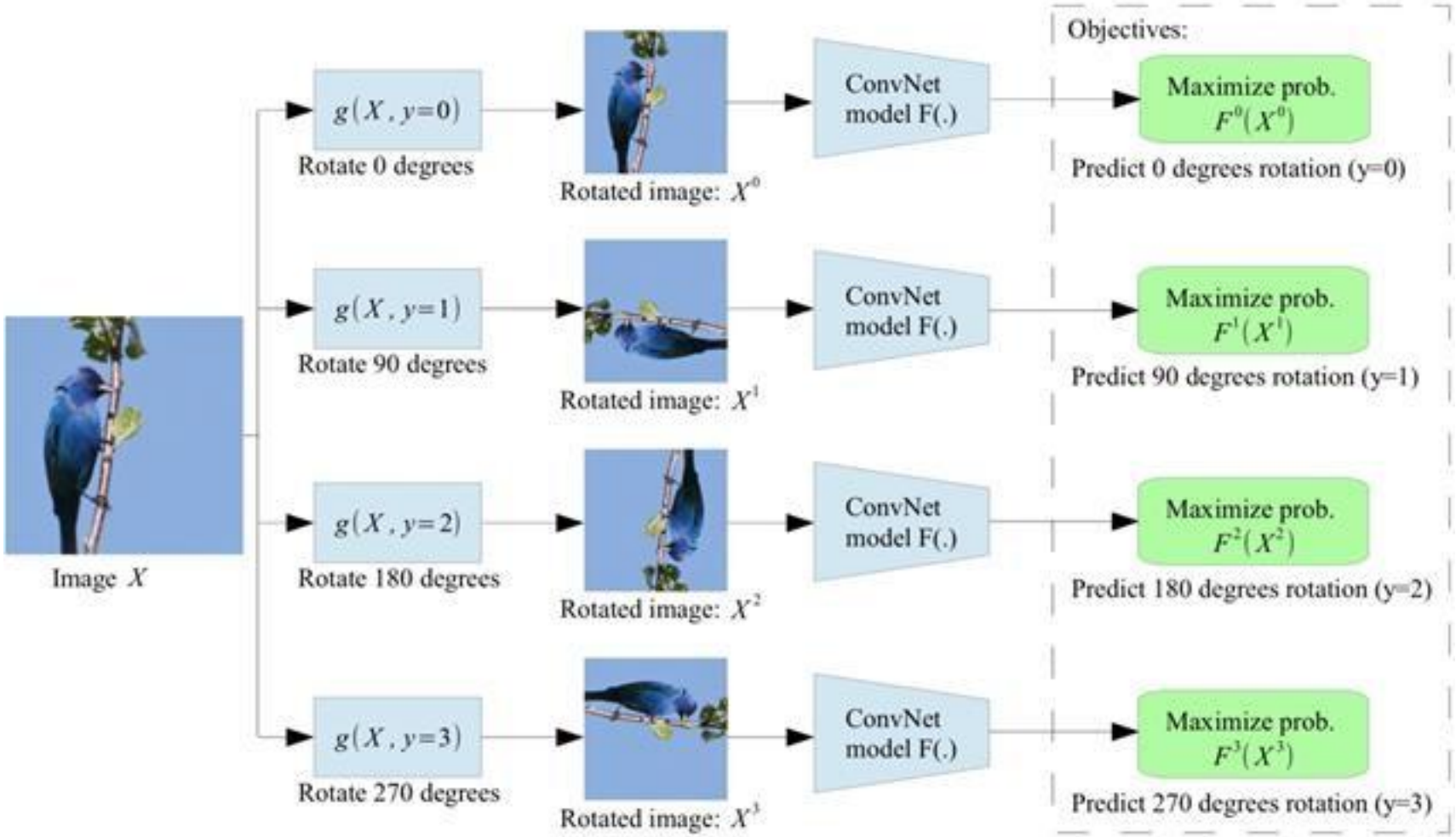


Self-supervised learning by rotating the entire input images.

The model learns to predict which rotation is applied (4-way classification)

(Image source: Gidaris et al. 2018)

Pretext task: predict rotations

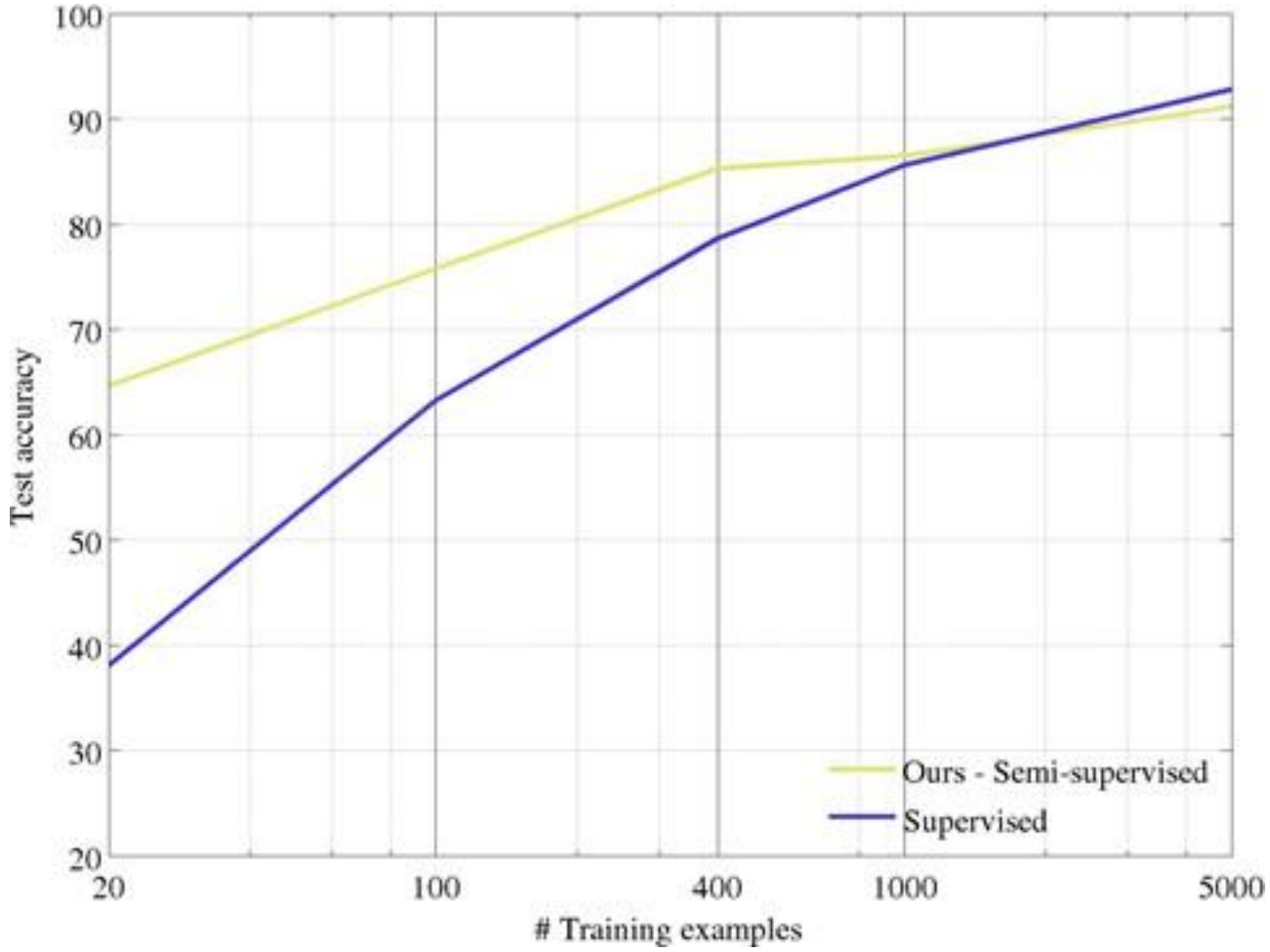


Self-supervised learning by rotating the entire input images.

The model learns to predict which rotation is applied (4-way classification)

(Image source: Gidaris et al. 2018)

Evaluation on semi-supervised learning



Self-supervised learning on CIFAR10 (entire training set).

Freeze conv1 +conv2
Learn conv3 +linear layers with subset of labeled CIFAR10 data (classification).

(Image source: Gidaris et al. 2018)

Transfer learned features to supervised learning

	Classification (%mAP)		Detection (%mAP)	Segmentation (%mIoU)
Trained layers	fc6-8	all	all	all
ImageNet labels	78.9	79.9	56.8	48.0
Random		53.3	43.4	19.8
Random rescaled Krähenbühl et al. (2015)	39.2	56.6	45.6	32.6
Egomotion (Agrawal et al., 2015)	31.0	54.2	43.9	
Context Encoders (Pathak et al., 2016b)	34.6	56.5	44.5	29.7
Tracking (Wang & Gupta, 2015)	55.6	63.1	47.4	
Context (Doersch et al., 2015)	55.1	65.3	51.1	
Colorization (Zhang et al., 2016a)	61.5	65.6	46.9	35.6
BIGAN (Donahue et al., 2016)	52.3	60.1	46.9	34.9
Jigsaw Puzzles (Noroozi & Favaro, 2016)	-	67.6	53.2	37.6
NAT (Bojanowski & Joulin, 2017)	56.7	65.3	49.4	
Split-Brain (Zhang et al., 2016b)	63.0	67.1	46.7	36.0
ColorProxy (Larsson et al., 2017)		65.9		38.4
Counting (Noroozi et al., 2017)	-	67.7	51.4	36.6
(Ours) RotNet	**70.87**	**72.97**	**54.4**	**39.1**

Pretrained with full ImageNet supervision

No pretraining

Self-supervised learning on ImageNet (entire training set) with AlexNet.

Finetune on labeled data from Pascal VOC 2007.

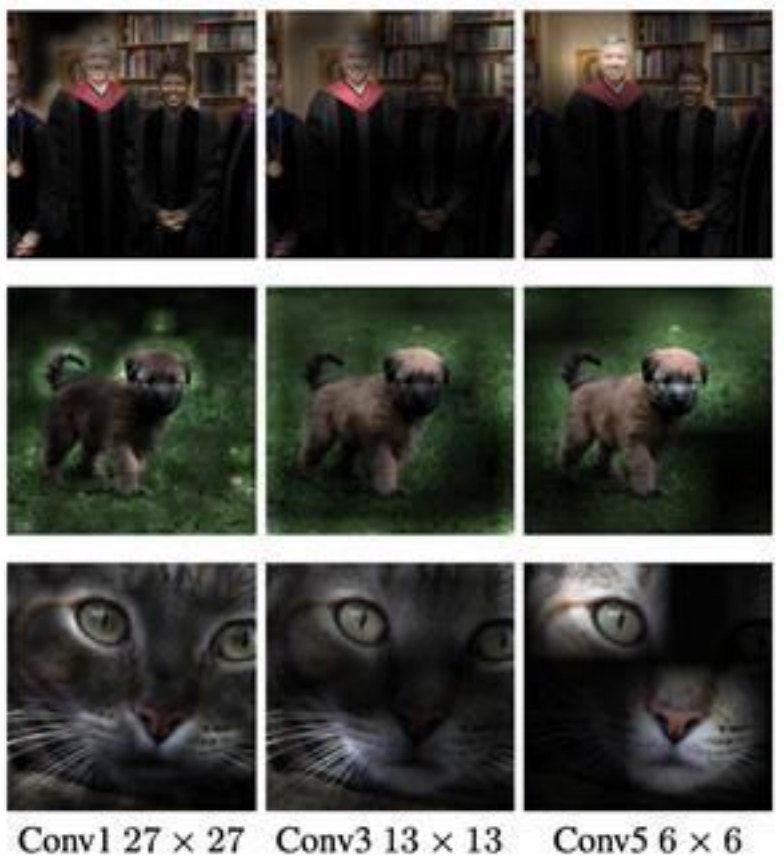
Self-supervised learning with rotation prediction

source: Gidaris et al. 2018

Visualize learned visual attentions



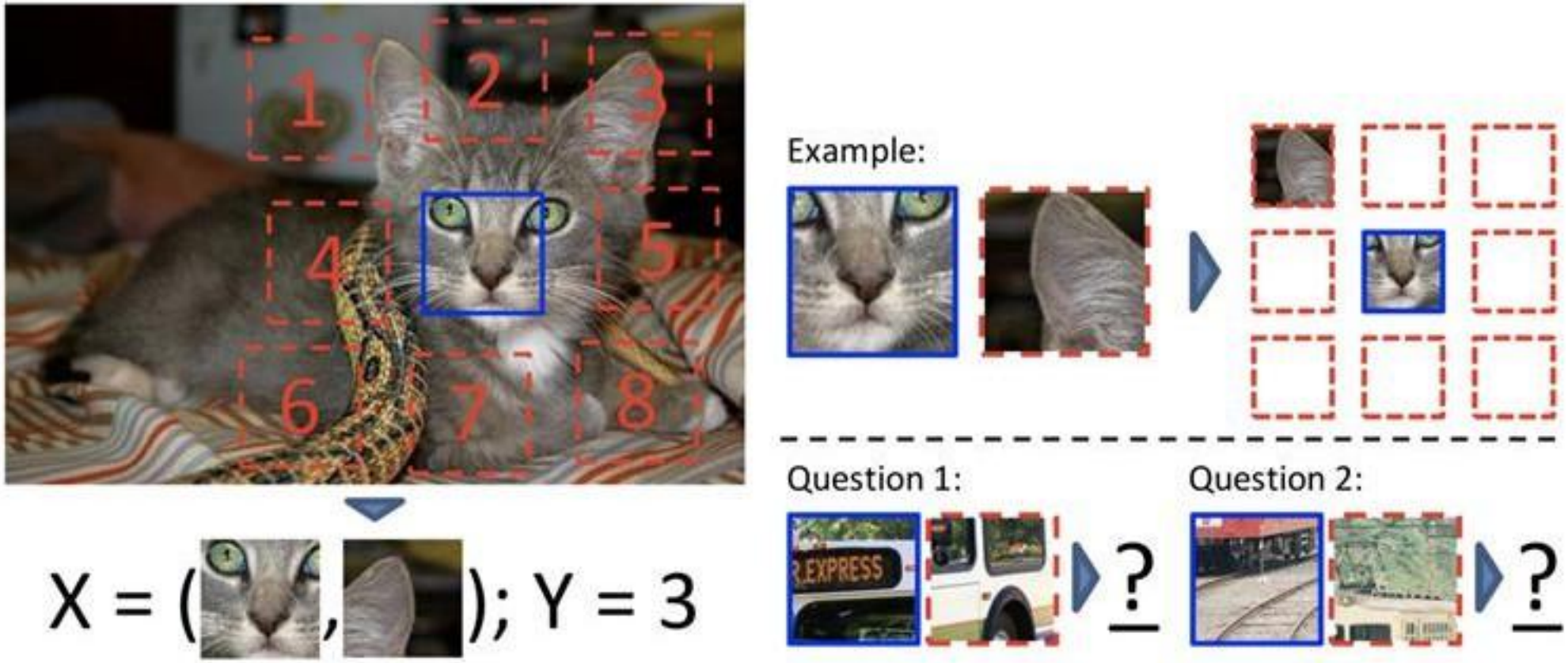
(a) **Attention maps of supervised model**



(b) **Attention maps of our self-supervised model**

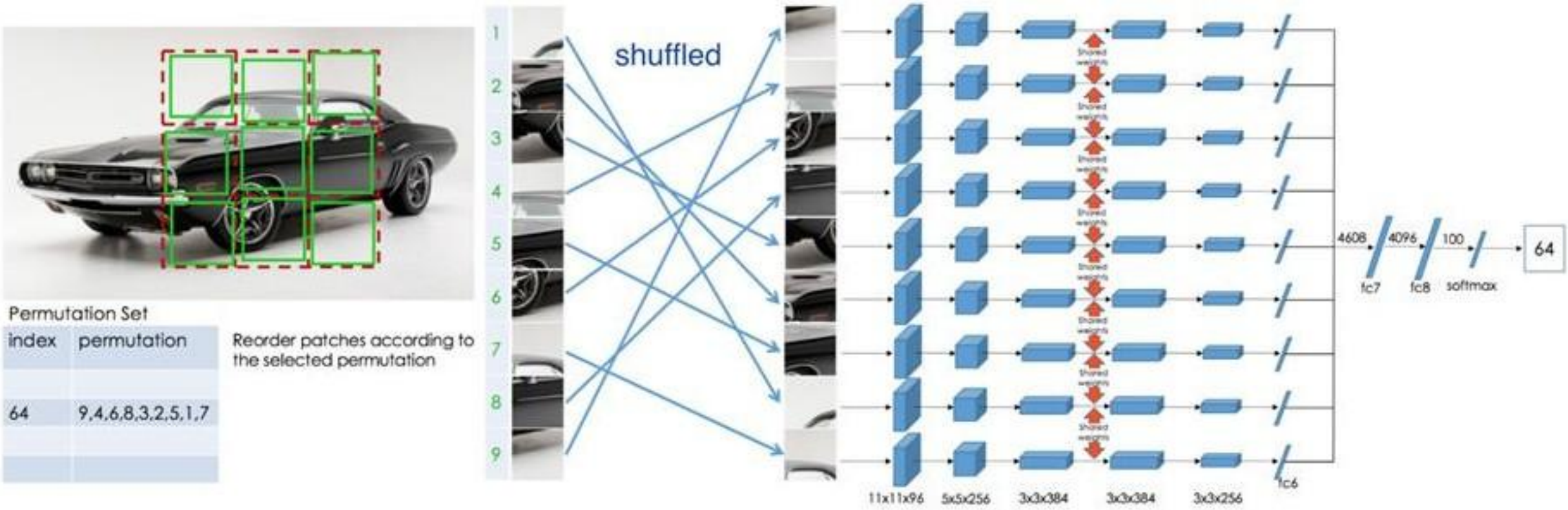
(Image source: Gidaris et al. 2018)

Pretext task: predict relative patch locations



(Image source: Doersch et al., 2015)

Pretext task: solving "jigsaw puzzles"



(Image source: [Noroozi & Favaro, 2016])

Transfer learned features to supervised learning

Table 1: Results on PASCAL VOC 2007 Detection and Classification. The results of the other methods are taken from Pathak *et al.* [30].

Method	Pretraining time	Supervision	Classification	Detection	Segmentation
Krizhevsky*et al.* [25]	3 days	1000 class labels	**78.2%**	**56.8%**	**48.0%**
Wang and Gupta[39]	1 week	motion	58.4%	44.0%	-
Doersch *et al.* [10]	4 weeks	context	55.3%	46.6%	-
Pathak *et al.* [30]	14 hours	context	56.5%	44.5%	29.7%
Ours	2.5 days	context	**67.6%**	**53.2%**	**37.6%**

"Ours" is feature learned from solving image Jigsaw puzzles (Noroozi & Favaro, 2016). Doersch et al. is the method with relative patch location

(source: Noroozi & Favaro, 2016)

Pretext task: predict missing pixels (inpainting)

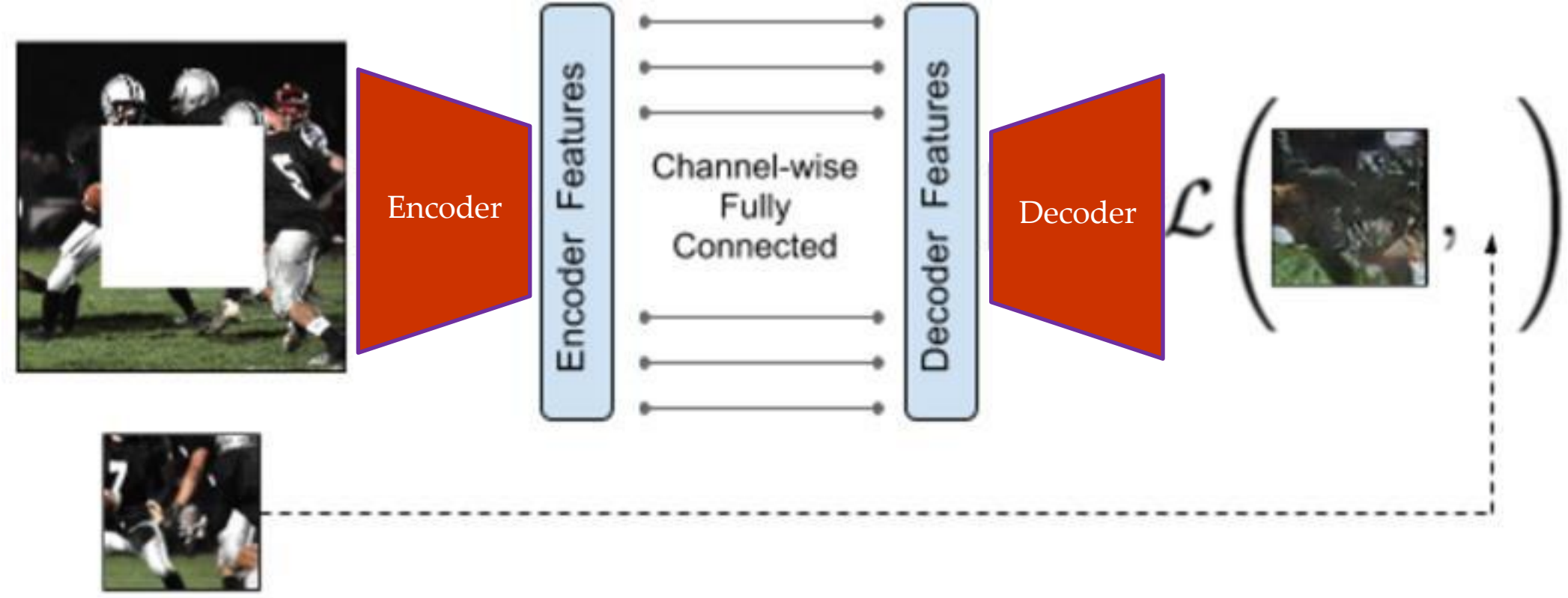


Context Encoders: Feature Learning by Inpainting (Pathak et al., 2016)

Source: Pathak et al., 2016

Learning to inpaint by reconstruction

Auto Encoder



Learning to reconstruct the missing pixels

Source: [Pathak et al., 2016]

Inpainting evaluation



Input (context)



reconstruction

Source: Pathak et al., 2016

Learning to inpaint by reconstruction

Loss =reconstruction +adversarial learning

$$L(x) = L_{recon}(x) + L_{adv}(x)$$

Element wise multiplication

$$M = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{not masked} \\ 1 & \text{masked} \end{cases}$$

$$L_{recon}(x) = ||M * (x - F_\theta((1 - M) * x))||_2^2$$

Encoder-decoder

$$L_{adv} = \max_D \mathbb{E}_x \left[\log D(x) + \log \left(1 - D(F((1 - M) * x))\right) \right]$$

Adversarial loss between "real" images and inpainted images

Source: Pathak et al., 2016

Inpainting evaluation



Input (context)



reconstruction



adversarial



recon +adv

Source: [Pathak et al., 2016]

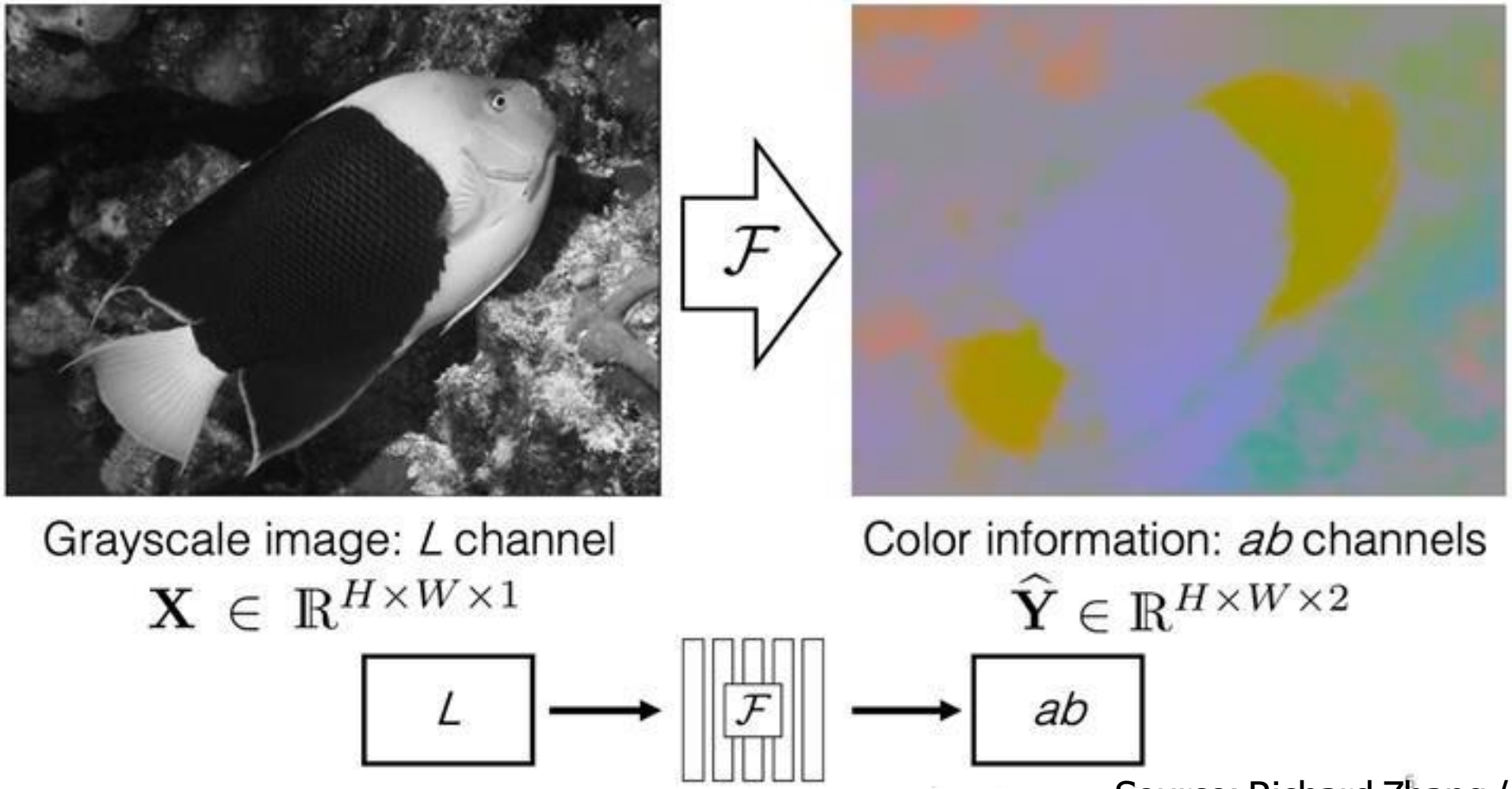
Transfer learned features to supervised learning

Pretraining Method	Supervision	Pretraining time	Classification	Detection	Segmentation
ImageNet [26]	1000 class labels	3 days	78.2%	56.8%	48.0%
Random Gaussian	initialization	< 1 minute	53.3%	43.4%	19.8%
Autoencoder	-	14 hours	53.8%	41.9%	25.2%
Agrawal *et al.* [1]	egomotion	10 hours	52.9%	41.8%	-
Wang *et al.* [39]	motion	1 week	58.7%	47.4%	-
Doersch *et al.* [7]	relative context	4 weeks	55.3%	46.6%	-
Ours	context	14 hours	56.5%	44.5%	30.0%

Self-supervised learning on ImageNet training set, transfer to classification (Pascal VOC 2007), detection (Pascal VOC 2007), and semantic segmentation (Pascal VOC 2012)

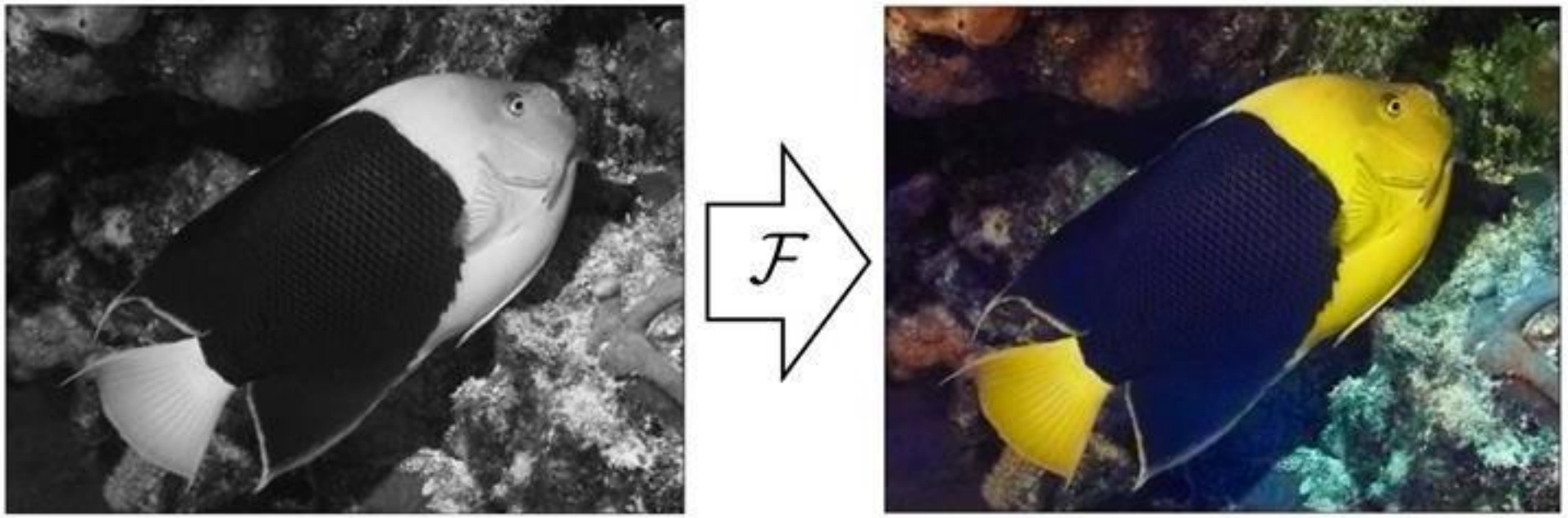
Source: Pathak et al., 2016

Pretext task: image coloring



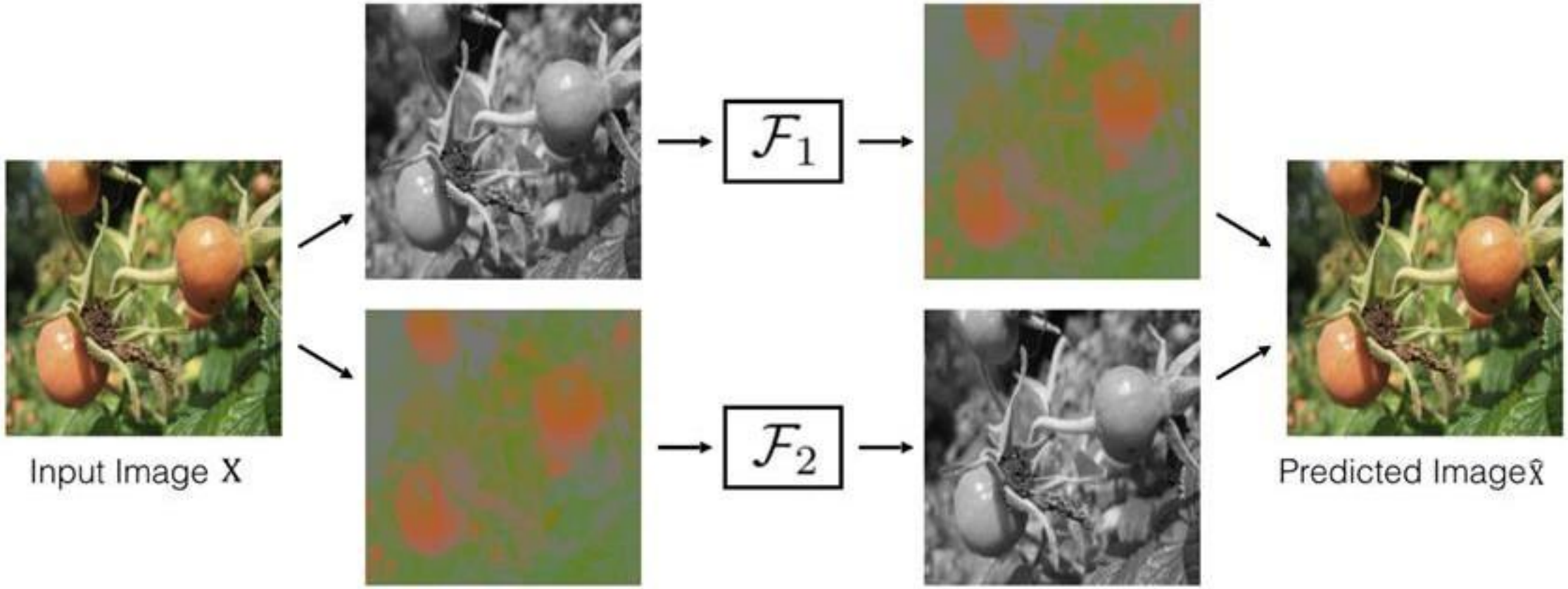
Source: Richard Zhang / Phillip Isola

Pretext task: image coloring



Source: Richard Zhang / Phillip Isola

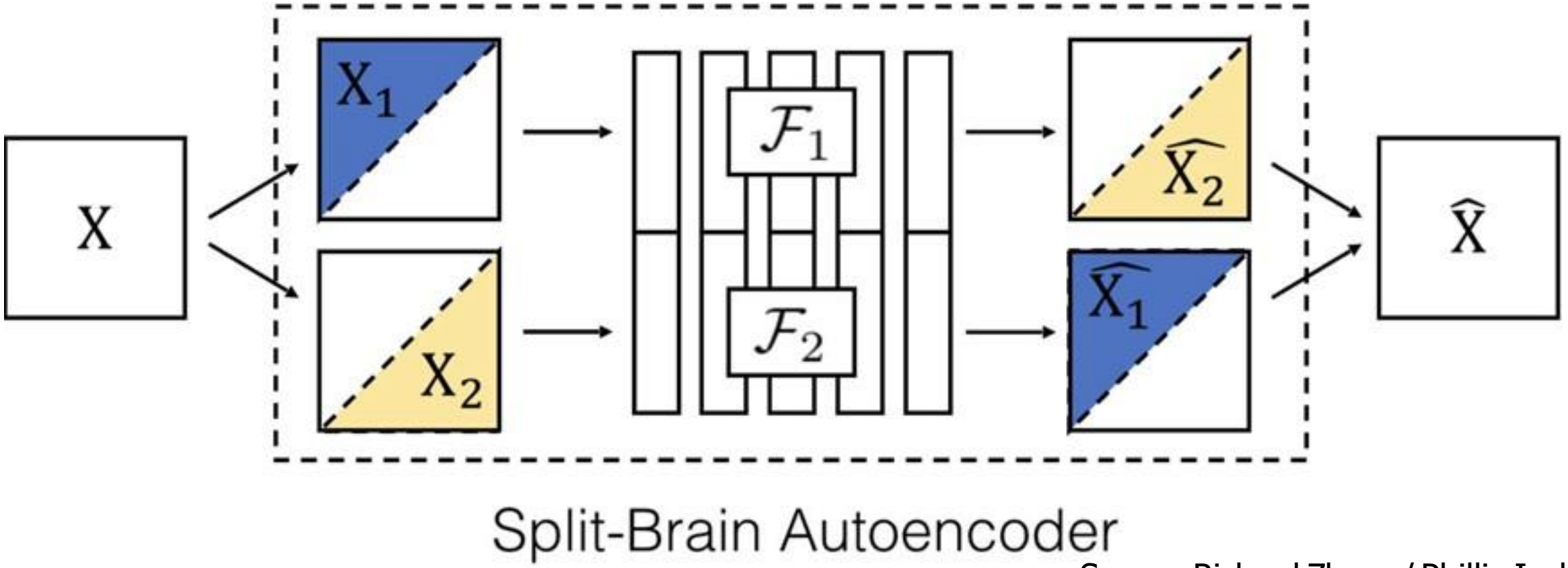
Learning features from colorization: Split-brain Autoencoder



Source: Richard Zhang / Phillip Isola

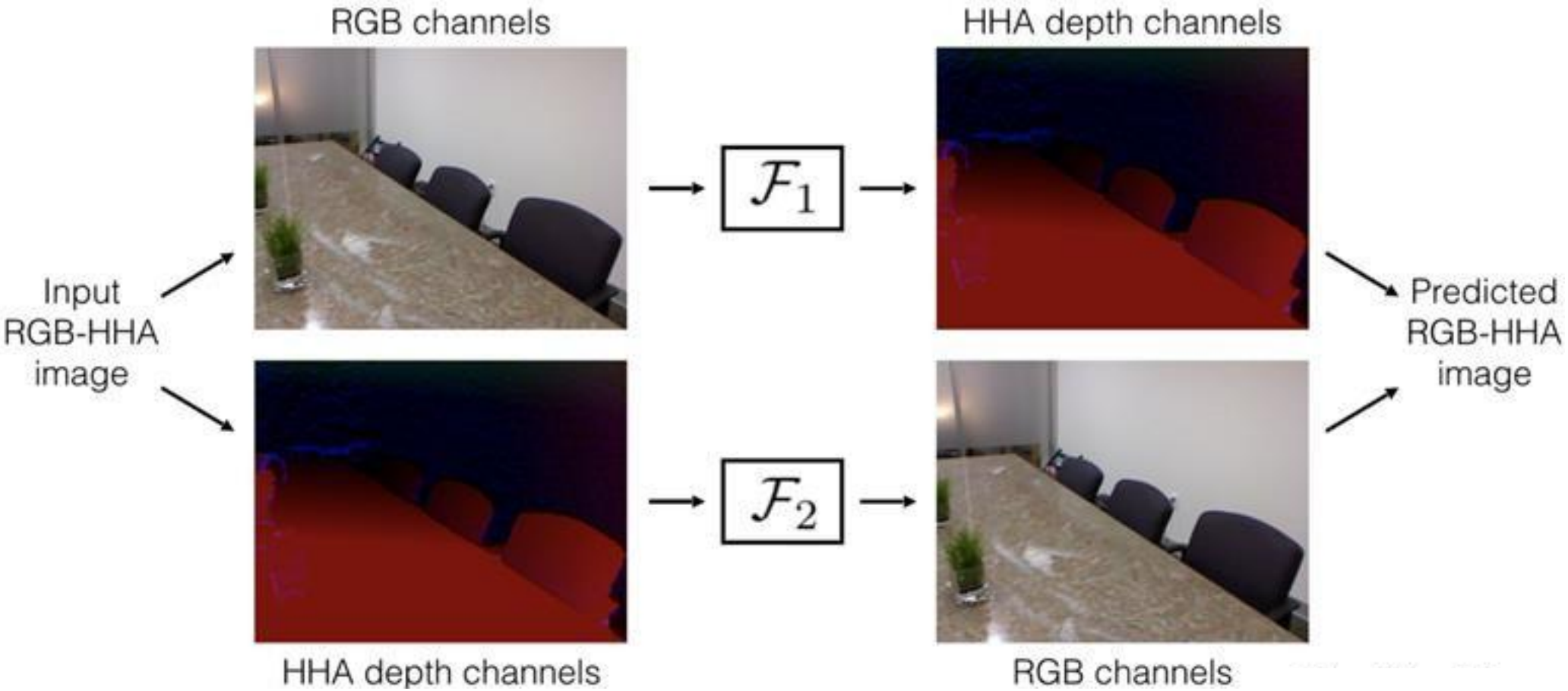
Learning features from colorization: Split-brain Autoencoder

Idea: cross-channel predictions



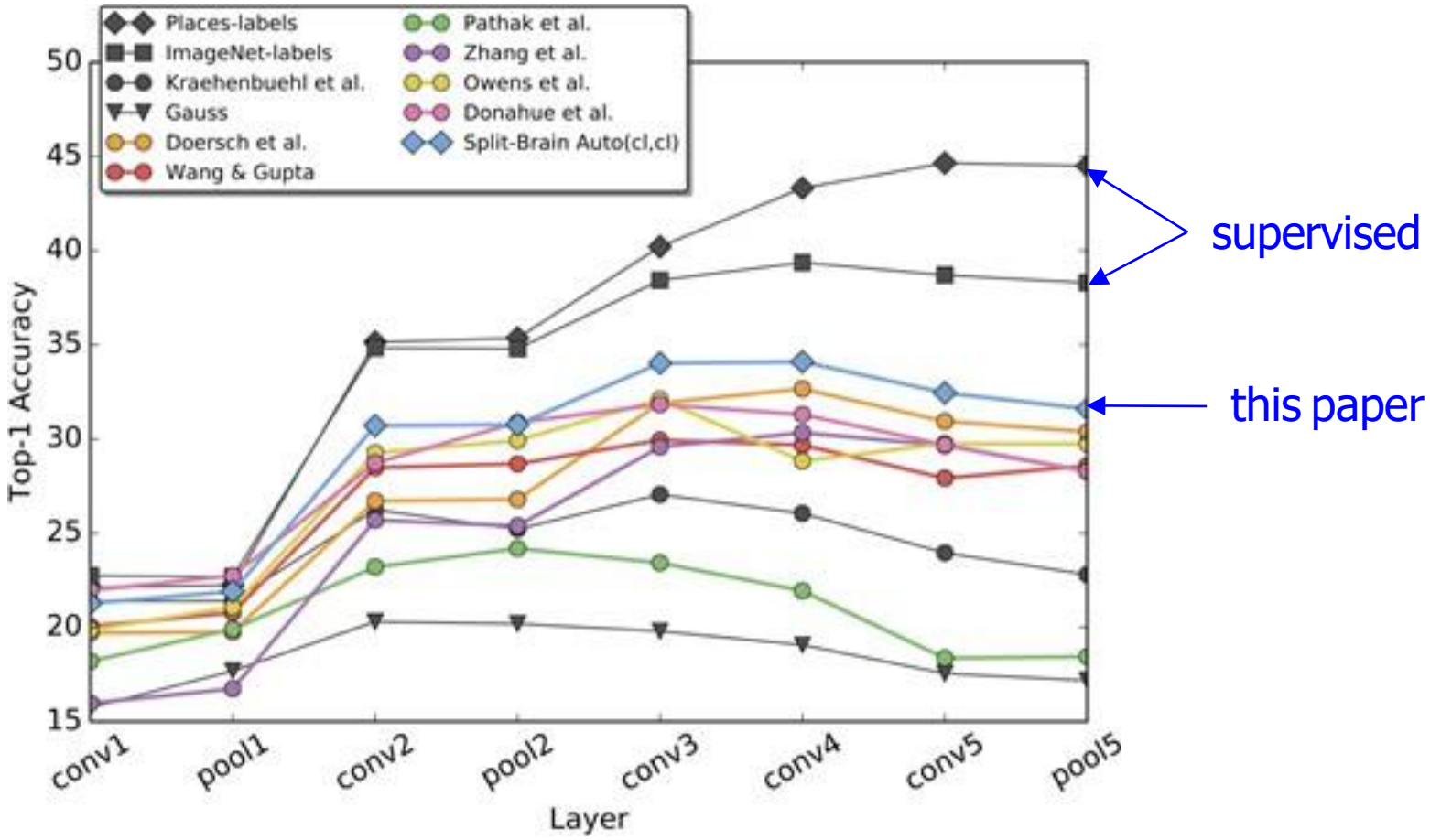
Source: Richard Zhang / Phillip Isola

Learning features from colorization: Split-brain Autoencoder



Source: Richard Zhang / Phillip Isola

Transfer learned features to supervised learning



Self-supervised learning on ImageNet (entire training set).

Use concatenated features from F_1 and F_2

Labeled data is from the Places (Zhou 2016).

Source: Zhang et al., 2017

Pretext task: image coloring



Source: Richard Zhang / Phillip Isola

Pretext task: image coloring



Source: Richard Zhang / Phillip Isola

Pretext task: video coloring

Idea: model the temporal coherence of colors in videos

reference frame

how should I color these frames?



t =0



t =1



t =2



t =3

...

Source: Vondrick et al., 2018

Pretext task: video coloring

Idea: model the temporal coherence of colors in videos

reference frame

how should I color these frames?

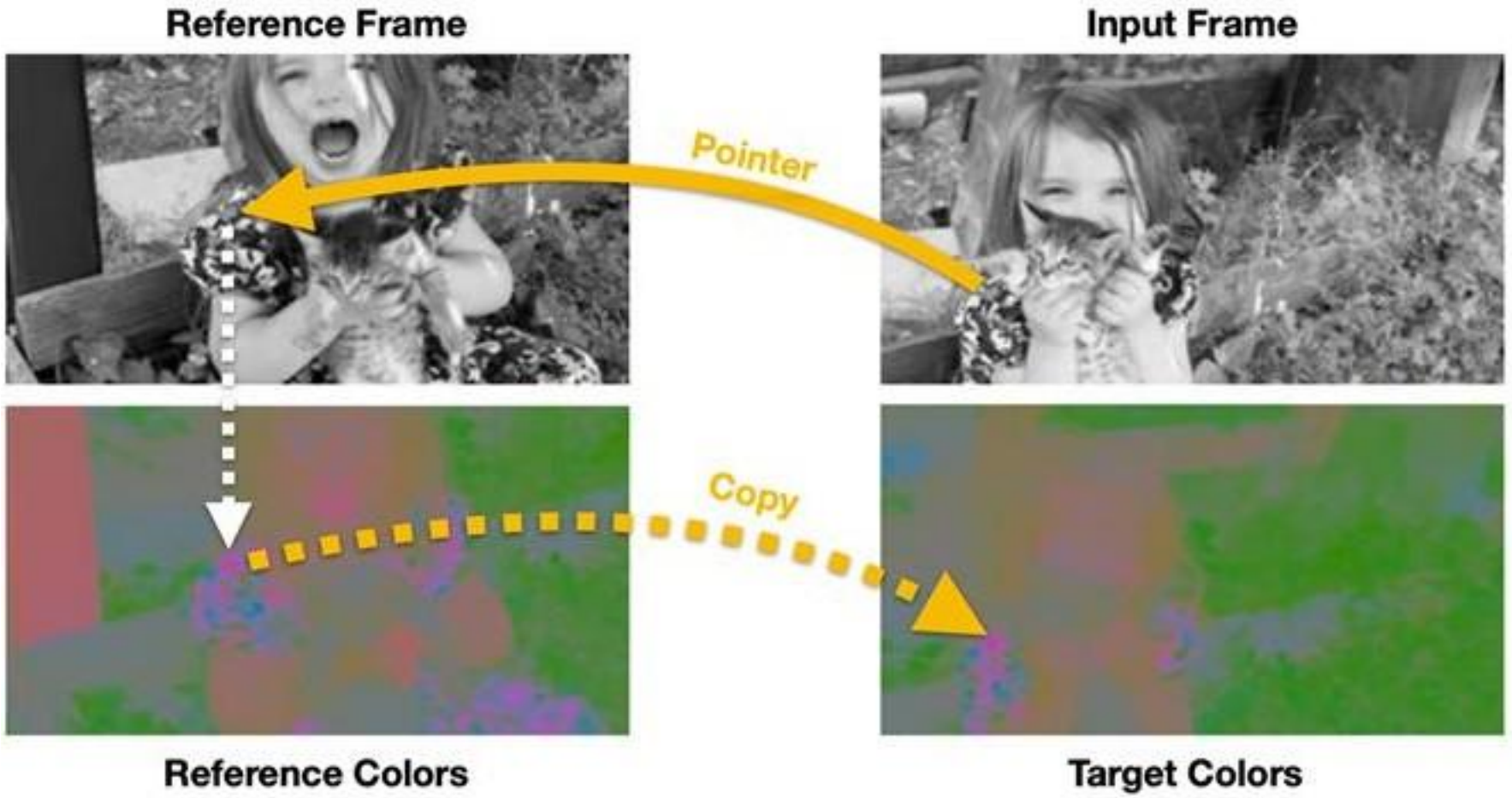
Should be the same color!



Hypothesis: learning to color video frames should allow model to learn to track regions or objects without labels!

Source: Vondrick et al., 2018

Learning to color videos



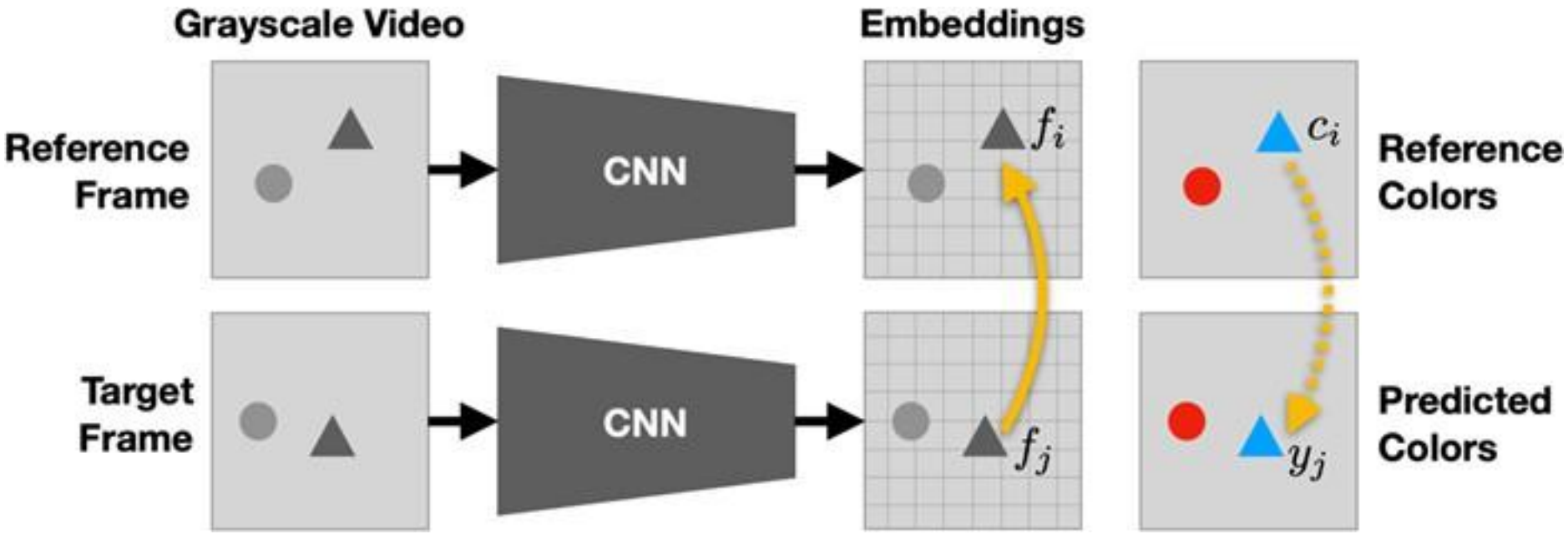
Learning objective:

Establish mappings between reference and target frames in a learned feature space.

Use the mapping as "pointers" to copy the correct color (LAB).

Source: Vondrick et al., 2018

Learning to color videos

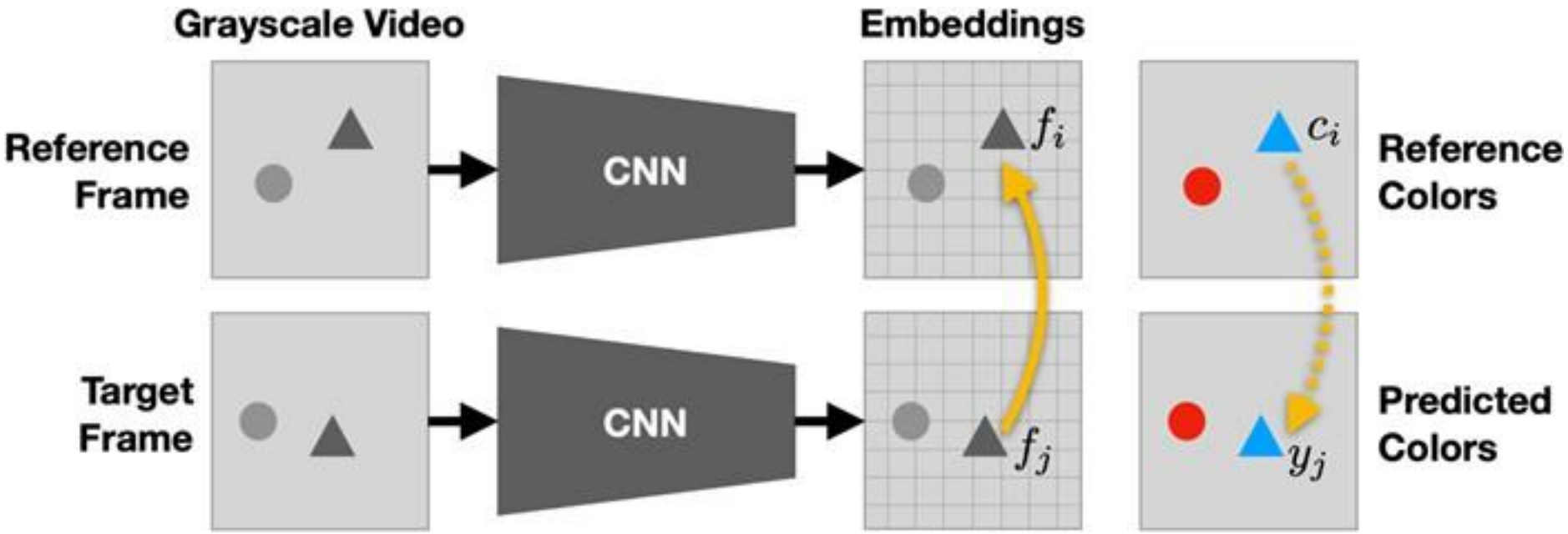


attention map on the reference frame

$$A_{ij} = \frac{\exp\left(f_i^T f_j\right)}{\sum_k \exp\left(f_k^T f_j\right)}$$

Source: Vondrick et al., 2018

Learning to color videos



attention map on the reference frame

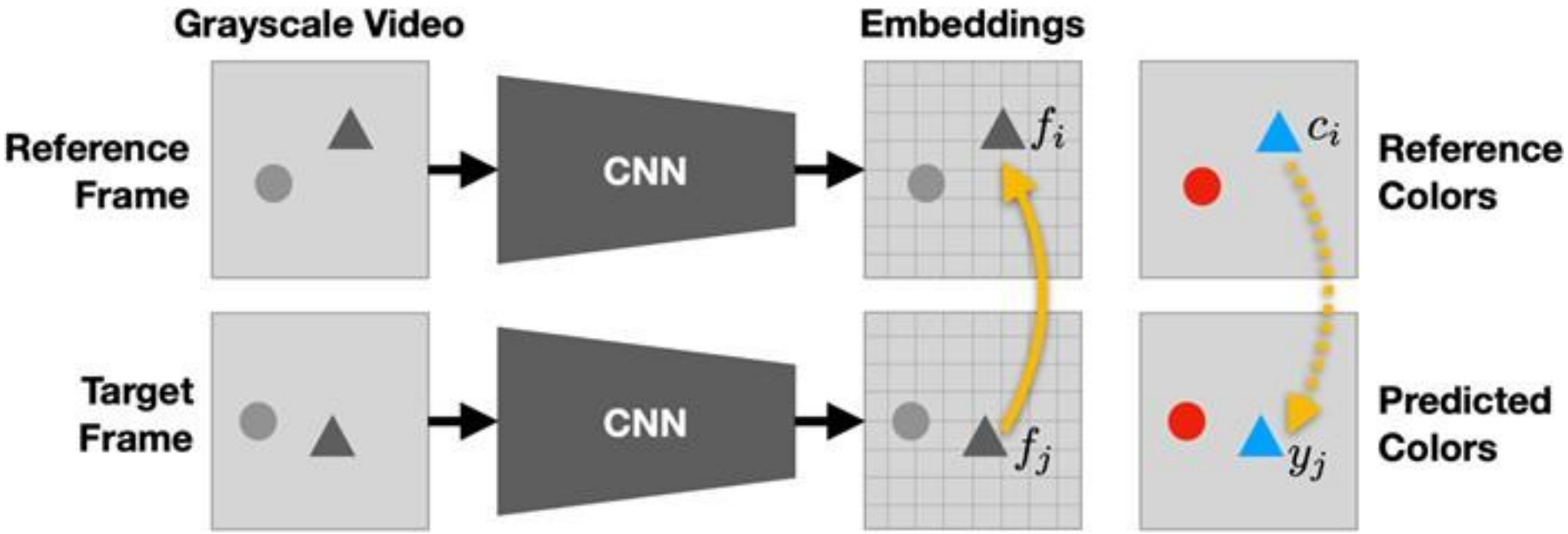
$$A_{ij} = \frac{\exp\left(f_i^T f_j\right)}{\sum_k \exp\left(f_k^T f_j\right)}$$

predicted color =weighted sum of the reference color

$$y_j = \sum_i A_{ij} c_i$$

Source: Vondrick et al., 2018

Learning to color videos



attention map on the reference frame

$$A_{ij} = \frac{\exp\left(f_i^T f_j\right)}{\sum_k \exp\left(f_k^T f_j\right)}$$

predicted color =weighted sum of the reference color

$$y_j = \sum_i A_{ij} c_i$$

loss between predicted color and ground truth color

$$\min_\theta \sum_j \mathcal{L}\left(y_j, c_j\right)$$

Source: [Vondrick et al., 2018]

Colorizing videos (qualitative)

reference frame



target frames (gray)



predicted color



Source: Google AI blog post

Colorizing videos (qualitative)

reference frame



target frames (gray)



predicted color



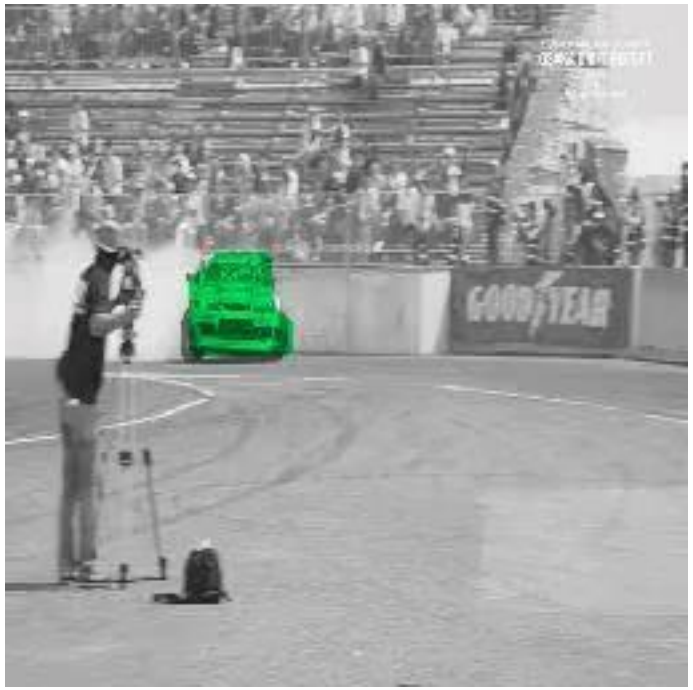
Source: [Google AI blog post]

Tracking emerges from colorization

Propagate segmentation masks using learned attention







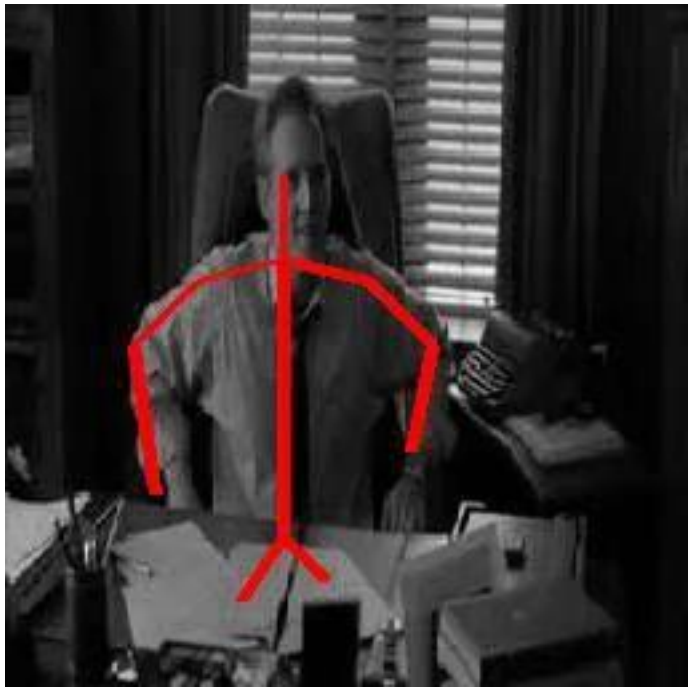
Source: Google AI blog post

Tracking emerges from colorization

Propagate pose keypoints using learned attention

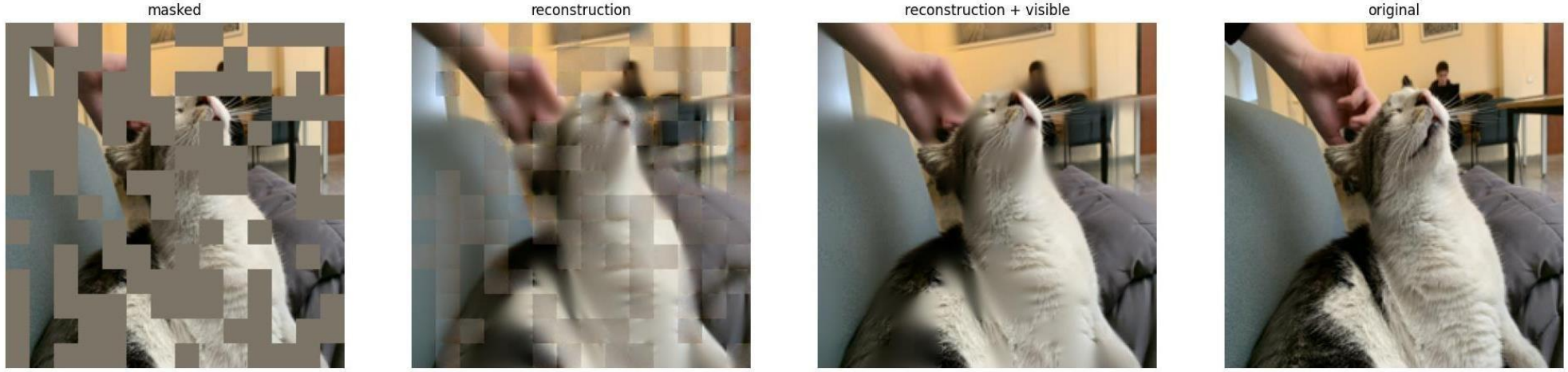




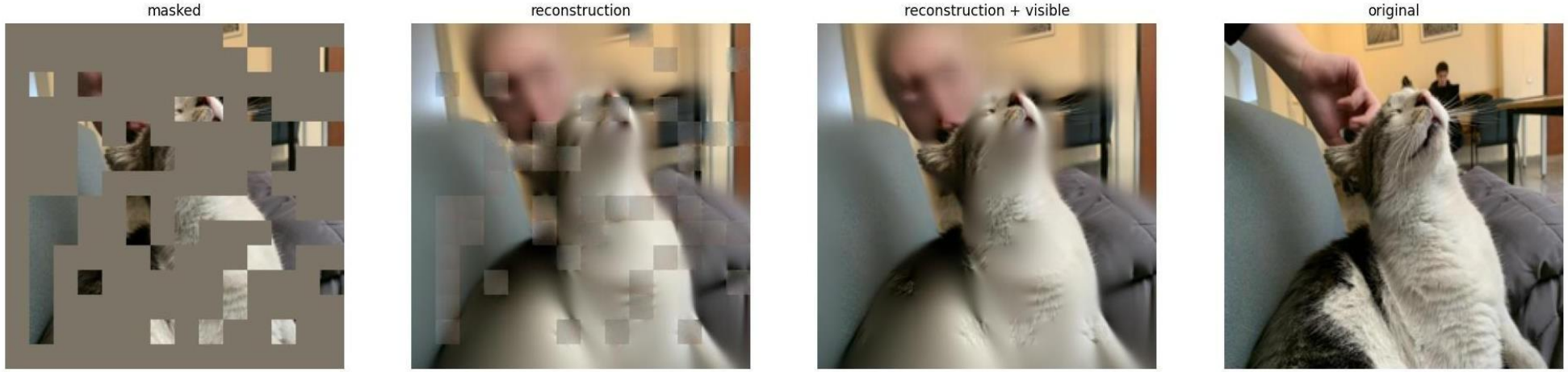


Source: Google AI blog post

Masked Auto Encoders (MAE)
Reconstruction with a larger masked portion



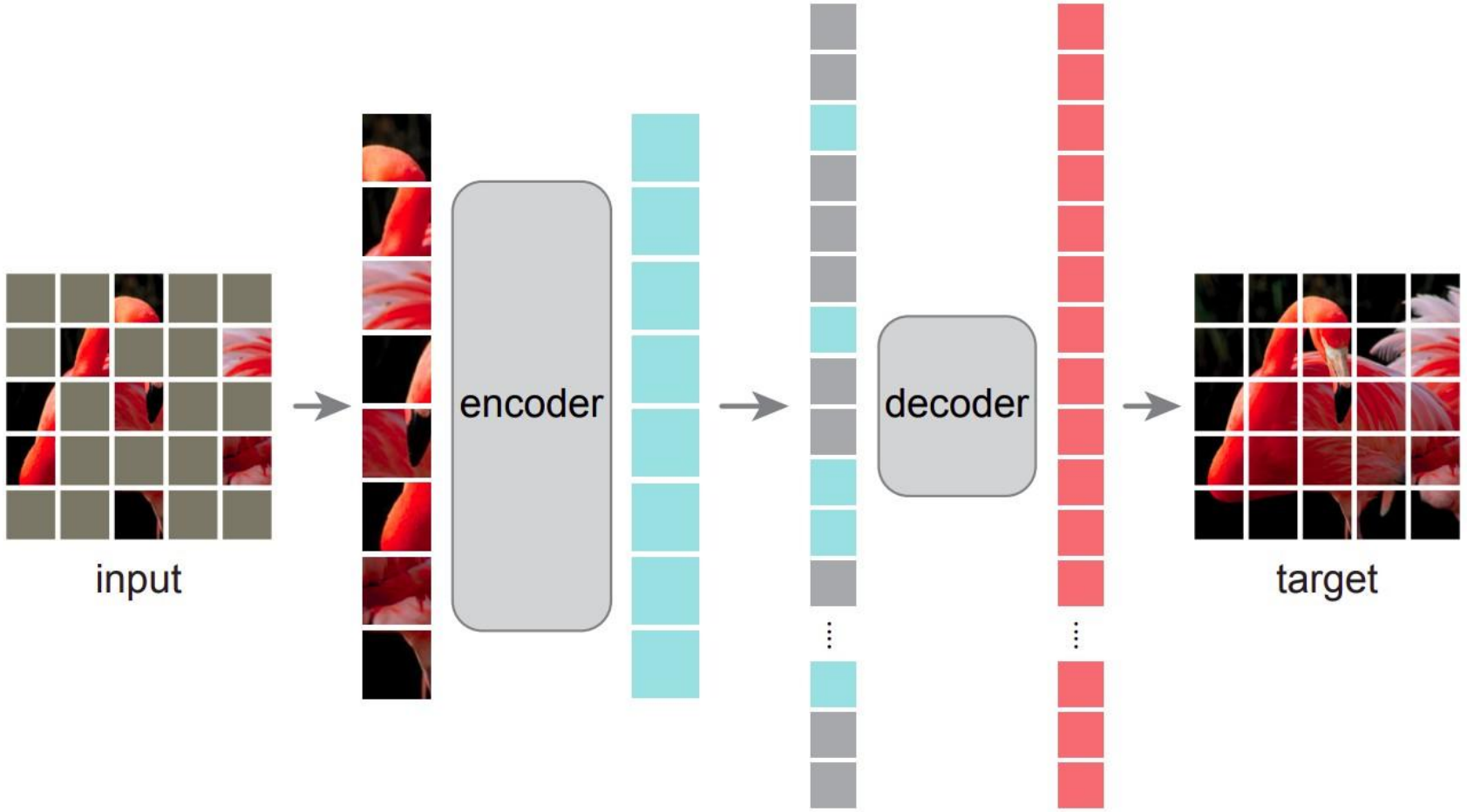
50% masking ratio



75% masking ratio

He et al., 2021 Masked Autoencoders Are Scalable Vision Learners

Masked Auto Encoders (MAE)



He et al., 2021 Masked Autoencoders Are Scalable Vision Learners

Masking Methos

- Similar to the original ViT, divide the input into non-overlapping patches.
- Uniformly sample a very large proportion (75%) of these patches and mask them
- Masking a high ratio makes predicting the task challenging and meaningful.
- Also, not using mask tokens and picking a high sampling ratio (masking most of the image, e.g., 75%, and sampling a small visible portion, e.g., 25%, to feed into the encoder) enables the encoder to be very large.

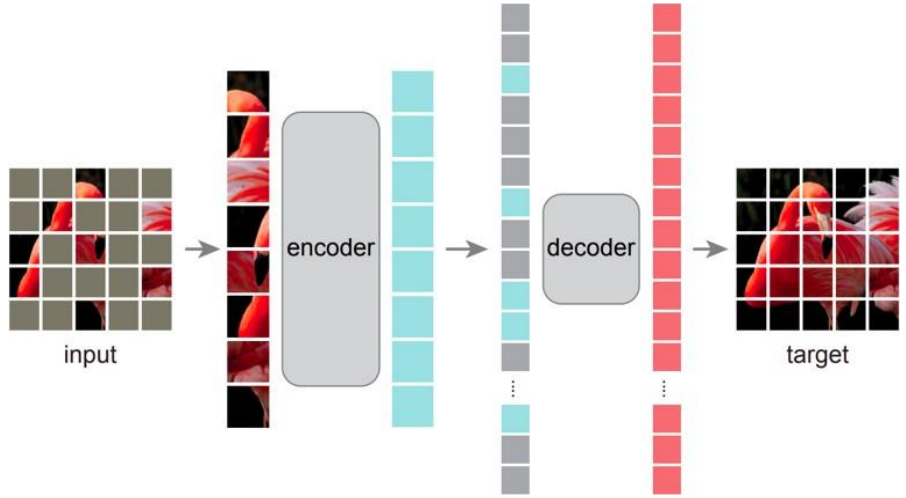


Figure 6. MAE architecture from the paper

He et al., 2021 Masked Autoencoders Are Scalable Vision Learners

MAE Encoder

- The encoder only operates on unmasked patches (25%)
- Embeds the patches by linear projection and add positional embeddings
- Uses transformer blocks
- Since the input patches are a small part of the input, the encoder is chosen to be very large. (encoder has over 9 times computations per token vs decoder)

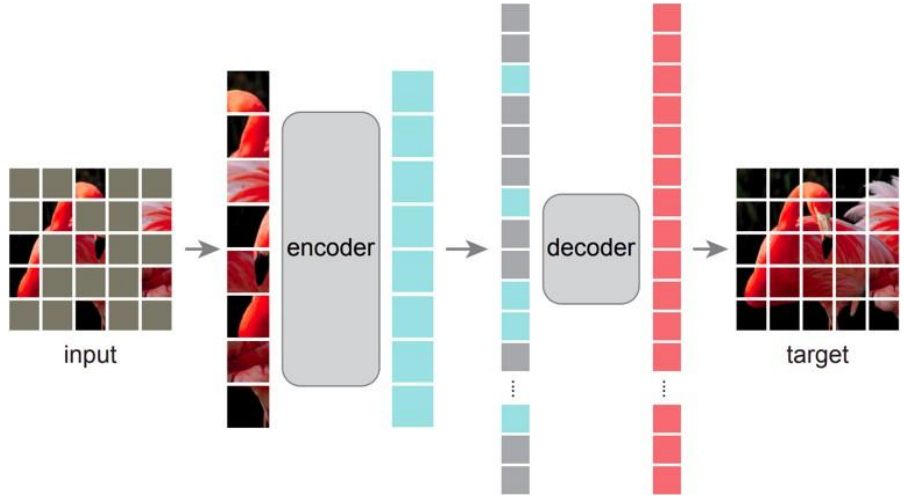


Figure 6. MAE architecture from the paper

He et al., 2021 Masked Autoencoders Are Scalable Vision Learners

MAE Decoder

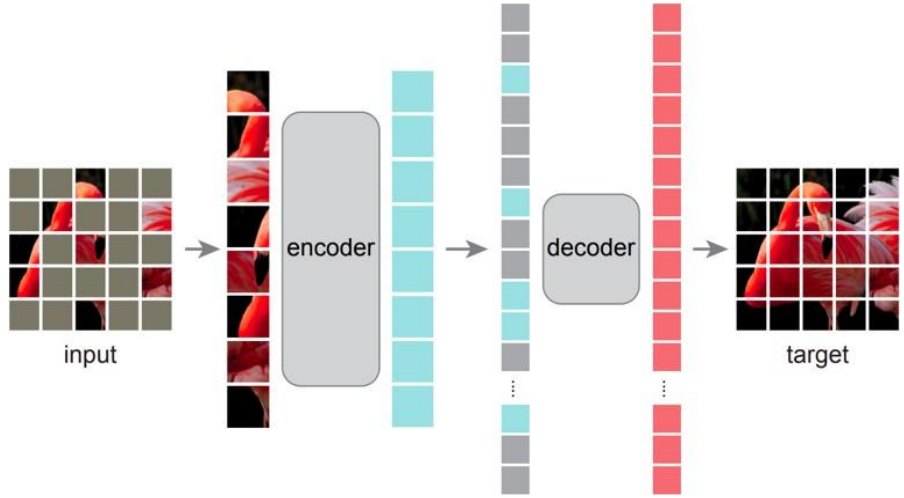


Figure 6. MAE architecture from the paper

- Merges the encoder outputs with the shared mask tokens in previously masked places, adding positional encodings to them.
- Uses transformer blocks, followed by a linear projection for finalizing pixel reconstruction.
- Is solely responsible for reconstruction, meaning it is not used post-training. Hence, it is independent of the encoder design, making it flexible (unlike traditional AEs or UNet). This is an asymmetrical autoencoder design.

He et al., 2021 Masked Autoencoders Are Scalable Vision Learners

Reconstruction

- The MSE (mean squared error loss) in the pixel space between the input image and the reconstructed image is adopted.

- Loss is only computed for masked patches

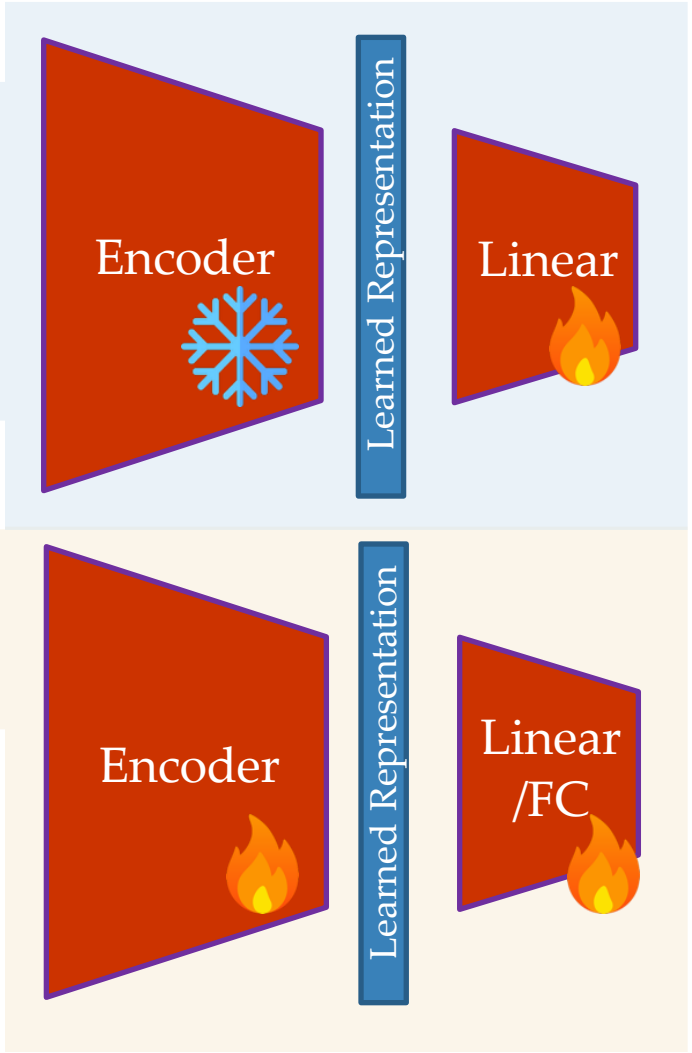
He et al., 2021 Masked Autoencoders Are Scalable Vision Learners

Linear Probing vs Full Fine-tuning

- In linear probing, the pre-trained model is fixed, and only one linear layer is added at the end, to predict the labels (or produce the output). This method is used to assess the quality of representations from a pre-trained feature extraction model.

- In fine-tuning, pre-trained model is further trained (not fixed), and one or more layers, possibly with non-linearities are added.

- linear probing: provides a measure of representation quality of a pre-training in restricted conditions
- fine-tuning: exploits models near-true potential to adopt for new tasks

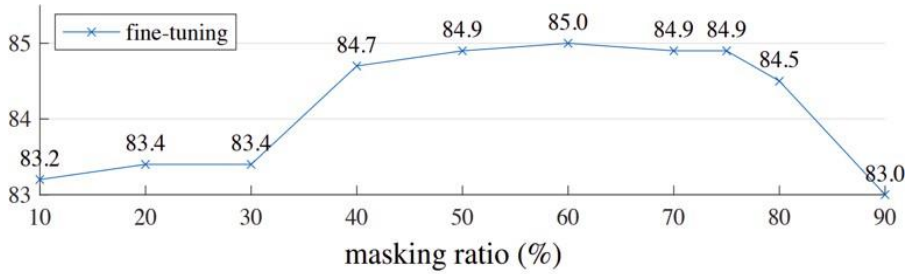


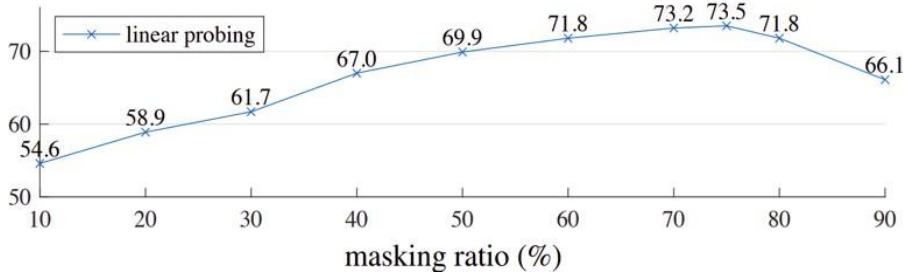
He et al., 2021 Masked Autoencoders Are Scalable Vision Learners

Ablation Studies

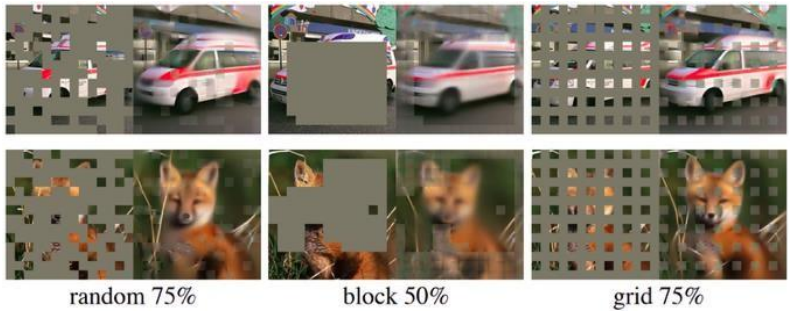
So many modeling/hyperparameter choices:

- Masking ratio
- Decoder depth
- Decoder width
- Mask token (used or not in encoder)
- Reconstruction target
- Data augmentation
- Mask sampling method
- Training schedule



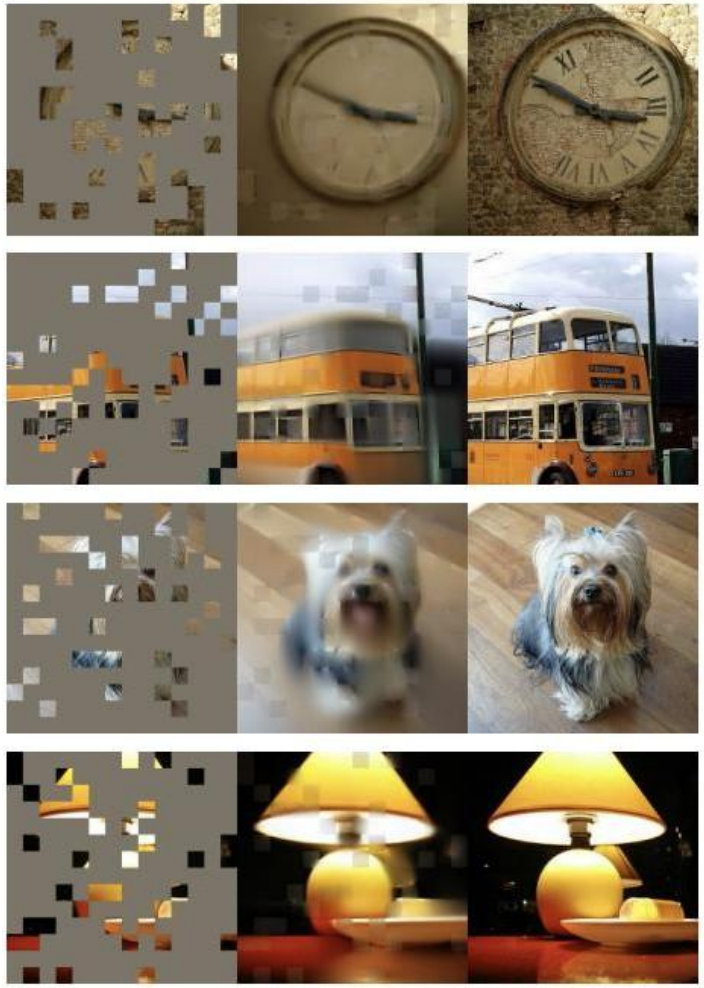


case	ratio	ft	lin
random	75	**84.9**	**73.5**
block	50	83.9	72.3
block	75	82.8	63.9
grid	75	84.0	66.0



He et al., 2021 Masked Autoencoders Are Scalable Vision Learners

Masked Autoencoder – Comparisons



method	pre-train data	ViT-B	ViT-L	ViT-H	ViT-H_{448}
scratch, our impl.	-	82.3	82.6	83.1	-
DINO [5]	IN1K	82.8	-	-	-
MoCo v3 [9]	IN1K	83.2	84.1	-	-
BEiT [2]	IN1K+DALLE	83.2	85.2	-	-
MAE	IN1K	83.6	85.9	86.9	**87.8**

He et al., 2021 Masked Autoencoders Are Scalable Vision Learners

Summary: pretext tasks from image transformations

- Pretext tasks focus on "visual common sense", e.g., predict rotations, inpainting, rearrangement, and colorization.
- The models are forced learn good features about natural images, e.g., semantic representation of an object category, in order to solve the pretext tasks.
- We often do not care about the performance of these pretext tasks, but rather how useful the learned features are for downstream tasks (classification, detection, segmentation).

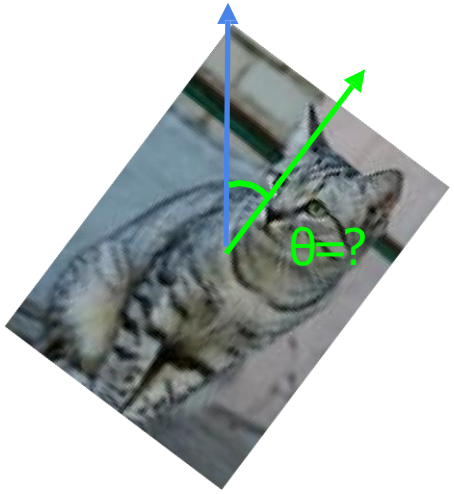
Summary: pretext tasks from image transformations

- Pretext tasks focus on "visual common sense", e.g., predict rotations, inpainting, rearrangement, and colorization.
- The models are forced learn good features about natural images, e.g., semantic representation of an object category, in order to solve the pretext tasks.
- We often do not care about the performance of these pretext tasks, but rather how useful the learned features are for downstream tasks (classification, detection, segmentation).
- Problems: 1) coming up with individual pretext tasks is tedious, and 2) the learned representations may not be general.

Pretext tasks from image transformations



image completion



rotation prediction



"jigsaw puzzle"

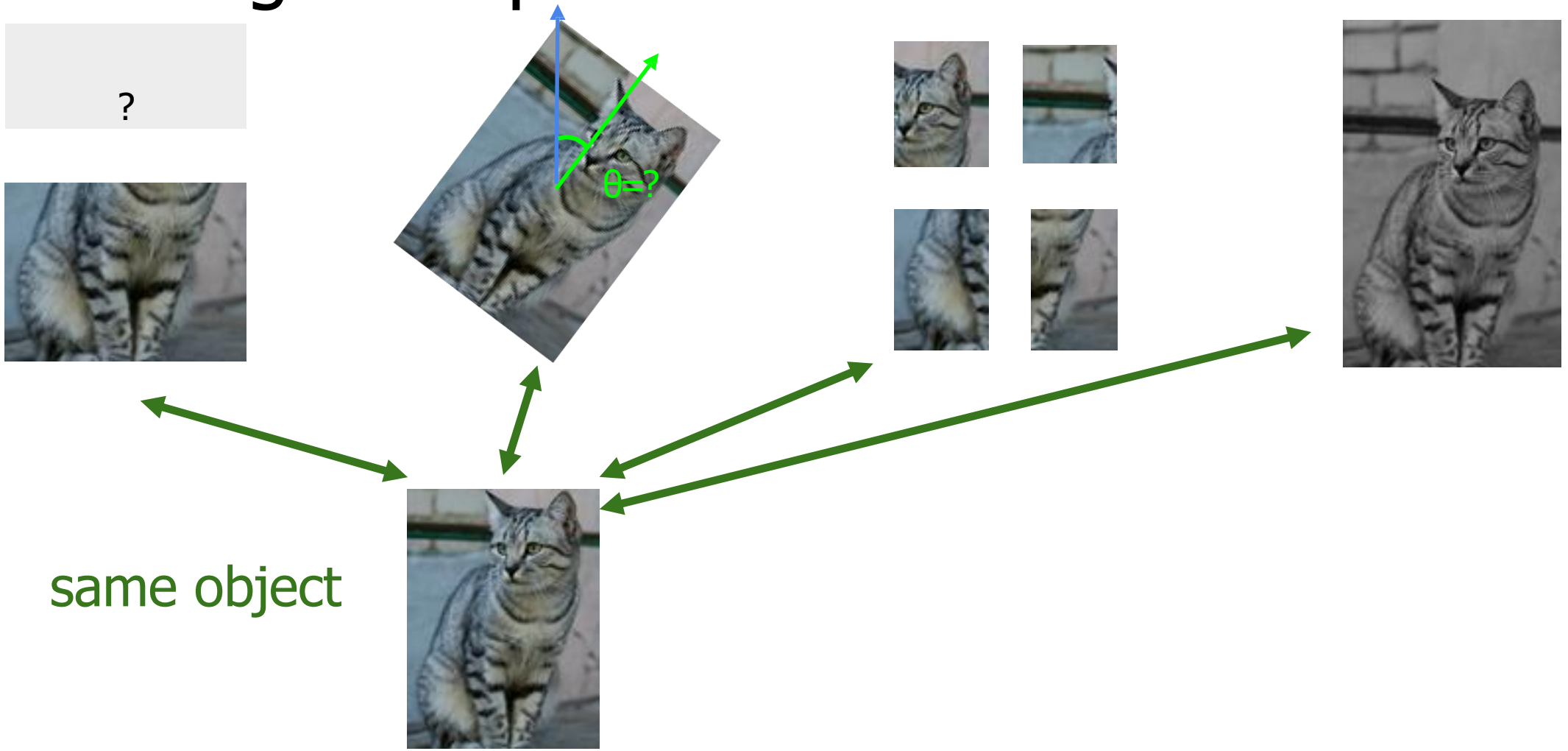


colorization

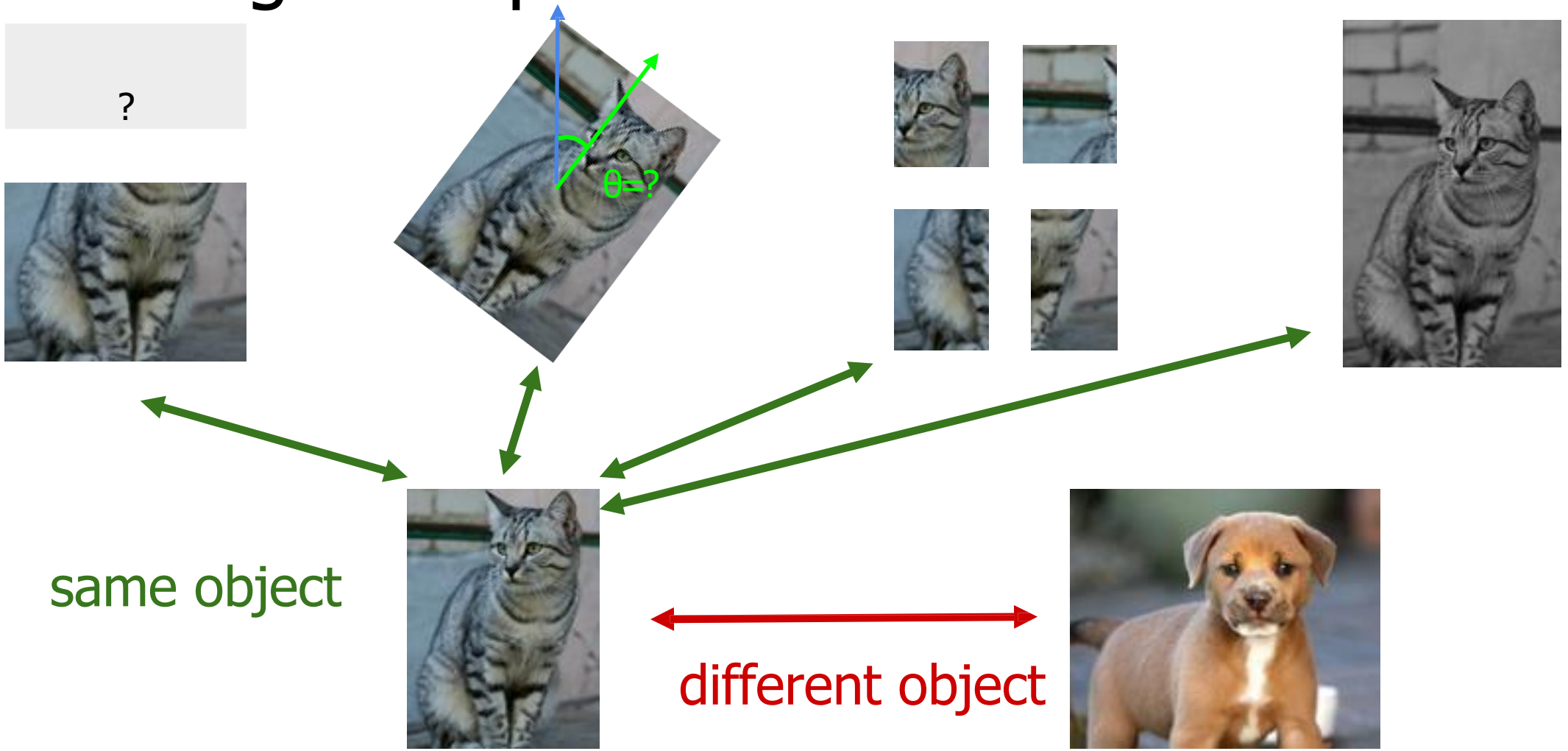
Learned representations may be tied to a specific pretext task!

Can we come up with a more general pretext task?

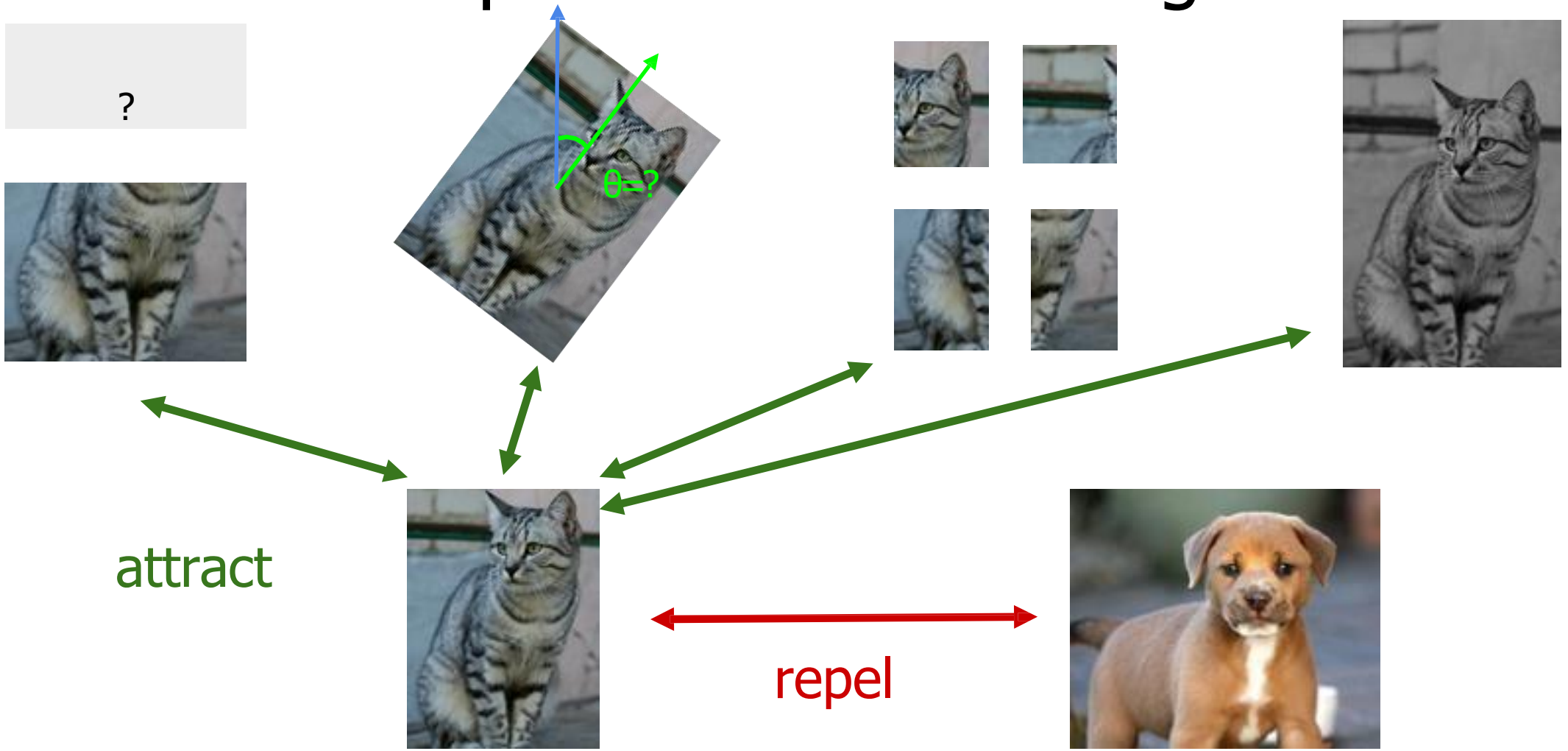
A more general pretext task?



A more general pretext task?



Contrastive Representation Learning



Outline

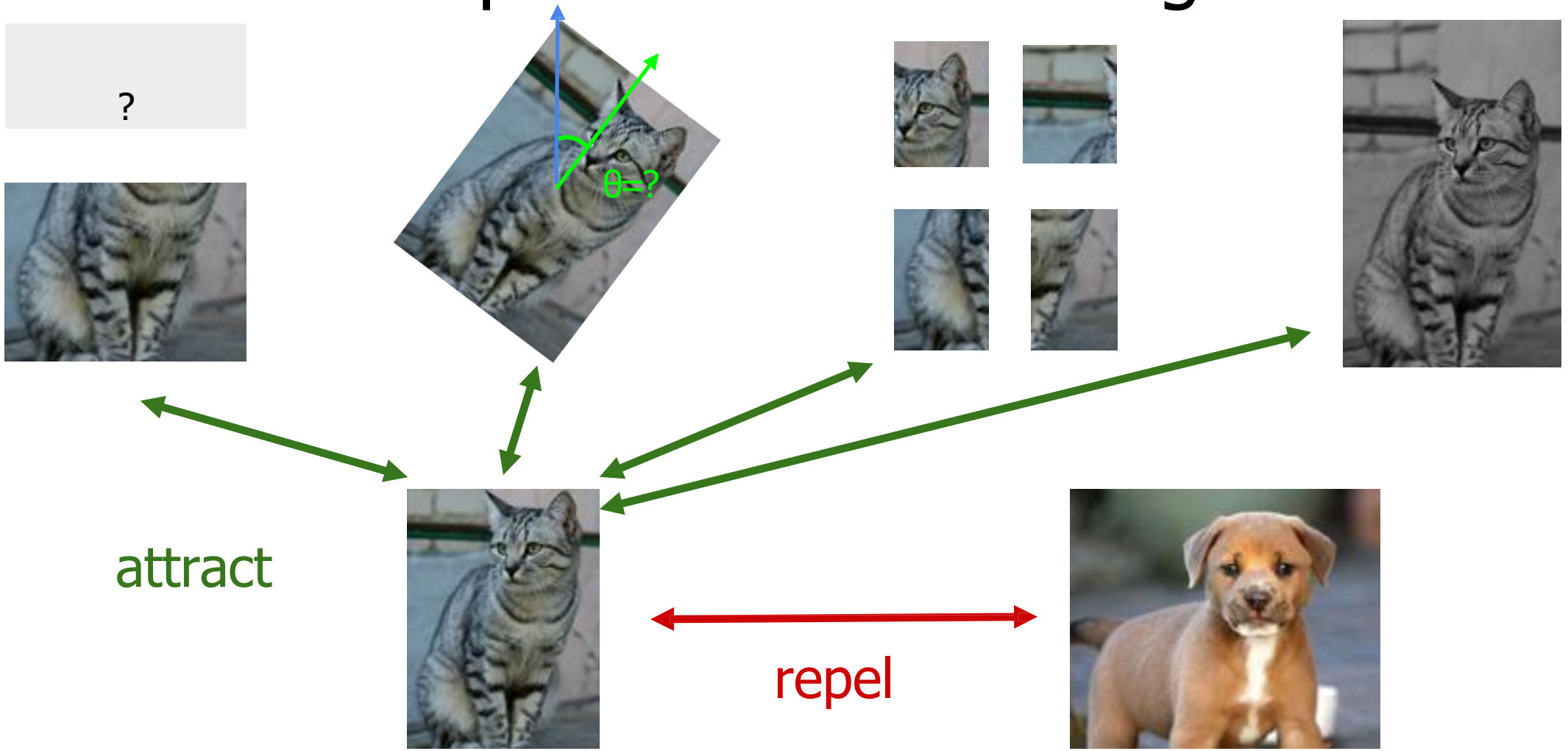
Pretext tasks from image transformations

- Rotation, inpainting, rearrangement, coloring
- Reconstruction-based learning (MAE)

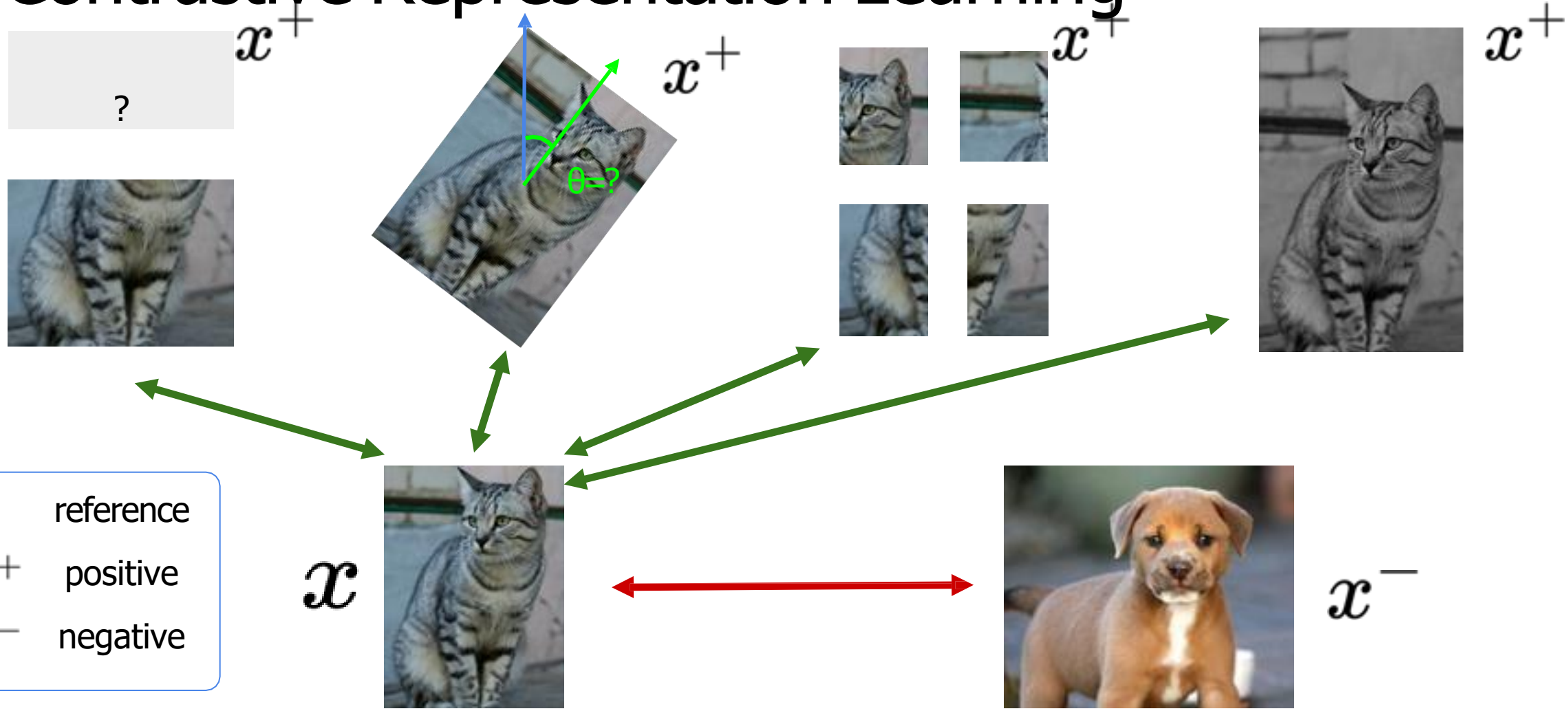
Contrastive representation learning

- Intuition and formulation
- Instance contrastive learning: SimCLR and MOCO
- Contrastive learning without negatives: BYOL, SimSiam
- Self-Distillation Without Labels, DINO

Contrastive Representation Learning



Contrastive Representation Learning



A formulation of contrastive learning

What we want:

$$\text{score}(f(x), f(x^+)) >> \text{score}(f(x), f(x^-))$$

x: reference sample; x^+ positive sample; x^- negative sample

Given a chosen score function, we aim to learn an encoder function f that yields high score for positive pairs (x, x^+) and low scores for negative pairs (x, x^-).

A formulation of contrastive learning

Loss function given 1 positive sample and N - 1 negative samples:

$$L = -\mathbb{E}_X \left[\log \frac{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+))}{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+)) + \sum_{j=1}^{N-1} \exp(s(f(x), f(x_j^-))} \right]$$

A formulation of contrastive learning

Loss function given 1 positive sample and N - 1 negative samples:

$$L = -\mathbb{E}_X \left[\log \frac{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+))}{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+)) + \sum_{j=1}^{N-1} \exp(s(f(x), f(x_j^-))} \right]$$



x



x^+



x



x_1^-



x_2^-



x_3^-

...

A formulation of contrastive learning

Loss function given 1 positive sample and N - 1 negative samples:

$$L = -\mathbb{E}_X \left[\log \frac{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+))}{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+)) + \sum_{j=1}^{N-1} \exp(s(f(x), f(x_j^-))} \right]$$

score for the positive pair

score for the N-1 negative pairs

This seems familiar …

A formulation of contrastive learning

Loss function given 1 positive sample and N - 1 negative samples:

$$L = -\mathbb{E}_X \left[\log \frac{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+))}{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+)) + \sum_{j=1}^{N-1} \exp(s(f(x), f(x_j^-))} \right]$$

score for the positive pair

score for the N-1 negative pairs

This seems familiar …

Cross entropy loss for a N-way softmax classifier!

I.e., learn to find the positive sample from the N samples

A formulation of contrastive learning

Loss function given 1 positive sample and N - 1 negative samples:

$$L = -\mathbb{E}_X \left[\log \frac{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+))}{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+)) + \sum_{j=1}^{N-1} \exp(s(f(x), f(x_j^-))} \right]$$

Commonly known as the InfoNCE loss (van den Oord et al., 2018)

A lower bound on the mutual information between f(x) and $f(x^+)$

$$MI[f(x), f(x^+)] - \log(N) \geq -L$$

The larger the negative sample size (N), the tighter the bound

Detailed derivation: Poole et al., 2019

SimCLR: A Simple Framework for Contrastive Learning

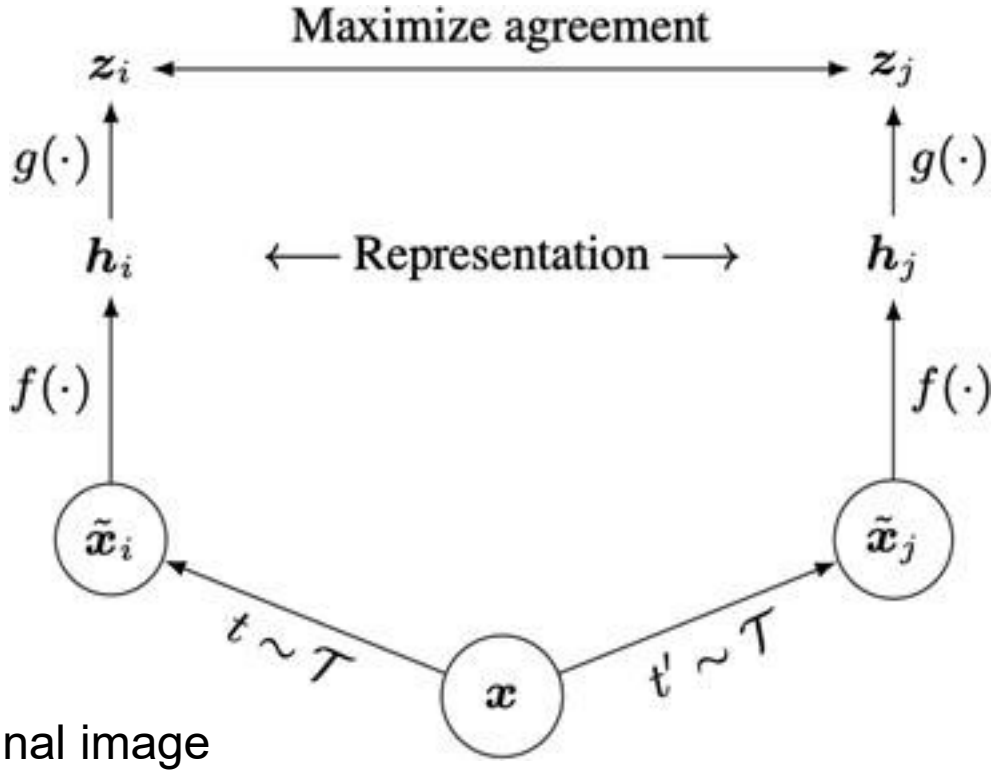
Cosine similarity as the score function:

$$s(u, v) = \frac{u^T v}{||u||||v||}$$

Use a projection network g(·) to project features to a space where contrastive learning is applied

Generate positive samples through data augmentation:

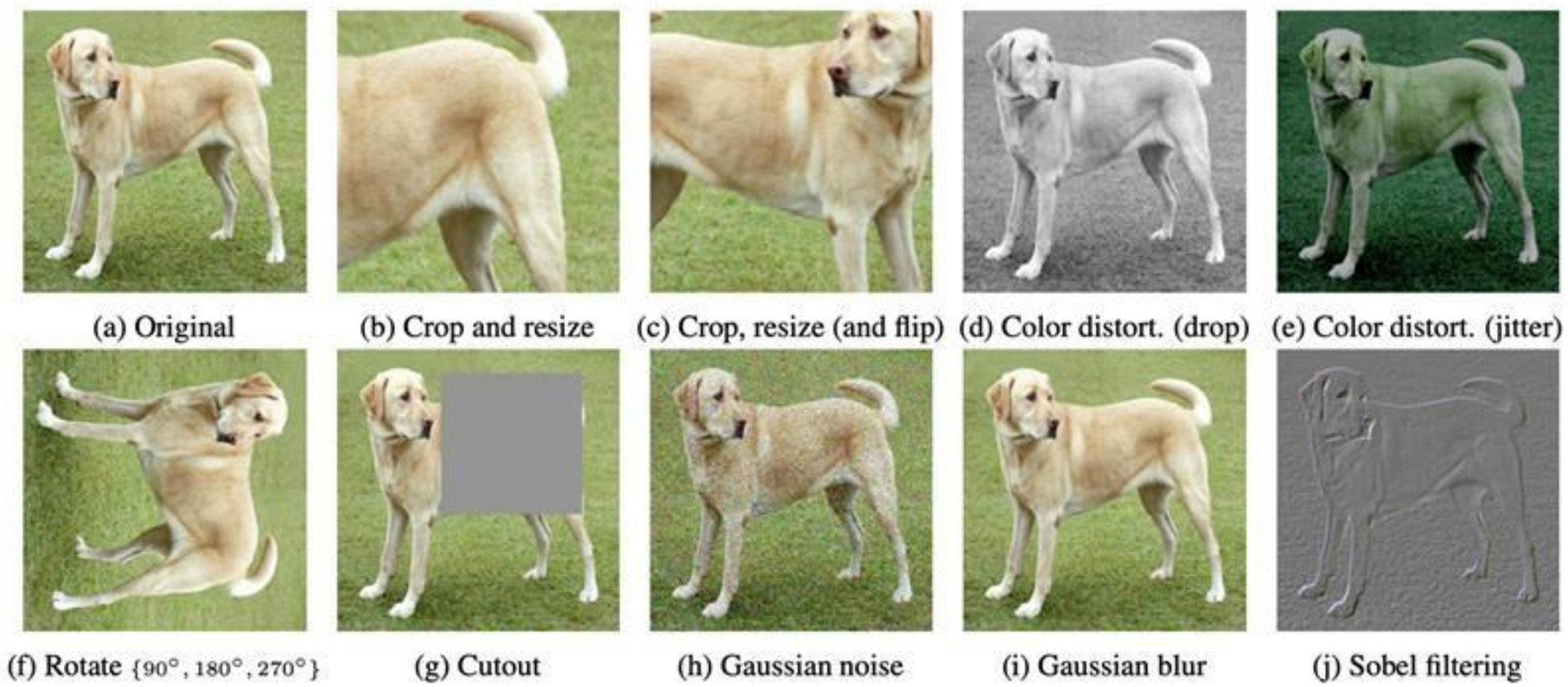
- random cropping, random color distortion, and random blur.



- x: original image
- t, t': sampled augmentations
- $f()$: encoder
- $g()$: projector
- z_i, z_j: embeddings

Source: Chen et al., 2020

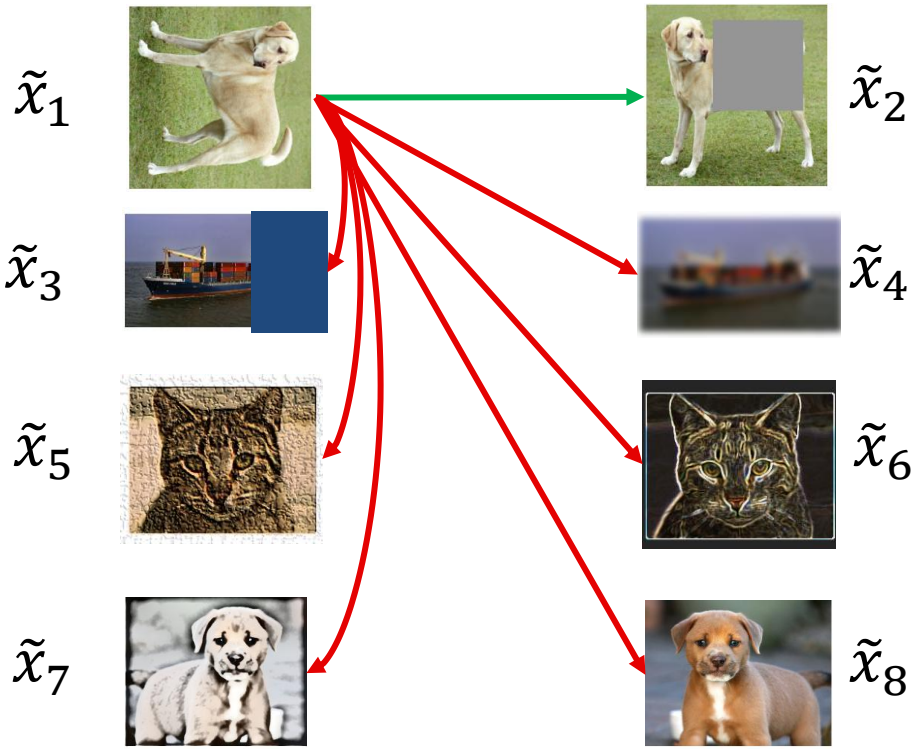
SimCLR: generating positive samples from data augmentation



Source: Chen et al., 2020

SimCLR

Positives are augmented view of the same instance/sample
Negatives are all the other samples



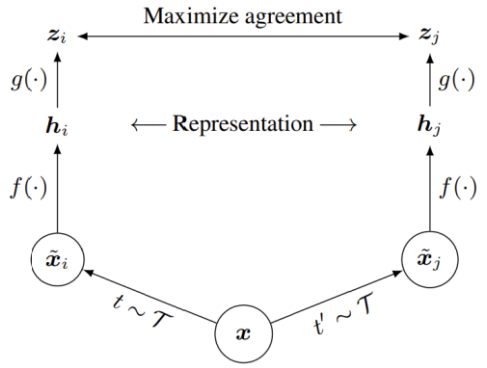
Increase
Cosine Similarity

$$s_{1,2} = s(z_1, z_2) = \frac{z_1 \cdot z_2}{||z_1||\ ||z_2||}$$

Decrease
Cosine Similarity

$$s_{1,j} = s(z_1, z_j) = \frac{z_1 \cdot z_j}{||z_1||\ ||z_j||}$$

$$where \quad j \neq 1, 2$$



- x: original image
- t, t': sampled augmentations
- $\tilde{x}_i$, $\tilde{x}_j$: augmented *views*

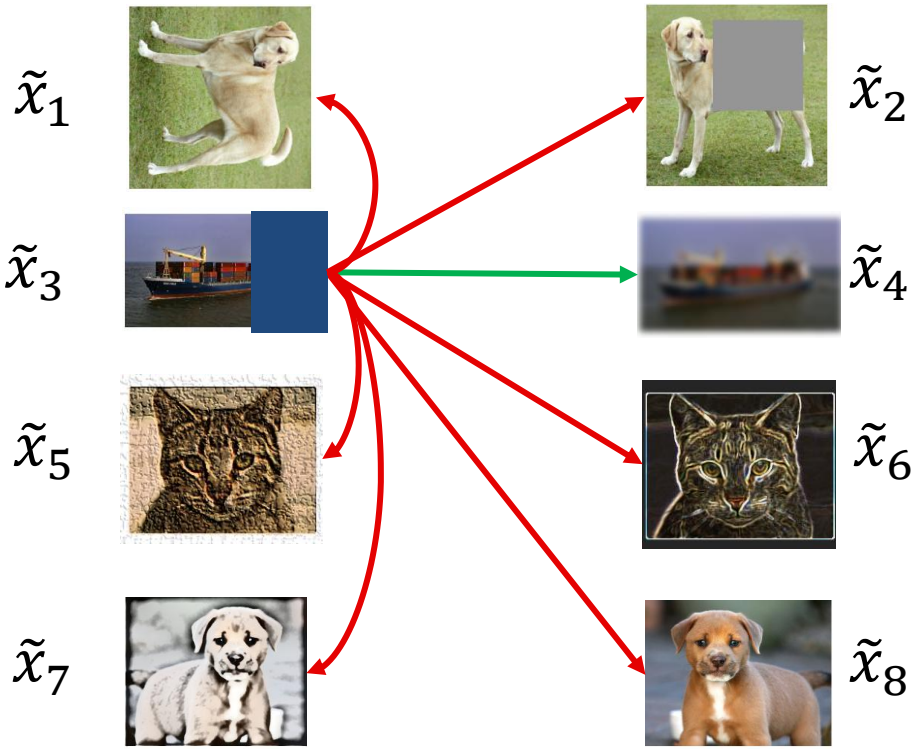
- $f()$: encoder
- h_i, h_j: representations

- $g()$: projector
- z_i, z_j: embeddings

A Simple Framework for Contrastive Learning of Visual Representations (Chen et al. ICML et al. 2020)

SimCLR

Positives are augmented view of the same instance/sample
Negatives are all the other samples



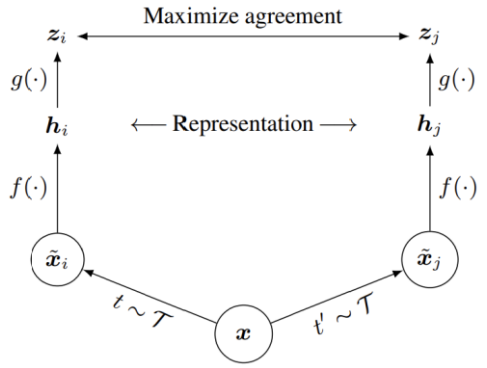
Increase
Cosine Similarity

$$s_{3,4} = s(z_3, z_4) = \frac{z_3 \cdot z_4}{||z_3||\ ||z_4||}$$

Decrease
Cosine Similarity

$$s_{3,j} = s(z_3, z_j) = \frac{z_3 \cdot z_j}{||z_3||\ ||z_j||}$$

$$where \quad j \neq 3, 4$$



- x: original image
- t, t': sampled augmentations
- $\tilde{x}_i$, $\tilde{x}_j$: augmented *views*

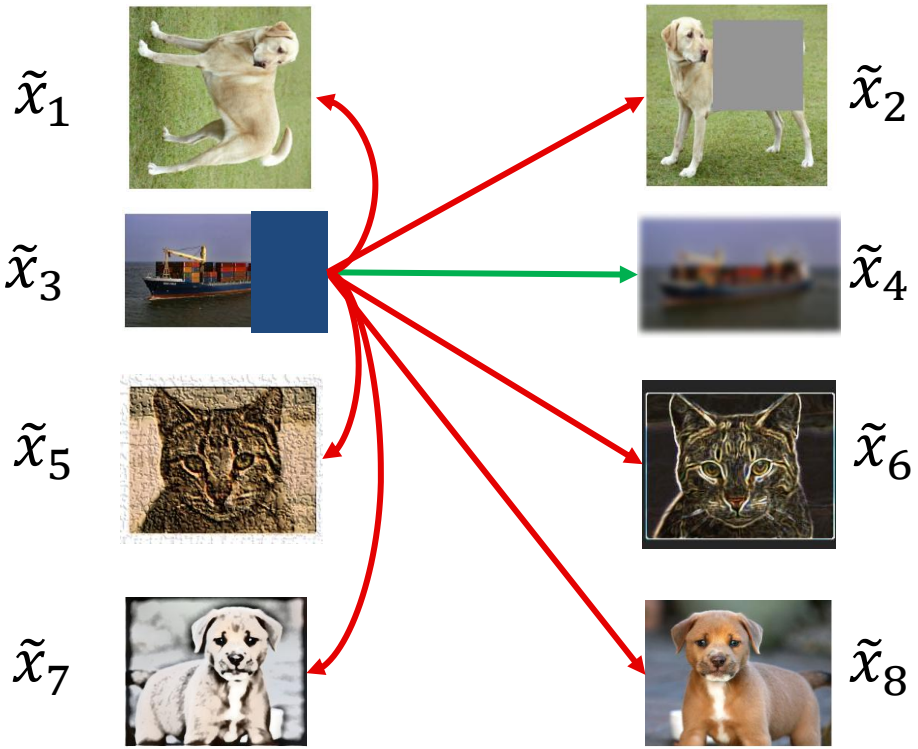
- $f()$: encoder
- h_i, h_j: representations

- $g()$: projector
- z_i, z_j: embeddings

A Simple Framework for Contrastive Learning of Visual Representations (Chen et al. ICML et al. 2020)

SimCLR

Positives are augmented view of the same instance/sample
Negatives are all the other samples



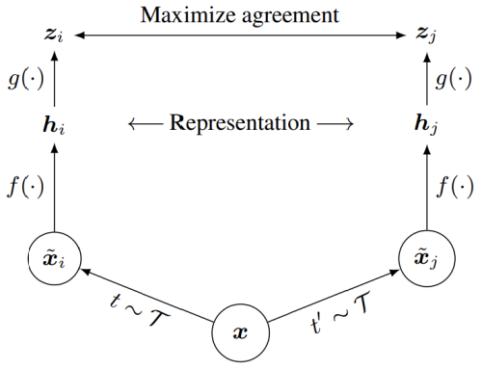
Increase Cosine Similarity

$$s_{2i-1,\,2i} = \frac{\tilde{x}_{2i-1} \cdot \tilde{x}_{2i}}{||\tilde{x}_{2i-1}||\ ||\tilde{x}_{2i}||}$$

Decrease Cosine Similarity

$$s_{2i-1,\,j} = \frac{\tilde{x}_{2i-1} \cdot \tilde{x}_{j}}{||\tilde{x}_{2i-1}||\ ||\tilde{x}_{j}||}$$

$$where \quad j \neq 2i$$



- x: original image
- t, t': sampled augmentations
- $\tilde{x}_i$, $\tilde{x}_j$: augmented *views*

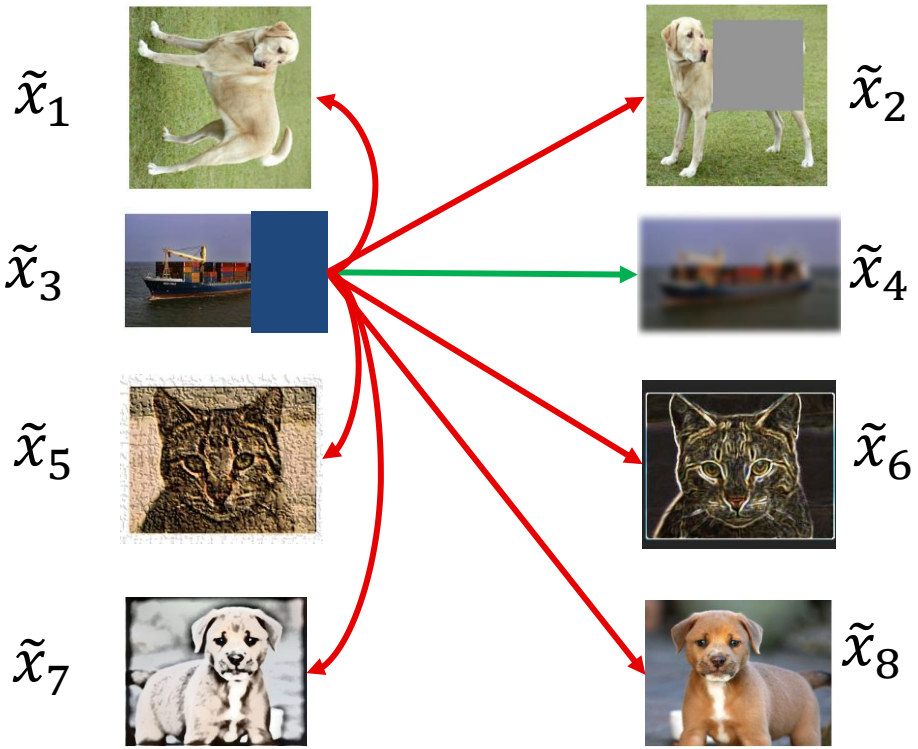
- $f()$: encoder
- h_i, h_j: representations

- $g()$: projector
- z_i, z_j: embeddings

A Simple Framework for Contrastive Learning of Visual Representations (Chen et al. ICML et al. 2020)

SimCLR

Positives are augmented view of the same instance/sample
Negatives are all the other samples



Increase Cosine Similarity

$$s_{2i-1,\,2i} = \frac{z_{2i-1} \cdot z_{2i}}{||z_{2i-1}||\ ||z_{2i}||}$$

Decrease Cosine Similarity

$$s_{2i-1,\,j} = \frac{z_{2i-1} \cdot z_j}{||z_{2i-1}||\ ||z_j||} \quad where \quad j \neq 2i-1,\ 2i$$

Final **InfoNCE Loss:**

$$L = -\mathbb{E}_X \left[\log \frac{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+))}{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+)) + \sum_{j=1}^{N-1} \exp(s(f(x), f(x_j^-))} \right]$$

$s_{2i-1,\,2i}$ (numerator) $s_{2i-1,\,2i}$ (denominator) $s_{2i-1,\,j}$

A Simple Framework for Contrastive Learning of Visual Representations (Chen et al. ICML et al. 2020)

SimCLR

Generate a positive pair by sampling data augmentation functions

Algorithm 1 SimCLR's main learning algorithm.

input: batch size N, constant τ, structure of $f, g, \mathcal{T}$.
for sampled minibatch $\{\boldsymbol{x}_k\}_{k=1}^{N}$ **do**
  for all $k \in \{1, \ldots, N\}$ **do**
    draw two augmentation functions $t \sim \mathcal{T}, t' \sim \mathcal{T}$
    # the first augmentation
    $\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{2k-1} = t(\boldsymbol{x}_k)$
    $\boldsymbol{h}_{2k-1} = f(\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{2k-1})$ # representation
    $\boldsymbol{z}_{2k-1} = g(\boldsymbol{h}_{2k-1})$ # projection
    # the second augmentation
    $\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{2k} = t'(\boldsymbol{x}_k)$
    $\boldsymbol{h}_{2k} = f(\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{2k})$ # representation
    $\boldsymbol{z}_{2k} = g(\boldsymbol{h}_{2k})$ # projection
  end for
  for all $i \in \{1, \ldots, 2N\}$ and $j \in \{1, \ldots, 2N\}$ **do**
    $s_{i,j} = \boldsymbol{z}_i^\top \boldsymbol{z}_j / (\|\boldsymbol{z}_i\| \|\boldsymbol{z}_j\|)$ # pairwise similarity
  end for
  define $\ell(i, j)$ **as** $\ell(i, j) = -\log \frac{\exp(s_{i,j}/\tau)}{\sum_{k=1}^{2N} \mathbb{1}_{[k \neq i]} \exp(s_{i,k}/\tau)}$
  $\mathcal{L} = \frac{1}{2N} \sum_{k=1}^{N} [\ell(2k-1, 2k) + \ell(2k, 2k-1)]$
  update networks f and g to minimize $\mathcal{L}$
end for
return encoder network $f(\cdot)$, and throw away $g(\cdot)$

Source: Chen et al., 2020

SimCLR

Generate a positive pair by sampling data augmentation functions

Algorithm 1 SimCLR's main learning algorithm.

input: batch size N, constant τ, structure of $f, g, \mathcal{T}$.
for sampled minibatch $\{\boldsymbol{x}_k\}_{k=1}^{N}$ **do**
  for all $k \in \{1, \ldots, N\}$ **do**
    draw two augmentation functions $t \sim \mathcal{T}$, $t' \sim \mathcal{T}$
    # the first augmentation
    $\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{2k-1} = t(\boldsymbol{x}_k)$
    $\boldsymbol{h}_{2k-1} = f(\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{2k-1})$ # representation
    $\boldsymbol{z}_{2k-1} = g(\boldsymbol{h}_{2k-1})$ # projection
    # the second augmentation
    $\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{2k} = t'(\boldsymbol{x}_k)$
    $\boldsymbol{h}_{2k} = f(\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{2k})$ # representation
    $\boldsymbol{z}_{2k} = g(\boldsymbol{h}_{2k})$ # projection
  end for
  for all $i \in \{1, \ldots, 2N\}$ and $j \in \{1, \ldots, 2N\}$ **do**
    $s_{i,j} = \boldsymbol{z}_i^\top \boldsymbol{z}_j / (\|\boldsymbol{z}_i\| \|\boldsymbol{z}_j\|)$ # pairwise similarity
  end for
  define $\ell(i, j)$ **as** $\ell(i,j) = -\log \frac{\exp(s_{i,j}/\tau)}{\sum_{k=1}^{2N} \mathbb{1}_{[k \neq i]} \exp(s_{i,k}/\tau)}$
  $\mathcal{L} = \frac{1}{2N} \sum_{k=1}^{N} [\ell(2k-1, 2k) + \ell(2k, 2k-1)]$
  update networks f and g to minimize $\mathcal{L}$
end for
return encoder network $f(\cdot)$, and throw away $g(\cdot)$

InfoNCE loss: Use all non-positive samples in the batch as x^-

Source: Chen et al., 2020

SimCLR

Generate a positive pair by sampling data augmentation functions

Iterate through and use each of the 2N sample as reference, compute average loss

InfoNCE loss: Use all non-positive samples in the batch as x^-

Algorithm 1 SimCLR's main learning algorithm.

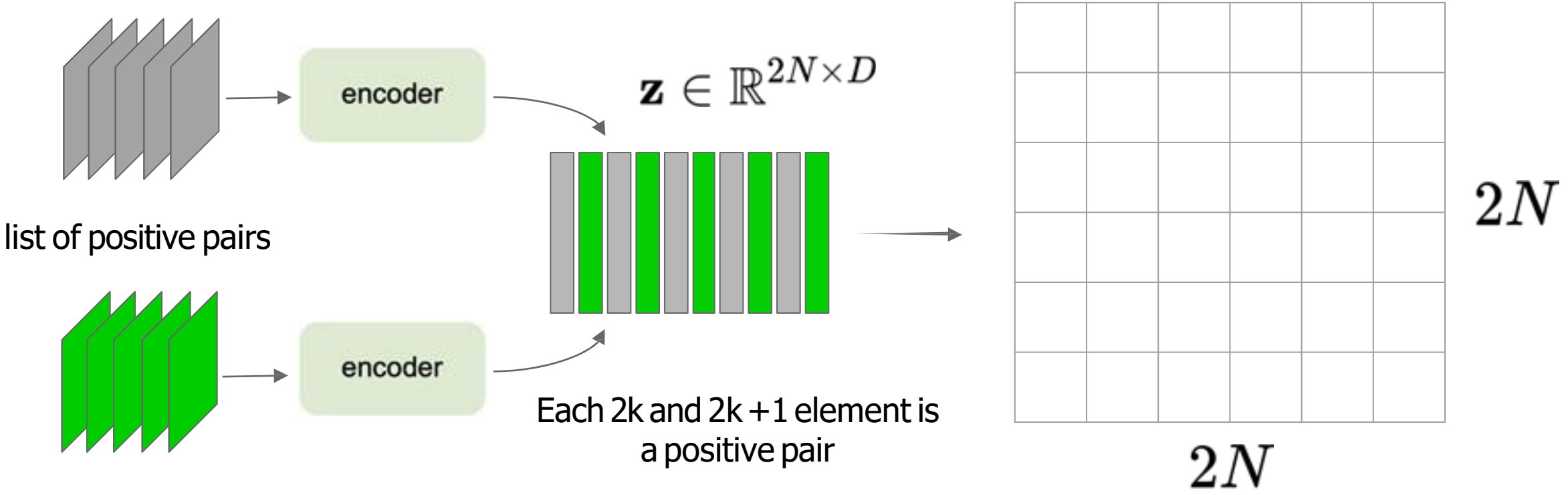
input: batch size N, constant τ, structure of $f, g, \mathcal{T}$.
for sampled minibatch $\{\boldsymbol{x}_k\}_{k=1}^{N}$ **do**
  for all $k \in \{1, \ldots, N\}$ **do**
    draw two augmentation functions $t \sim \mathcal{T}, t' \sim \mathcal{T}$
    # the first augmentation
    $\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{2k-1} = t(\boldsymbol{x}_k)$
    $\boldsymbol{h}_{2k-1} = f(\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{2k-1})$ # representation
    $\boldsymbol{z}_{2k-1} = g(\boldsymbol{h}_{2k-1})$ # projection
    # the second augmentation
    $\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{2k} = t'(\boldsymbol{x}_k)$
    $\boldsymbol{h}_{2k} = f(\tilde{\boldsymbol{x}}_{2k})$ # representation
    $\boldsymbol{z}_{2k} = g(\boldsymbol{h}_{2k})$ # projection
  end for
  for all $i \in \{1, \ldots, 2N\}$ and $j \in \{1, \ldots, 2N\}$ **do**
    $s_{i,j} = \boldsymbol{z}_i^\top \boldsymbol{z}_j / (\|\boldsymbol{z}_i\| \|\boldsymbol{z}_j\|)$ # pairwise similarity
  end for
  define $\ell(i, j)$ **as** $\ell(i,j) = -\log \frac{\exp(s_{i,j}/\tau)}{\sum_{k=1}^{2N} \mathbb{1}_{[k \neq i]} \exp(s_{i,k}/\tau)}$
  $\mathcal{L} = \frac{1}{2N} \sum_{k=1}^{N} [\ell(2k-1, 2k) + \ell(2k, 2k-1)]$
  update networks f and g to minimize $\mathcal{L}$
end for
return encoder network $f(\cdot)$, and throw away $g(\cdot)$

Source: Chen et al., 2020

SimCLR: mini-batch training

$$s_{i,j} = \frac{z_i^T z_j}{||z_i||\,||z_j||}$$

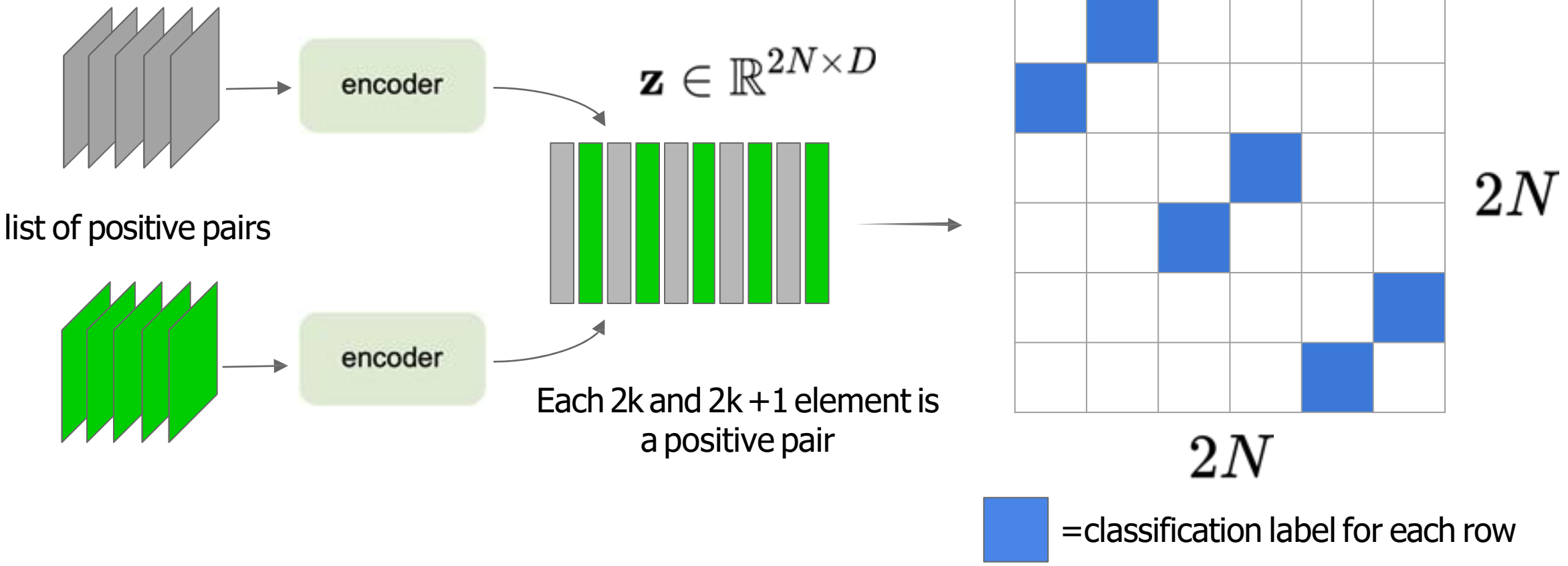
"Affinity matrix"



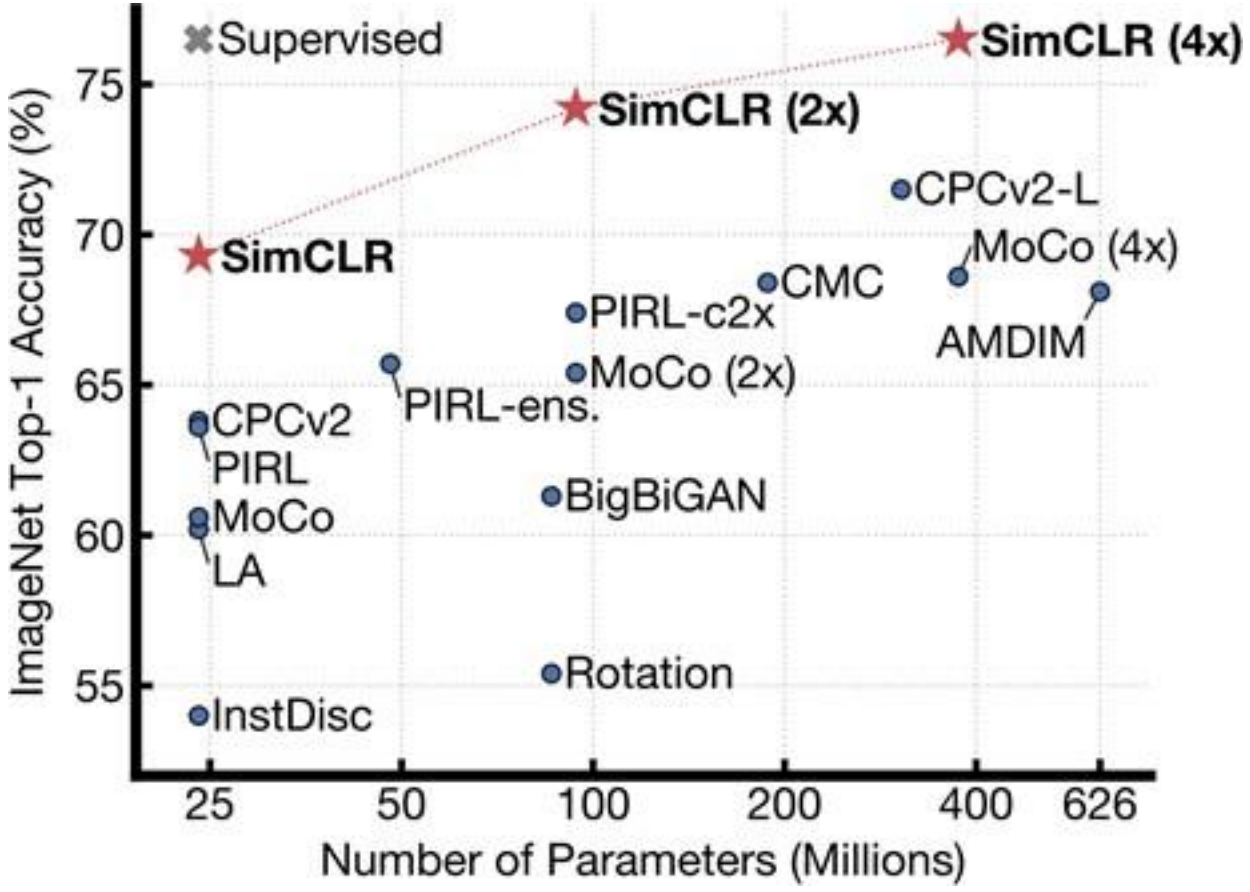
SimCLR: mini-batch training

$$s_{i,j} = \frac{z_i^T z_j}{||z_i||\,||z_j||}$$

"Affinity matrix"



Training linear classifier on SimCLR features



Train feature encoder on ImageNet (entire training set) using SimCLR.

Freeze feature encoder, train a linear classifier on top with labeled data.

Source: [Chen et al., 2020]

Semi-supervised learning on SimCLR features

Method	Architecture	Label fraction 1%	10%
		Top 5	
Supervised baseline	ResNet-50	48.4	80.4
Methods using other label-propagation:			
Pseudo-label	ResNet-50	51.6	82.4
VAT+Entropy Min.	ResNet-50	47.0	83.4
UDA (w. RandAug)	ResNet-50	-	88.5
FixMatch (w. RandAug)	ResNet-50	-	89.1
S4L (Rot+VAT+En. M.)	ResNet-50 (4×)	-	91.2
Methods using representation learning only:			
InstDisc	ResNet-50	39.2	77.4
BigBiGAN	RevNet-50 (4×)	55.2	78.8
PIRL	ResNet-50	57.2	83.8
CPC v2	ResNet-161(*)	77.9	91.2
SimCLR (ours)	ResNet-50	75.5	87.8
SimCLR (ours)	ResNet-50 (2×)	83.0	91.2
SimCLR (ours)	ResNet-50 (4×)	**85.8**	**92.6**

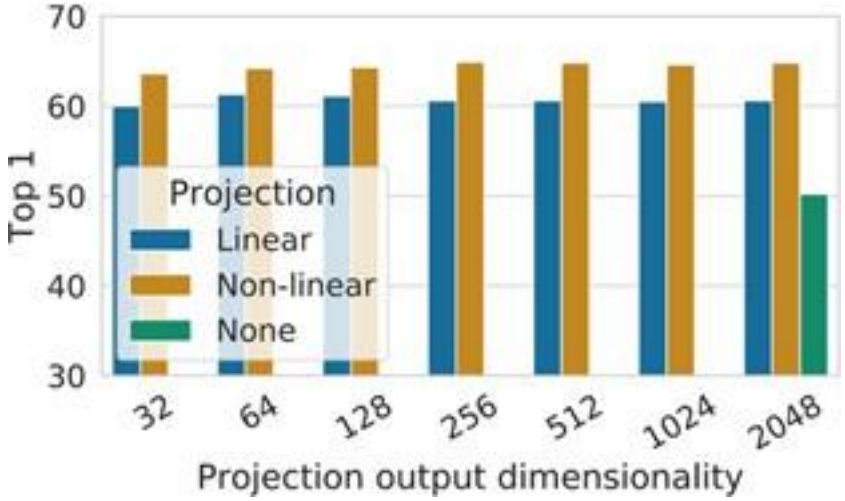
Table 7. ImageNet accuracy of models trained with few labels.

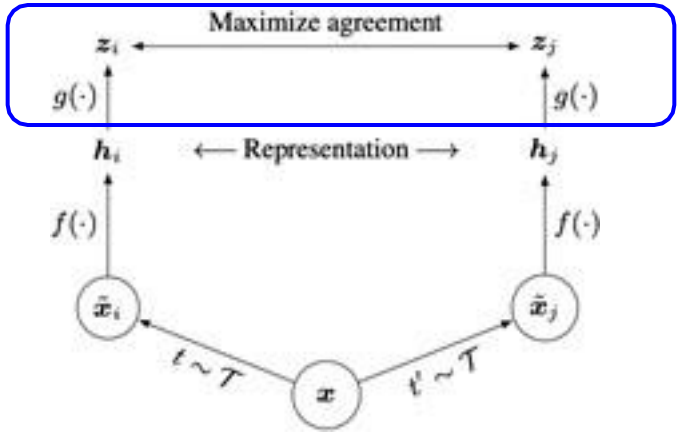
Train feature encoder on ImageNet (entire training set) using SimCLR.

Finetune the encoder with 1% / 10% of labeled data on ImageNet.

Source: Chen et al., 2020

SimCLR design choices: projection head





Linear / non-linear projection heads improve representation learning.

A possible explanation:

- contrastive learning objective may discard useful information for downstream tasks
- representation space z is trained to be invariant to data transformation.
- by leveraging the projection head g(·), more information can be preserved in the h representation space

Source: Chen et al., 2020

SimCLR design choices: large batch size

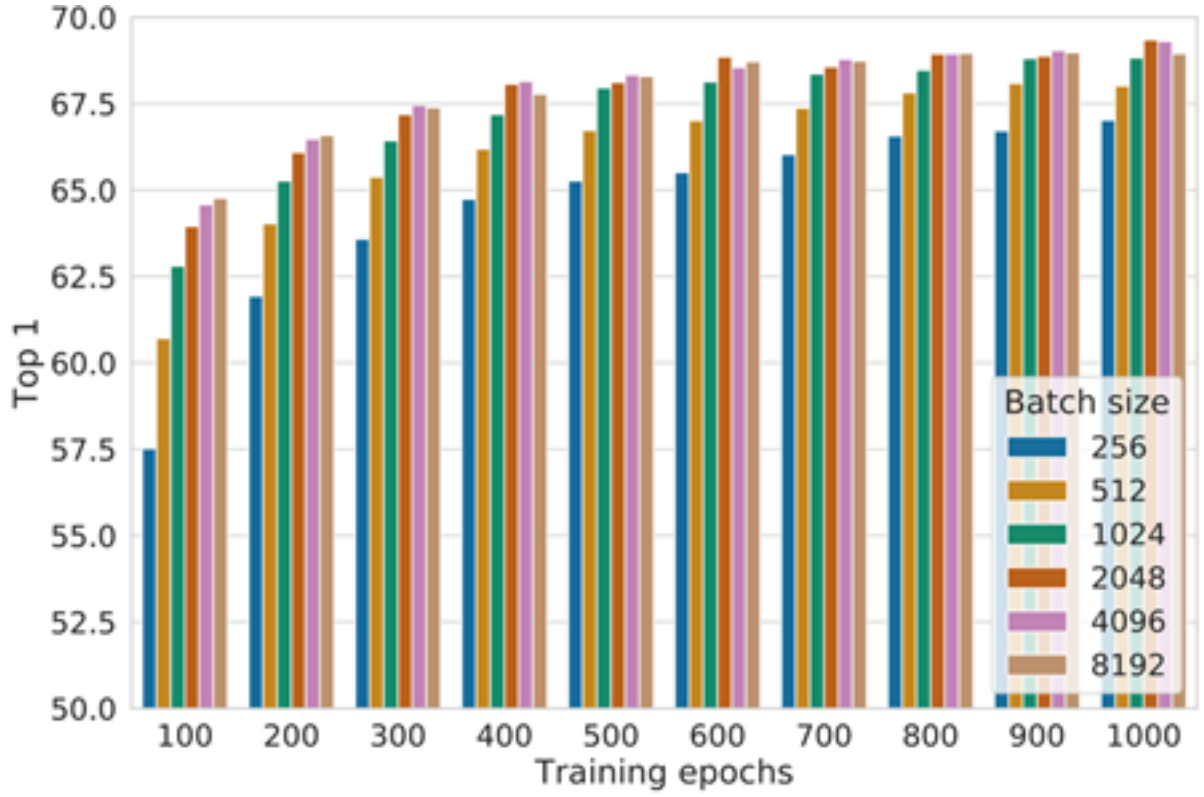


Figure 9. Linear evaluation models (ResNet-50) trained with different batch size and epochs. Each bar is a single run from scratch.[10]

Large training batch size is crucial for SimCLR!

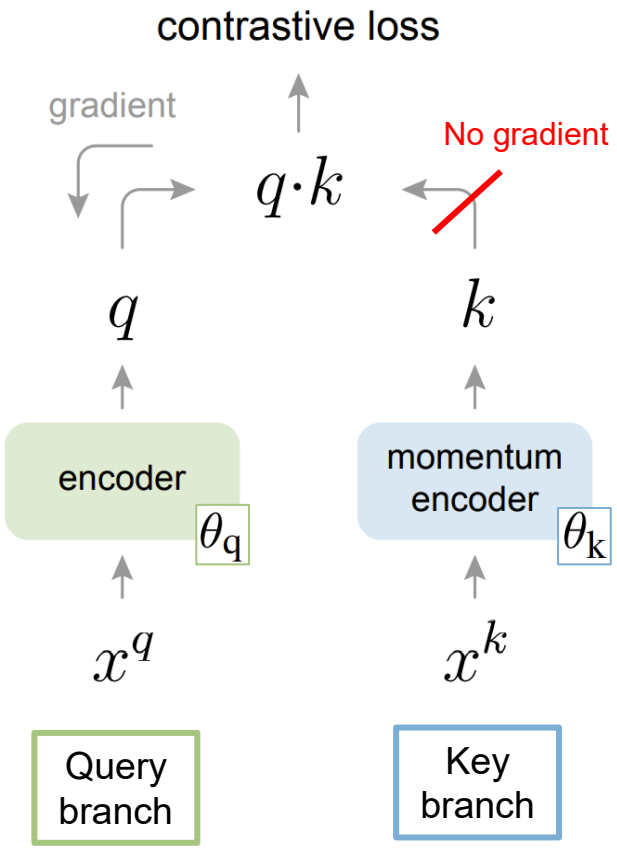
Large batch size causes large memory footprint during backpropagation: requires distributed training on TPUs (ImageNet experiments)

$$MI[f(x), f(x^+)] - \log(N) \geq -L$$

Source: Chen et al., 2020

Momentum Contrastive Learning (MoCo)

About Positive Pair



Key differences to SimCLR:

- Replace encoder in the right-branch with its *momentum* version:

1. Compute gradients and update encoder only through the queries;
2. Key encoder is slowly progressing updated through the momentum update rule:

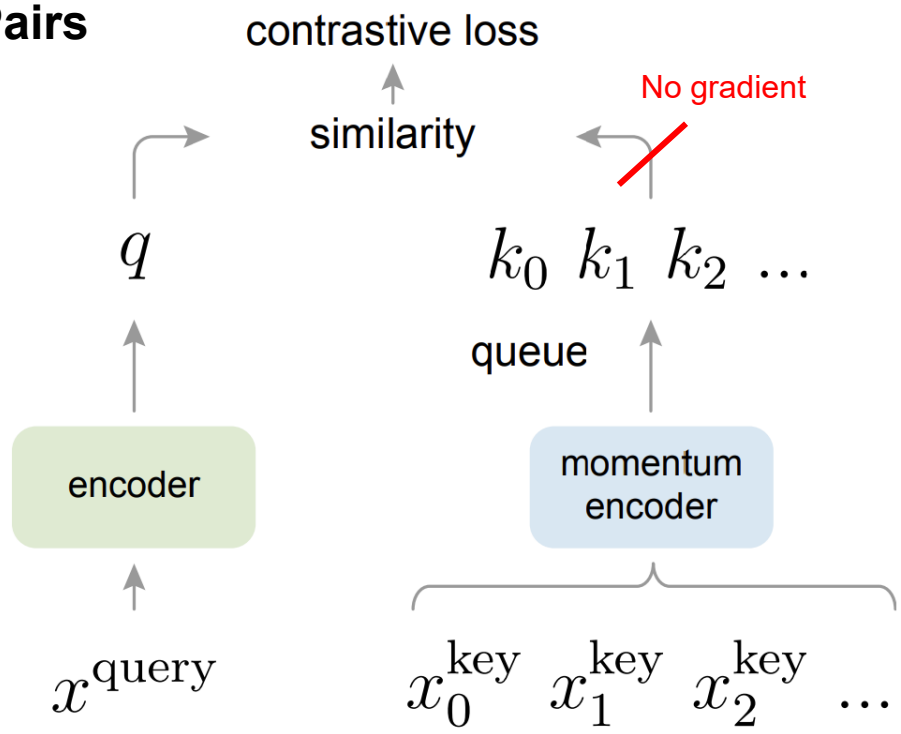
$$\theta_k \leftarrow m\theta_k + (1-m)\theta_q$$

3. This helps stabilizing and extend the training

Source: He et al., 2020

Momentum Contrastive Learning (MoCo)

About Negative Pairs



Key differences to SimCLR:

- Replace encoder in the right-branch with its *momentum* version
- Keep a running *queue* of keys (negatives):

1. Updated with new key representations (FIFO queue)
2. Decouple mini-batch and negative memory bank function
3. Support large negative samples without high batch size

Source: He et al., 2020

MoCo

Generate a positive pair by sampling data augmentation functions

No gradient through the key

Algorithm 1 Pseudocode of MoCo in a PyTorch-like style.

```
# f_q, f_k: encoder networks for query and key
# queue: dictionary as a queue of K keys (CxK)
# m: momentum
# t: temperature

f_k.params = f_q.params # initialize
for x in loader: # load a minibatch x with N samples
   x_q = aug(x) # a randomly augmented version
   x_k = aug(x) # another randomly augmented version

   q = f_q.forward(x_q) # queries: NxC
   k = f_k.forward(x_k) # keys: NxC
   k = k.detach() # no gradient to keys

   # positive logits: Nx1
   l_pos = bmm(q.view(N,1,C), k.view(N,C,1))

   # negative logits: NxK
   l_neg = mm(q.view(N,C), queue.view(C,K))

   # logits: Nx(1+K)
   logits = cat([l_pos, l_neg], dim=1)

   # contrastive loss, Eqn.(1)
   labels = zeros(N) # positives are the 0-th
   loss = CrossEntropyLoss(logits/t, labels)

   # SGD update: query network
   loss.backward()
   update(f_q.params)

   # momentum update: key network
   f_k.params = m*f_k.params+(1-m)*f_q.params

   # update dictionary
   enqueue(queue, k) # enqueue the current minibatch
   dequeue(queue) # dequeue the earliest minibatch
```

bmm: batch matrix multiplication; mm: matrix multiplication; cat: concatenation.

Use the running queue of keys as the negative samples

InfoNCE loss

Update f_k through momentum

Update the FIFO negative sample queue

Source: He et al., 2020

"MoCo V2"

Improved Baselines with Momentum Contrastive Learning

Xinlei Chen Haoqi Fan Ross Girshick Kaiming He
Facebook AI Research (FAIR)

A hybrid of ideas from SimCLR and MoCo:

- From SimCLR: non-linear projection head and strong data augmentation.
- From MoCo: momentum-updated queues that allow training on a large number of negative samples (no TPU required!).

Source: Chen et al., 2020

MoCo vs. SimCLR vs. MoCo V2

case	unsup. pre-train MLP	aug+	cos	epochs	ImageNet acc.	VOC detection AP_{50}	AP	AP_{75}
supervised					76.5	81.3	53.5	58.8
MoCo v1				200	60.6	81.5	55.9	62.6
(a)	✓			200	66.2	82.0	56.4	62.6
(b)		✓		200	63.4	82.2	56.8	63.2
(c)	✓	✓		200	67.3	**82.5**	57.2	63.9
(d)	✓	✓	✓	200	67.5	82.4	57.0	63.6
(e)	✓	✓	✓	**800**	**71.1**	**82.5**	**57.4**	**64.0**

Table 1. **Ablation of MoCo baselines**, evaluated by ResNet-50 for (i) ImageNet linear classification, and (ii) fine-tuning VOC object detection (mean of 5 trials). "**MLP**": with an MLP head; "**aug+**": with extra blur augmentation; "**cos**": cosine learning rate schedule.

Key takeaways:

- Non-linear projection head and strong data augmentation are crucial for contrastive learning.

Source: Chen et al., 2020

MoCo vs. SimCLR vs. MoCo V2

case	unsup. pre-train MLP	aug+	cos	epochs	batch	ImageNet acc.
MoCo v1 [6]				200	256	60.6
SimCLR [2]	✓	✓	✓	200	256	61.9
SimCLR [2]	✓	✓	✓	200	8192	66.6
MoCo v2	✓	✓	✓	200	256	**67.5**
*results of **longer** unsupervised training follow:*						
SimCLR [2]	✓	✓	✓	1000	4096	69.3
MoCo v2	✓	✓	✓	800	256	**71.1**

Table 2. **MoCo *vs.* SimCLR**: ImageNet linear classifier accuracy (**ResNet-50, 1-crop 224×224**), trained on features from unsupervised pre-training. "aug+" in SimCLR includes blur and stronger color distortion. SimCLR ablations are from Fig. 9 in [2] (we thank the authors for providing the numerical results).

Key takeaways:

- Non-linear projection head and strong data augmentation are crucial for contrastive learning.
- Decoupling mini-batch size with negative sample size allows MoCo-V2 to outperform SimCLR with smaller batch size (256 vs. 8192).

Source: Chen et al., 2020

MoCo vs. SimCLR vs. MoCo V2

mechanism	batch	memory / GPU	time / 200-ep.
MoCo	256	**5.0G**	**53 hrs**
end-to-end	256	7.4G	65 hrs
end-to-end	4096	93.0G†	n/a

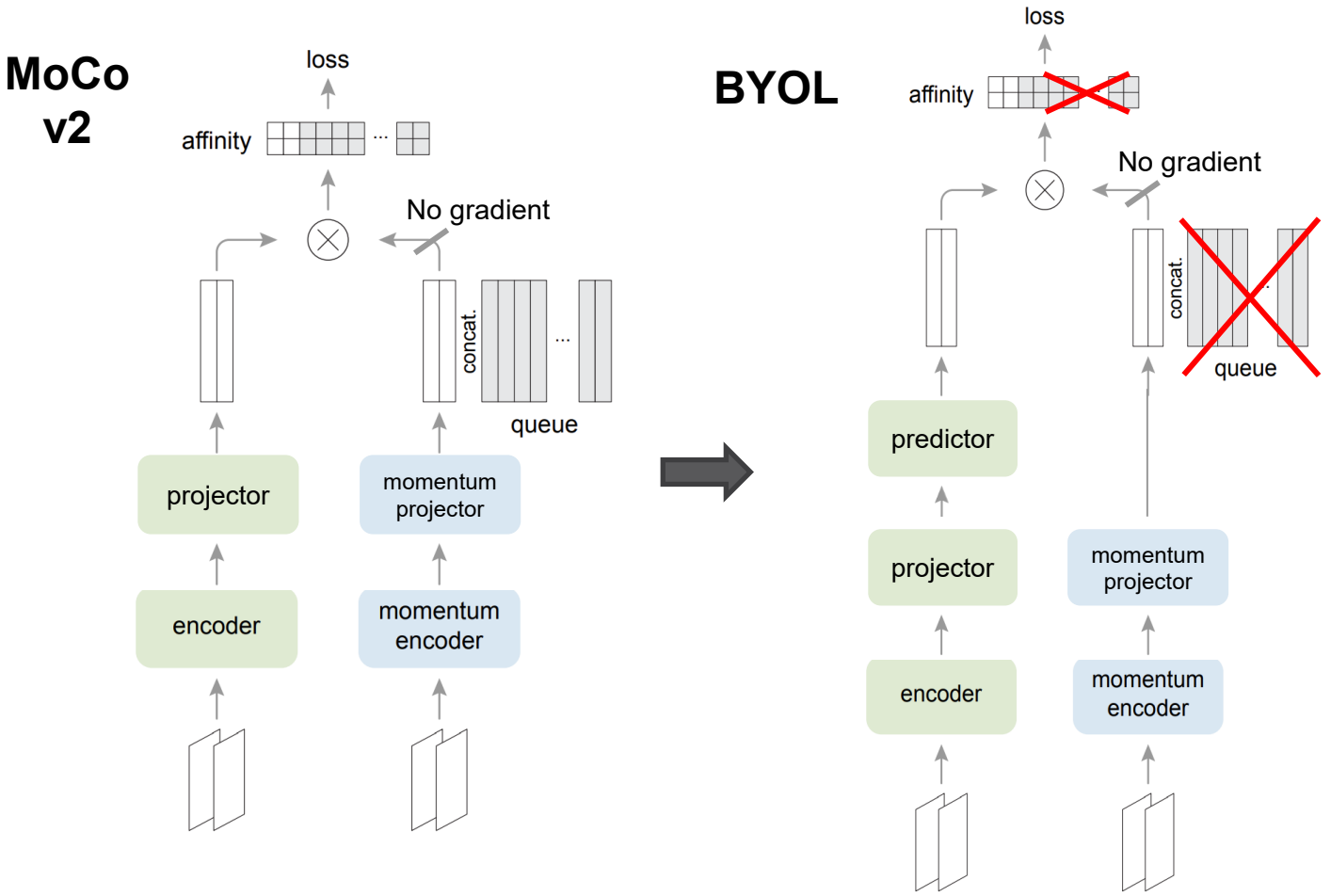
Table 3. **Memory and time cost** in 8 V100 16G GPUs, implemented in PyTorch. †: based on our estimation.

Key takeaways:

- Non-linear projection head and strong data augmentation are crucial for contrastive learning.
- Decoupling mini-batch size with negative sample size allows MoCo-V2 to outperform SimCLR with smaller batch size (256 vs. 8192).
- … all with much smaller memory footprint! ("end-to-end" means SimCLR here)

Source: Chen et al., 2020

BYOL: Bootstrap your own latent



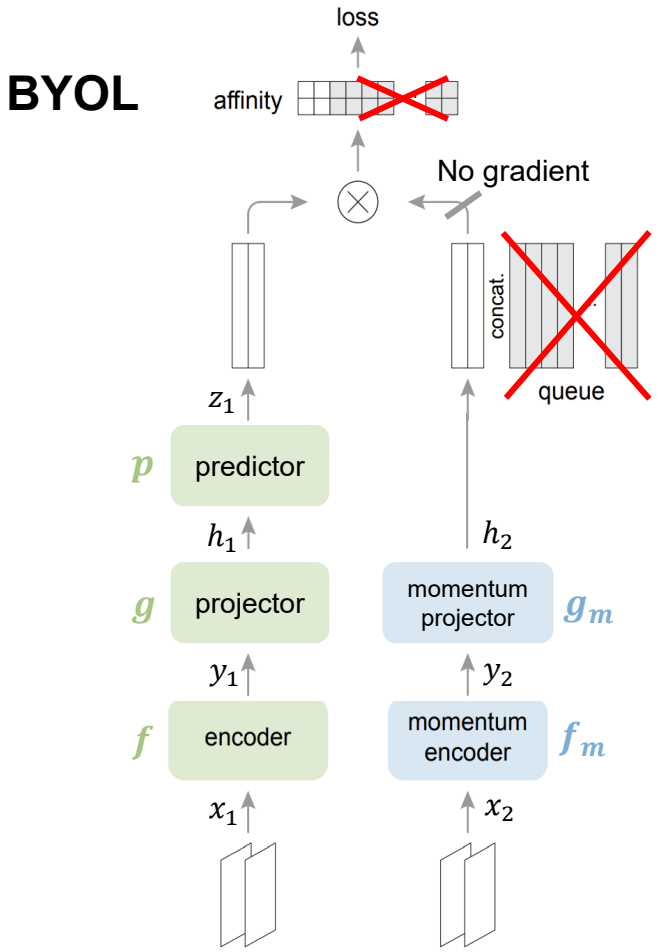
What are the differences?

1. No Negatives!!!
2. Predictor head (asymmetric architecture)

What happens if we *only* remove negatives?

Bootstrap your own latent: A new approach to self-supervised Learning (Grill et al. NeurIPS 2020)

BYOL: Bootstrap your own latent



Let's first introduce some notation:

Encoder f, Momentum encoder f_m
Projector g, Momentum projector g_m
Predictor p

and

$y_1 = f(x_1),\ y_2 = f_m(x_2)$ are the *representations*
$h_1 = g(y_1),\ h_2 = g_m(y_2)$ are the *embeddings*
$z_1 = p(h_1)$ is the *prediction*

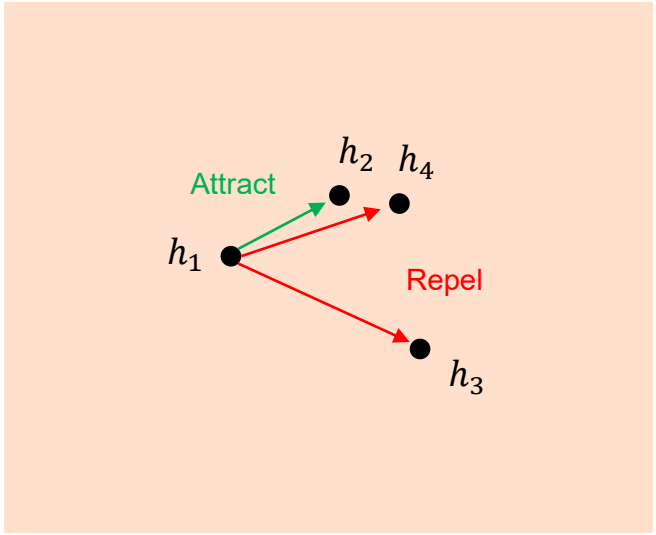
Bootstrap your own latent: A new approach to self-supervised Learning (Grill et al. NeurIPS 2020)

BYOL: Bootstrap your own latent

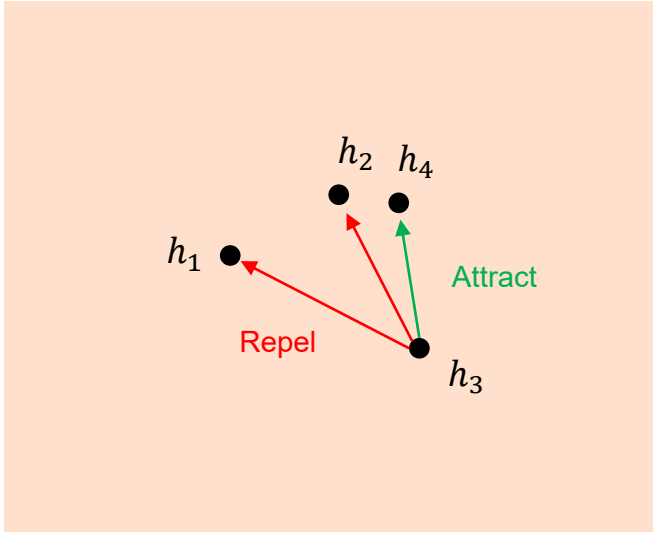
Case <u>with</u> negative
(i.e. SimCLR or Moco)

Encoder f, Momentum encoder f_m
Projector g, Momentum projector g_m

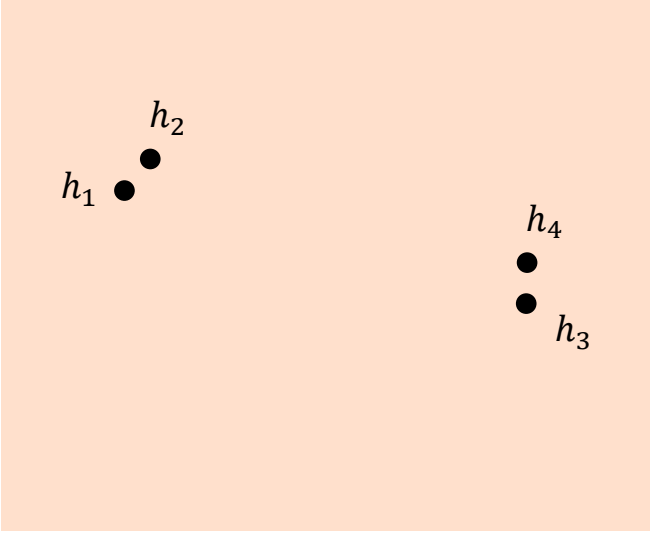
$y_1 = f(x_1),\ y_2 = f_m(x_2)$ are the *representations*
$h_1 = g(y_1),\ h_2 = g_m(y_2)$ are the *embeddings*



h_1: reference sample
h_2: positive sample
h_3, h_4: negative samples



h_3: reference sample
h_4: positive sample
h_1, h_2: negative samples



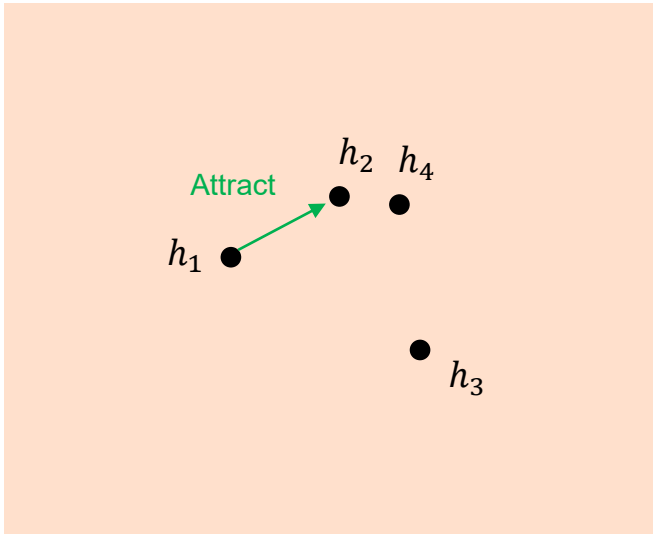
Good representations!

BYOL: Bootstrap your own latent

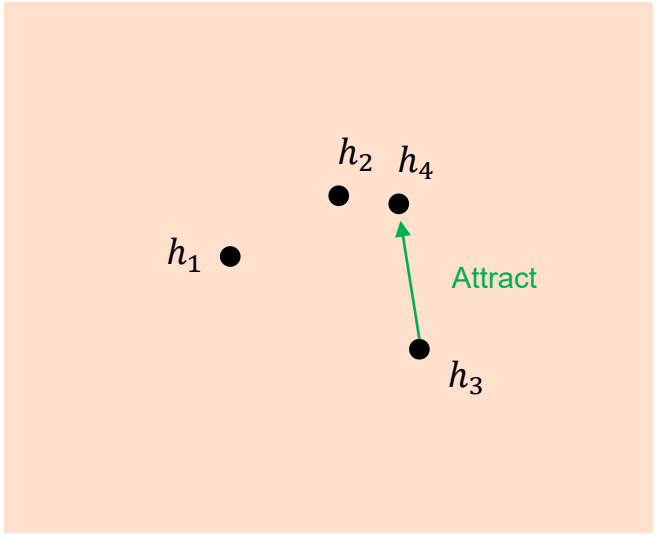
Case <u>without</u> negative
(i.e. SimCLR or Moco)

Encoder f, Momentum encoder f_m
Projector g, Momentum projector g_m

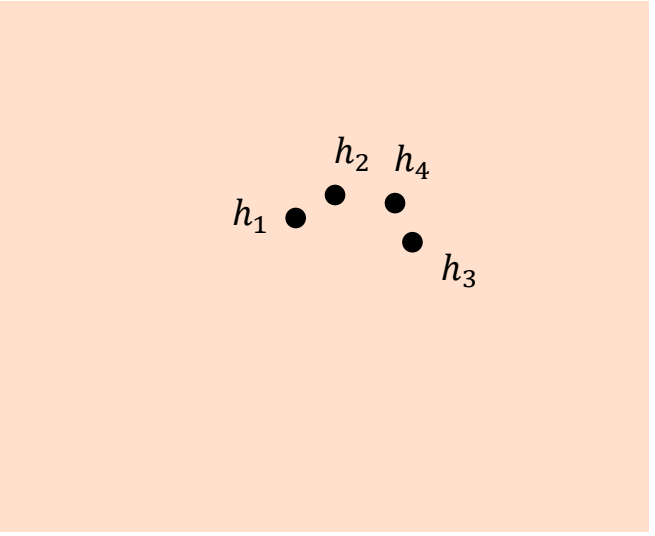
$y_1 = f(x_1),\ y_2 = f_m(x_2)$ are the *representations*
$h_1 = g(y_1),\ h_2 = g_m(y_2)$ are the *embeddings*



h_1: reference sample
h_2: positive sample



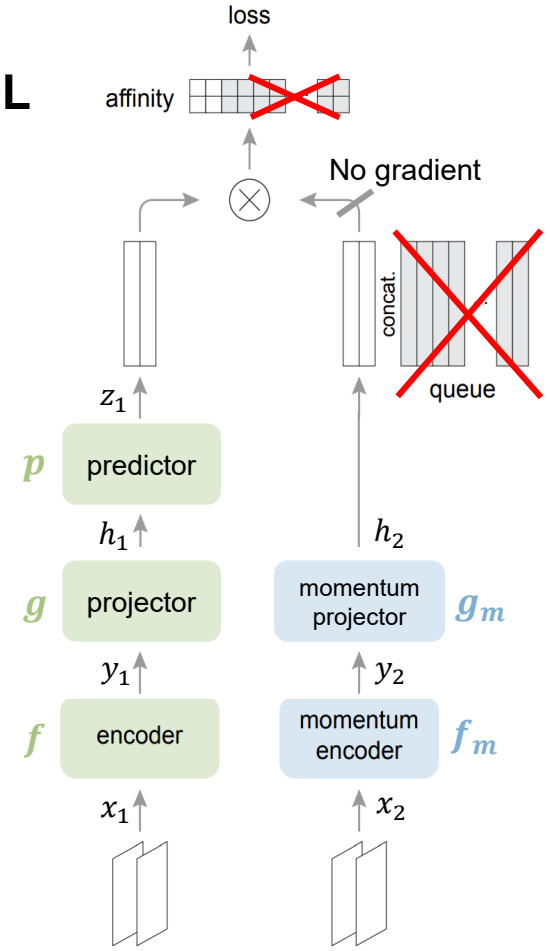
h_3: reference sample
h_4: positive sample



Bad representations!

BYOL: Bootstrap your own latent

BYOL



Encoder f, Momentum encoder f_m
Projector g, Momentum projector g_m
Predictor p

$y_1 = f(x_1),\ y_2 = f_m(x_2)$ are the *representations*
$h_1 = g(y_1),\ h_2 = g_m(y_2)$ are the *embeddings*
$z_1 = p(h_1)$ is the *prediction*

Consider this scenario:

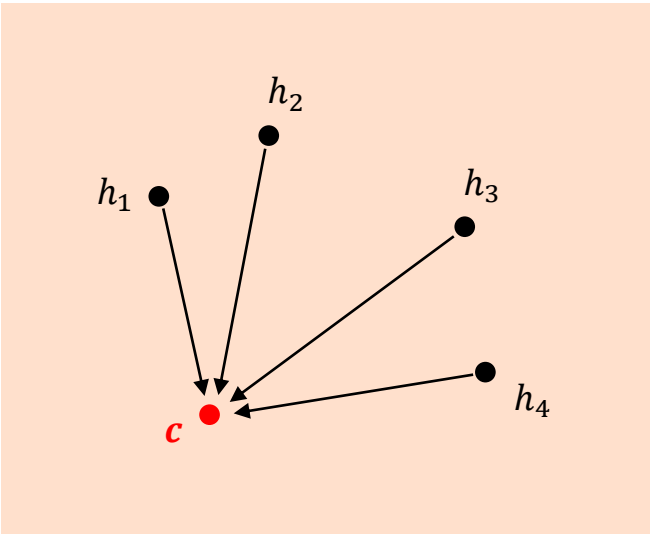
$f = f_m = \boldsymbol{zero\ function}$

$g = g_m = \boldsymbol{random}$

$\boldsymbol{Remove}\ p$

$y_1 = f(x_1) = y_2 = f_m(x_2) = 0$

$h_1 = g(y_1) = h_2 = g_m(y_2) = c$



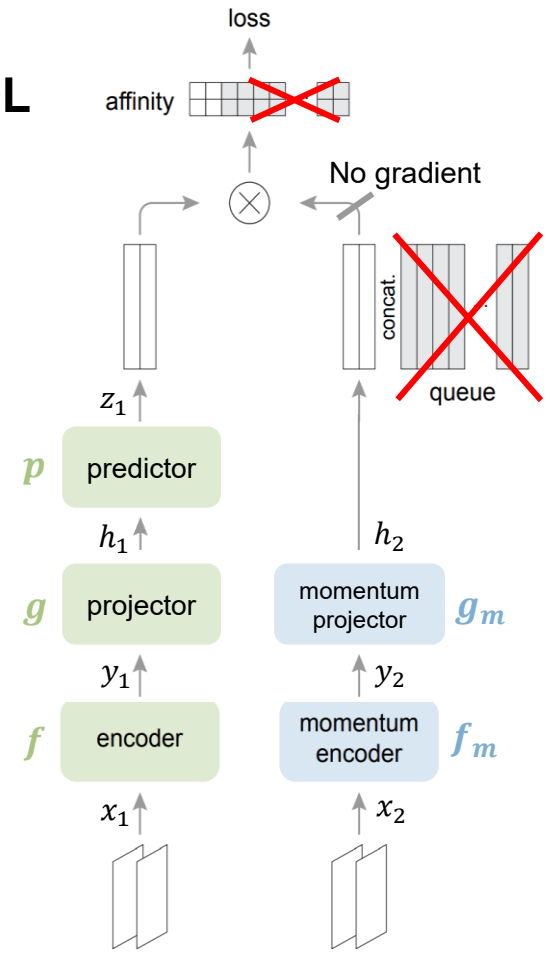
What happens if we *only* remove negatives?

The solutions **collapse**

Bootstrap your own latent: A new approach to self-supervised Learning (Grill et al. NeurIPS 2020)

BYOL: Bootstrap your own latent

BYOL



What happens if we *only* remove negatives? → The solutions **collapse**

So how does BYOL avoid collapse?

1. Predictor head (asymmetric architecture)
2. Momentum-updated encoder and projector

Bootstrap your own latent: A new approach to self-supervised Learning (Grill et al. NeurIPS 2020)

BYOL - Results

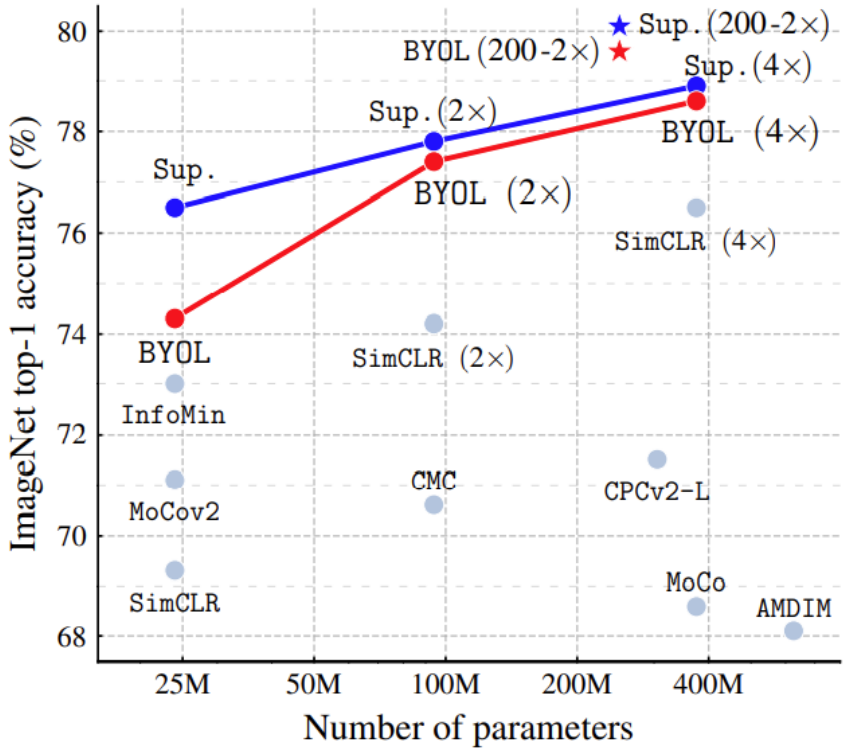
(a) ResNet-50 encoder.

Method	Top-1	Top-5
Local Agg.	60.2	-
PIRL [35]	63.6	-
CPC v2 [32]	63.8	85.3
CMC [11]	66.2	87.0
SimCLR [8]	69.3	89.0
MoCo v2 [37]	71.1	-
InfoMin Aug. [12]	73.0	91.1
BYOL (ours)	**74.3**	**91.6**

(b) Other ResNet encoder architectures.

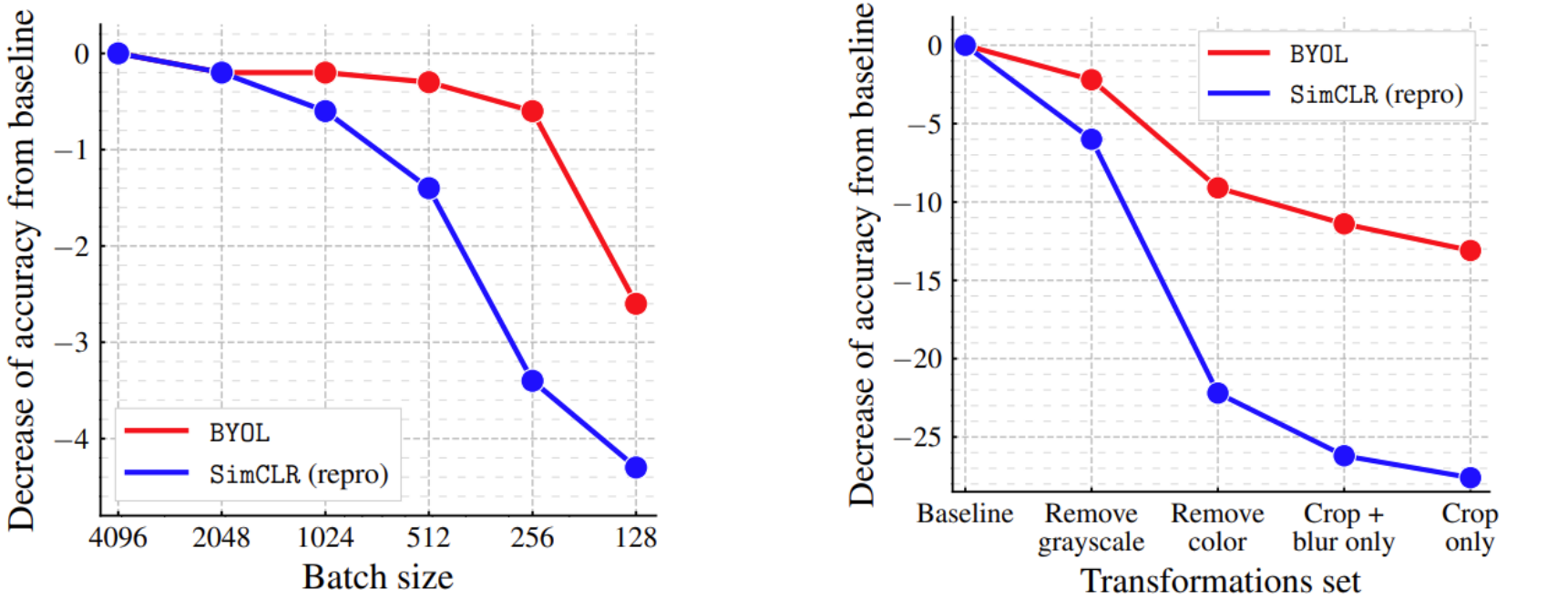
Method	Architecture	Param.	Top-1	Top-5
SimCLR [8]	ResNet-50 (2×)	94M	74.2	92.0
CMC [11]	ResNet-50 (2×)	94M	70.6	89.7
BYOL (ours)	ResNet-50 (2×)	94M	77.4	93.6
CPC v2 [32]	ResNet-161	305M	71.5	90.1
MoCo [9]	ResNet-50 (4×)	375M	68.6	-
SimCLR [8]	ResNet-50 (4×)	375M	76.5	93.2
BYOL (ours)	ResNet-50 (4×)	375M	78.6	94.2
BYOL (ours)	ResNet-200 (2×)	250M	**79.6**	**94.8**

Table 1: Top-1 and top-5 accuracies (in %) under linear evaluation on ImageNet.



Bootstrap your own latent: A new approach to self-supervised Learning (Grill et al. NeurIPS 2020)

BYOL - Results



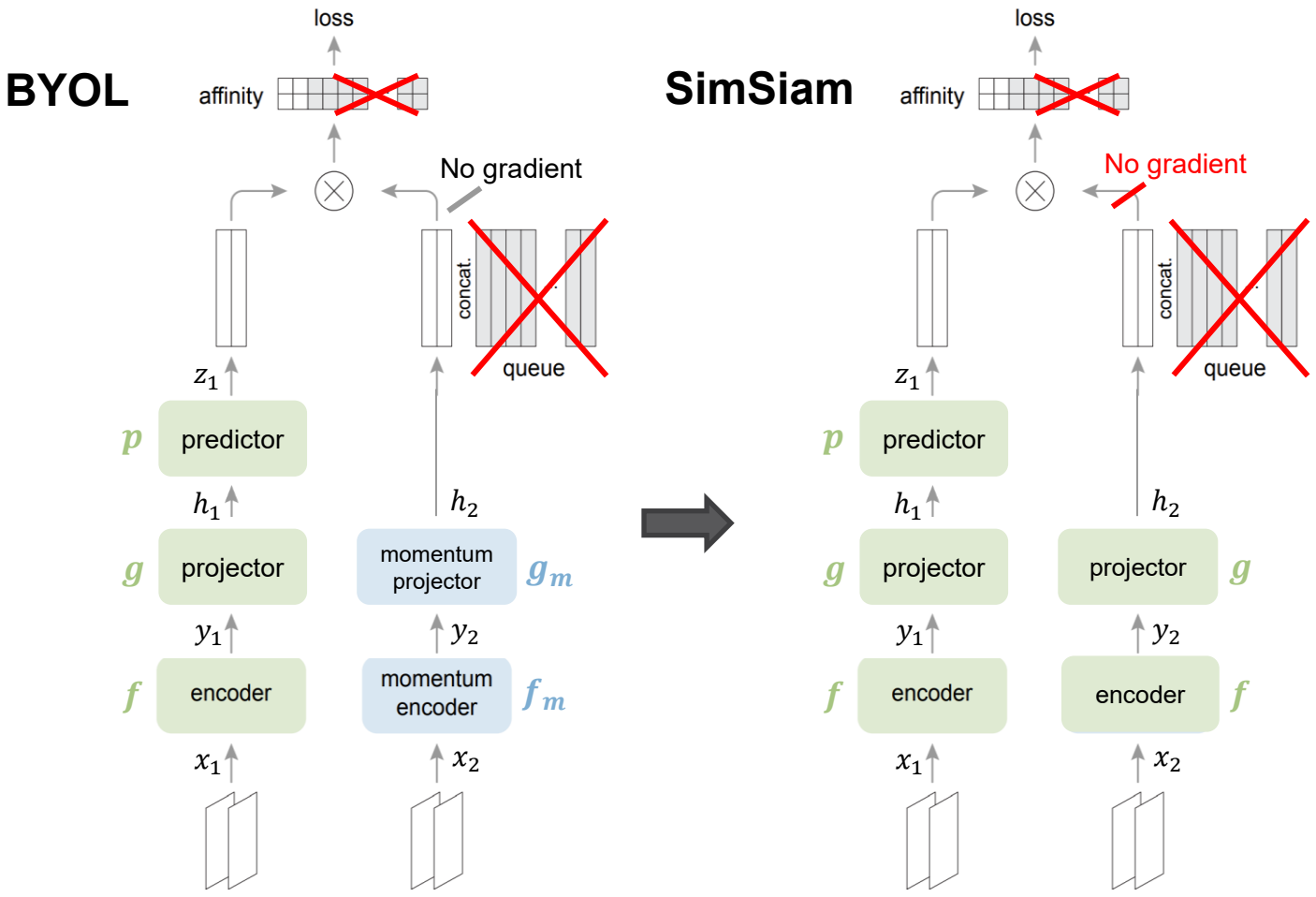
(a) Impact of batch size

(b) Impact of progressively removing transformations

Figure 3: Decrease in top-1 accuracy (in % points) of BYOL and our own reproduction of SimCLR at 300 epochs, under linear evaluation on ImageNet.

Bootstrap your own latent: A new approach to self-supervised Learning (Grill et al. NeurIPS 2020)

SimSiam: Exploring Simple Siamese Representation Learning



SimSiam: Exploring Simple Siamese Representation Learning (Chen et al. CVPR 2021)

What are the differences?

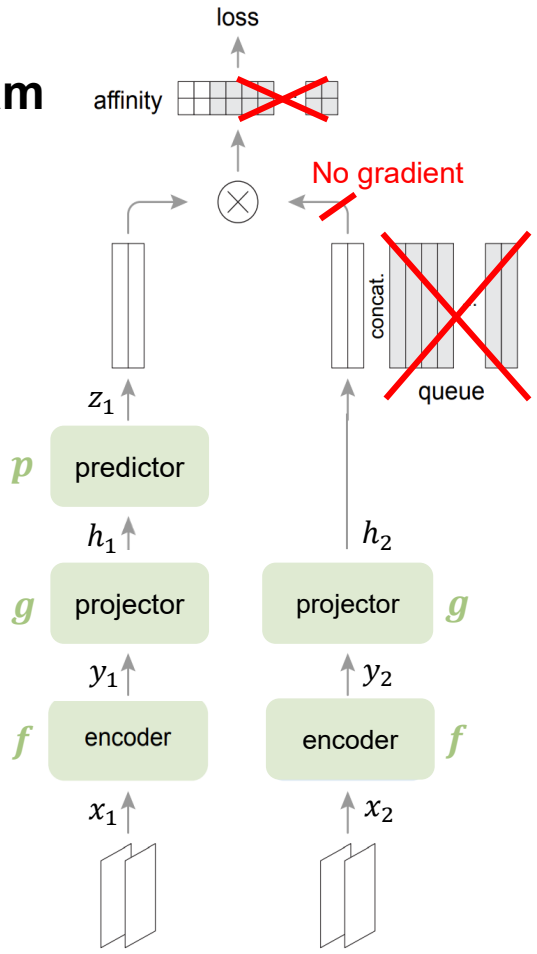
No momentum-update

So how does BYOL avoid collapse?

1. Predictor head (asymmetric architecture)
2. ~~Momentum-updated encoder and projector~~
2. Stopping Gradient

SimSiam

SimSiam



So how does SimSiam avoid collapse?

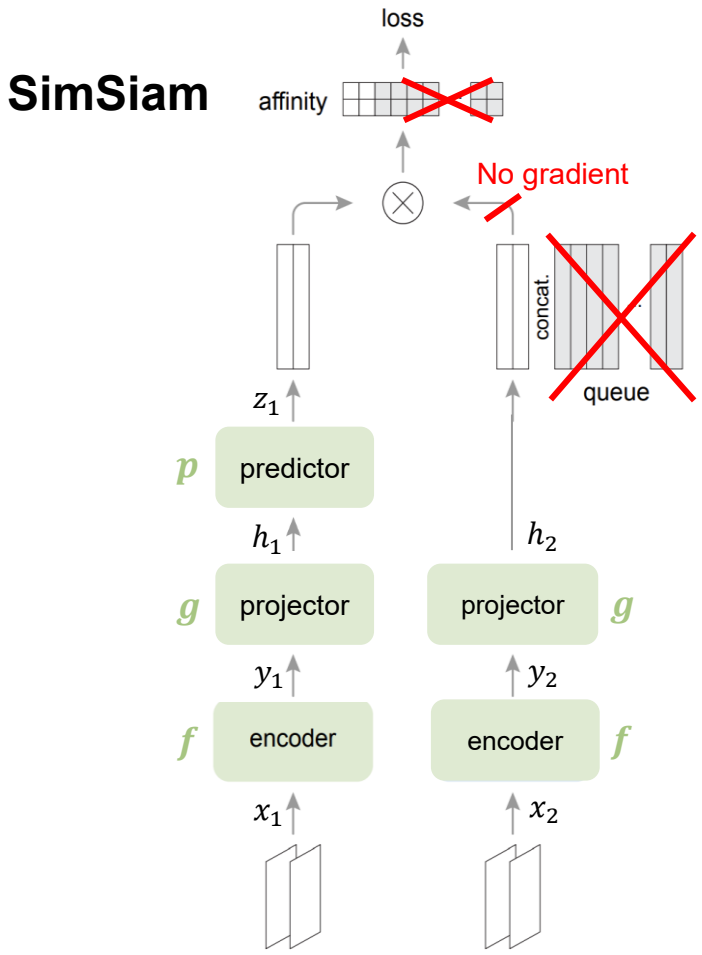
1. Predictor head
   (asymmetric architecture)

	pred. MLP h	acc. (%)
baseline	lr with cosine decay	67.7
(a)	no pred. MLP	0.1
(b)	fixed random init.	1.5
(c)	lr not decayed	68.1

Table 1. **Effect of prediction MLP** (ImageNet linear evaluation accuracy with 100-epoch pre-training). In all these variants, we use the same schedule for the encoder f (lr with cosine decay).

SimSiam: Exploring Simple Siamese Representation Learning (Chen et al. CVPR 2021)

SimSiam



So how does SimSiam avoid collapse?

1. Predictor head (asymmetric architecture)
2. Stopping Gradient

	acc. (%)
w/ stop-grad	67.7±0.1
w/o stop-grad	0.1

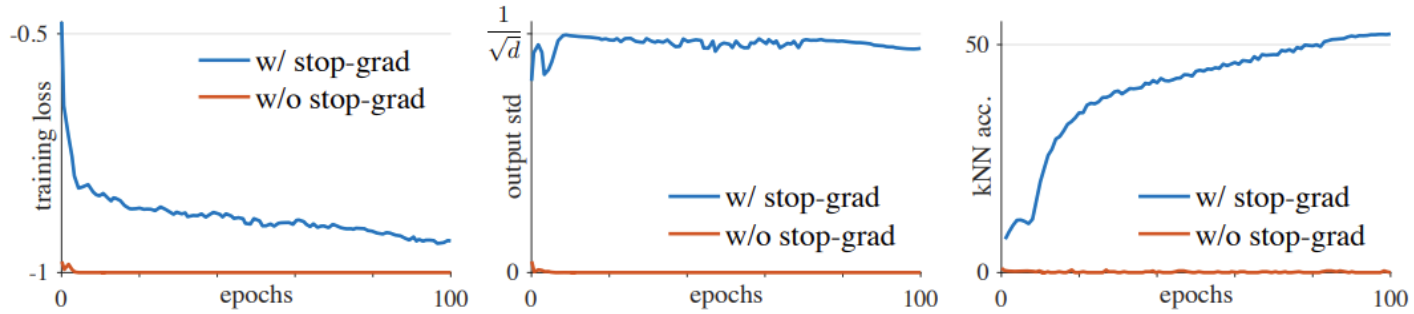


Figure 2. **SimSiam with *vs*. without stop-gradient**. **Left plot**: training loss. Without stop-gradient it degenerates immediately. **Middle plot**: the per-channel std of the ℓ_2-normalized output, plotted as the averaged std over all channels. **Right plot**: validation accuracy of a kNN classifier [34] as a monitor of progress. **Table**: ImageNet linear evaluation ("w/ stop-grad" is mean±std over 5 trials).

SimSiam: Exploring Simple Siamese Representation Learning (Chen et al. CVPR 2021)

SimSiam - Results

Comparisons on ImageNet
Linear Classification

method	batch size	negative pairs	momentum encoder	100 ep	200 ep	400 ep	800 ep
SimCLR (repro.+)	4096	✓		66.5	68.3	69.8	70.4
MoCo v2 (repro.+)	**256**	✓	✓	67.4	69.9	71.0	72.2
BYOL (repro.)	4096		✓	66.5	**70.6**	**73.2**	**74.3**
SwAV (repro.+)	4096			66.5	69.1	70.7	71.8
SimSiam	**256**			**68.1**	70.0	70.8	71.3

	VOC 07 detection			VOC 07+12 detection			COCO detection			COCO instance seg.		
pre-train	AP_{50}	AP	AP_{75}	AP_{50}	AP	AP_{75}	AP_{50}	AP	AP_{75}	AP^{mask}_{50}	AP^{mask}	AP^{mask}_{75}
scratch	35.9	16.8	13.0	60.2	33.8	33.1	44.0	26.4	27.8	46.9	29.3	30.8
ImageNet supervised	74.4	42.4	42.7	81.3	53.5	58.8	58.2	38.2	41.2	54.7	33.3	35.2
SimCLR (repro.+)	75.9	46.8	50.1	81.8	55.5	61.4	57.7	37.9	40.9	54.6	33.3	35.3
MoCo v2 (repro.+)	**77.1**	**48.5**	**52.5**	**82.3**	**57.0**	**63.3**	**58.8**	**39.2**	**42.5**	**55.5**	**34.3**	**36.6**
BYOL (repro.)	**77.1**	47.0	49.9	81.4	55.3	61.1	57.8	37.9	40.9	54.3	33.2	35.0
SwAV (repro.+)	75.5	46.5	49.6	81.5	55.4	61.4	57.6	37.6	40.3	54.2	33.1	35.1
SimSiam, base	75.5	47.0	50.2	**82.0**	56.4	62.8	57.5	37.9	40.9	54.2	33.2	35.2
SimSiam, optimal	**77.3**	**48.5**	**52.5**	**82.4**	**57.0**	**63.7**	**59.3**	**39.2**	**42.1**	**56.0**	**34.4**	**36.7**

Comparisons on
Finetuning

SimSiam: Exploring Simple Siamese Representation Learning (Chen et al. CVPR 2021)

DINO: Self-Distillation with No Labels

Emerging Properties in Self-Supervised Vision Transformers

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Julien Mairal[2] Piotr Bojanowski[1] Armand Joulin[1]

[1] Facebook AI Research [2] Inria* [3] Sorbonne University



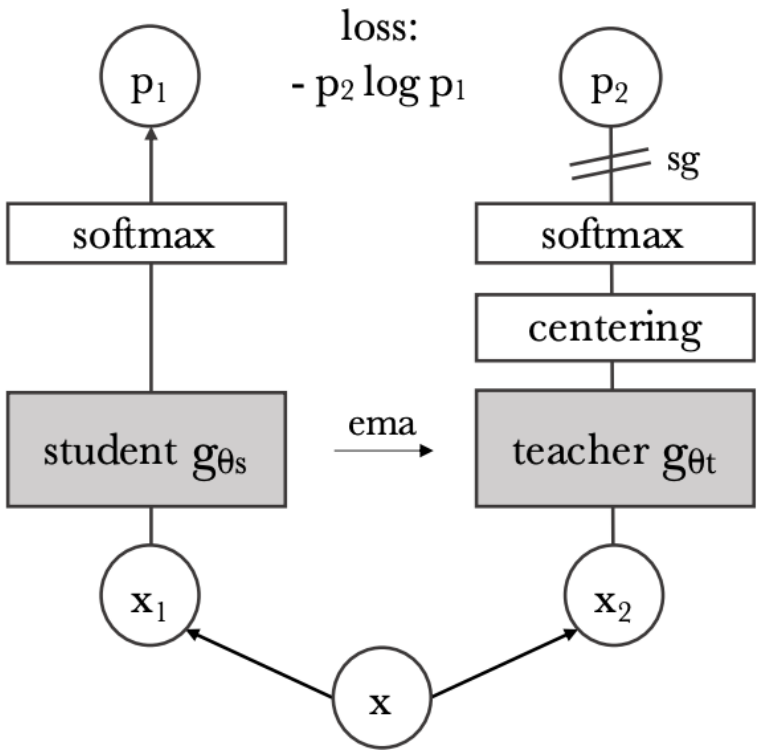
Figure 1: **Self-attention from a Vision Transformer with 8×8 patches trained with no supervision.** We look at the the `[CLS]` token on the heads of the last layer. This token is not attached to any label nor supervision. These maps show that the model automatically learns class-specific features leading to unsupervised object segmentations.

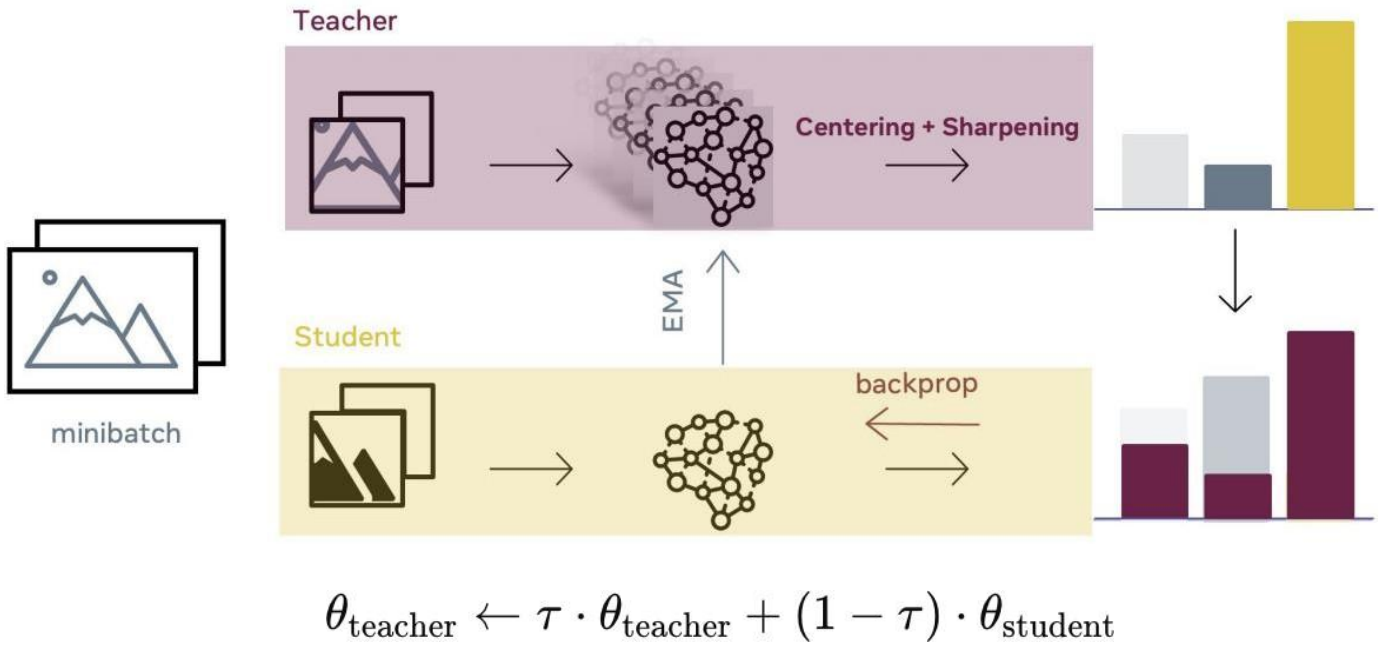
Abstract

*In this paper, we question if self-supervised learning provides new properties to Vision Transformer (ViT) [19] that stand out compared to convolutional networks (convnets). Beyond the fact that adapting self-supervised methods to this architecture works particularly well, we make the following observations: first, self-supervised ViT features contain explicit information about the semantic segmentation of an image, which does not emerge as clearly with supervised ViTs, nor with convnets. Second, these features are also excellent k-NN classifiers, reaching 78.3% top-1 on ImageNet with a small ViT. Our study also underlines the importance of momentum encoder [33], multi-crop training [10], and the use of small patches with ViTs. We implement our findings into a simple self-supervised method, called DINO, which we interpret as a form of self-**di**stillation with **no** labels. We show the synergy between DINO and ViTs by achieving 80.1% top-1 on ImageNet in linear evaluation with ViT-Base.*

Caron et al. 2021 Emerging Properties in Self-Supervised Vision Transformers

DINO





$$\theta_{\text{teacher}} \leftarrow \tau \cdot \theta_{\text{teacher}} + (1 - \tau) \cdot \theta_{\text{student}}$$

Caron et al. 2021 Emerging Properties in Self-Supervised Vision Transformers

DINO

Algorithm 1 DINO PyTorch pseudocode w/o multi-crop.

```
# gs, gt: student and teacher networks
# C: center (K)
# tps, tpt: student and teacher temperatures
# l, m: network and center momentum rates
gt.params = gs.params
for x in loader: # load a minibatch x with n samples
    x1, x2 = augment(x), augment(x) # random views

    s1, s2 = gs(x1), gs(x2) # student output n-by-K
    t1, t2 = gt(x1), gt(x2) # teacher output n-by-K

    loss = H(t1, s2)/2 + H(t2, s1)/2
    loss.backward() # back-propagate

    # student, teacher and center updates
    update(gs) # SGD
    gt.params = l*gt.params + (1-l)*gs.params
    C = m*C + (1-m)*cat([t1, t2]).mean(dim=0)

def H(t, s):
    t = t.detach() # stop gradient
    s = softmax(s / tps, dim=1)
    t = softmax((t - C) / tpt, dim=1) # center + sharpen
    return - (t * log(s)).sum(dim=1).mean()
```

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DINO v2

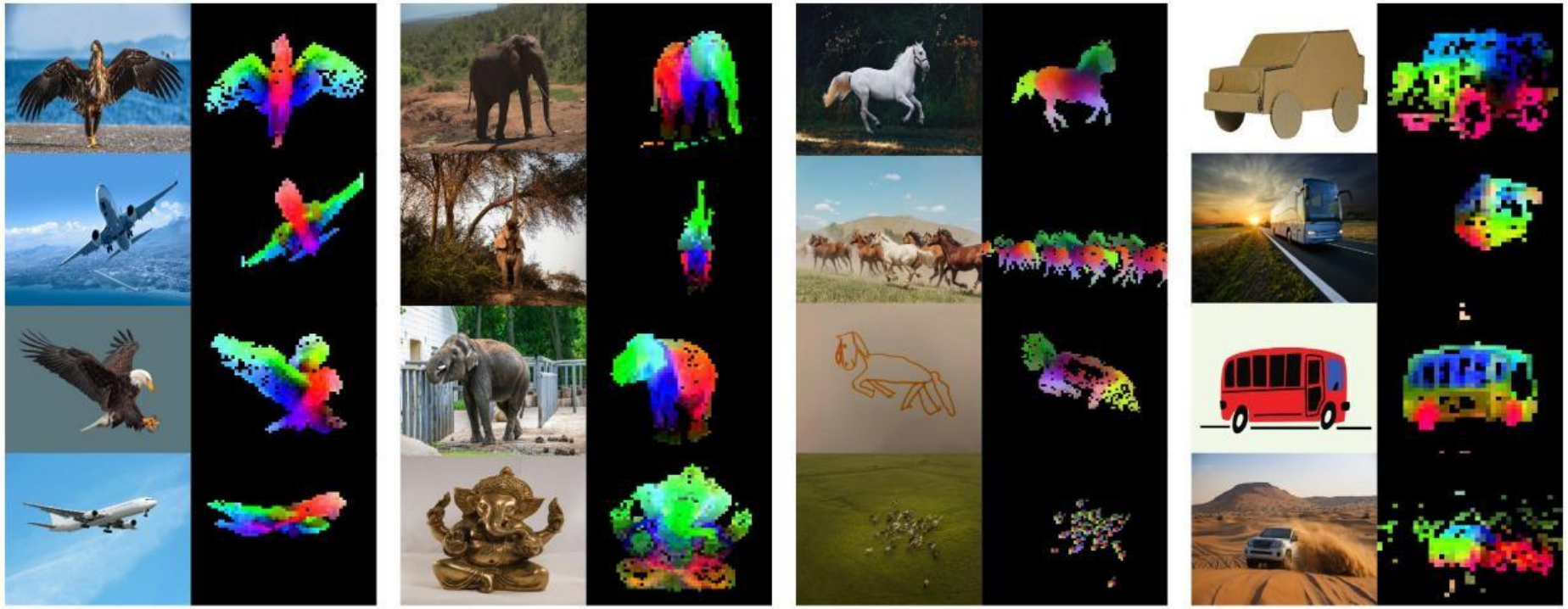


Figure 1: **Visualization of the first PCA components.** We compute a PCA between the patches of the images from the same column (a, b, c and d) and show their first 3 components. Each component is matched to a different color channel. Same parts are matched between related images despite changes of pose, style or even objects. Background is removed by thresholding the first PCA component.

Caron et al. 2021 Emerging Properties in Self-Supervised Vision Transformers

Summary: Contrastive Representation Learning

A general formulation for contrastive learning:

$$\text{score}(f(x), f(x^+)) >> \text{score}(f(x), f(x^-))$$

InfoNCE loss: N-way classification among positive and negative samples

$$L = -\mathbb{E}_X \left[\log \frac{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+))}{\exp(s(f(x), f(x^+)) + \sum_{j=1}^{N-1} \exp(s(f(x), f(x_j^-))} \right]$$

Commonly known as the InfoNCE loss (van den Oord et al., 2018)

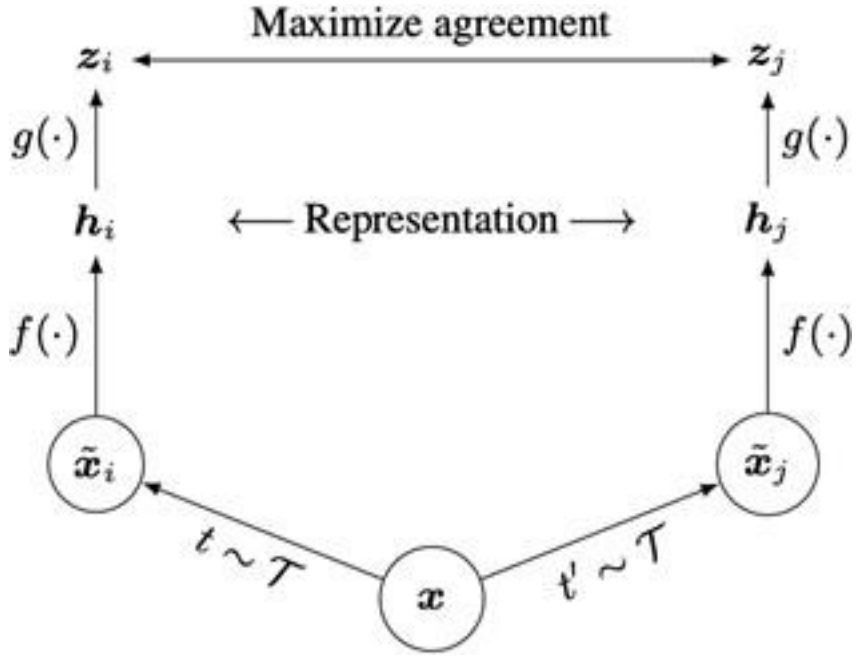
A lower bound on the mutual information between f(x) and f(x⁺)

$$MI[f(x), f(x^+)] - \log(N) \geq -L$$

Summary: Contrastive Representation Learning

SimCLR: a simple framework for contrastive representation learning

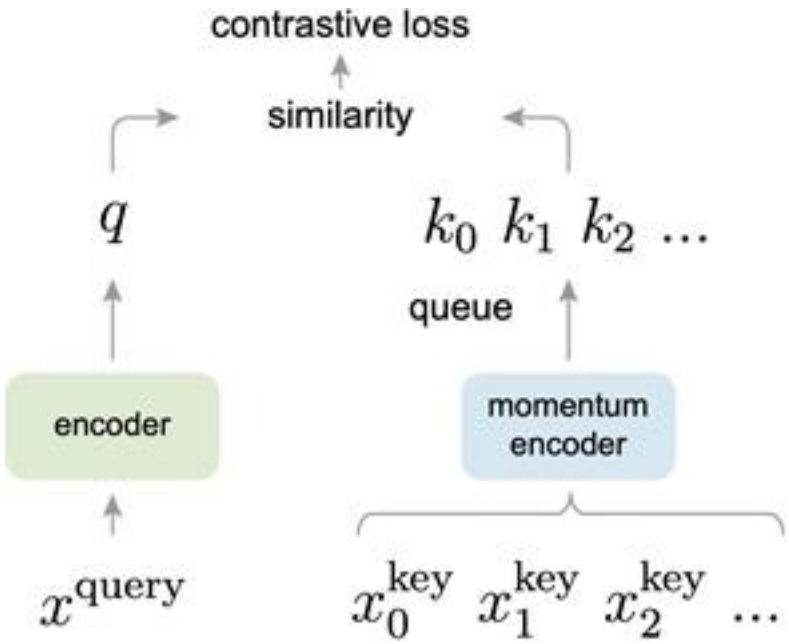
- Key ideas: non-linear projection head to allow flexible representation learning
- Simple to implement, effective in learning visual representation
- Requires large training batch size to be effective; large memory footprint



Summary: Contrastive Representation Learning

MoCo (v1, v2): contrastive learning using momentum sample encoder

- Decouples negative sample size from minibatch size; allows large batch training without TPU
- MoCo-v2 combines the key ideas from SimCLR, i.e., nonlinear projection head, strong data augmentation, with momentum contrastive learning



Summary – BYOL & SimSiam

- Positive pairs are augmented views of the same sample
  Remove the negative pairs → **BYOL**
- We can also remove momentum-update → **SimSiam**
- Key ingredients:
  - Heavy data Augmentation
  - Projection Head and Predictor Head → **BYOL**
  - No need of large Batch Size → **SimSiam**
  - Stop-Gradient

References

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Unsupervised Representation Learning by Predicting Image Rotations (Gidaris et al. ICLR 2018)
Unsupervised Visual Representation Learning by Context Prediction (Doersch et al. ICCV 2015)
Unsupervised Learning of Visual Representations by Solving Jigsaw Puzzles (Noroozi et al. ECCV 2016)
Context Encoders: Feature Learning by Inpainting (Pathak et al. CVPR 2016)
Colorful Image Colorization (Zhang, Isola and Efros, ECCV 2016)
Representation Learning with Contrastive Predictive Coding (Oord et al. 2018)
A Simple Framework for Contrastive Learning of Visual Representations (ICML et al. 2020)
Momentum Contrast for Unsupervised Visual Representation Learning (He et al. CVPR et al. 2020)
Improved Baselines with Momentum Contrastive Learning (Chen et al. 2020)
Bootstrap your own latent: A new approach to self-supervised Learning (Grill et al. NeurIPS 2020)
SimSiam: Exploring Simple Siamese Representation Learning (Chen et al. CVPR 2021)

Thank you

Acknowledges: some slides and material from Luca Franco, Fei-Fei Li, Justin Johnson, Serena Yeung, Jeff Donahue



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